REVISION 10

FIELD HEALTH AND SAFETY MANUAL

REVISED: 9/1/2025

Comprehensive Health and Safety Manual: Essential Standards and Procedures

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WHO WE ARE

Cooper Steel is a family-owned, industry-leading provider of high-quality steel fabrication solutions. With six decades of experience and a commitment to excellence, we specialize in custom fabrication, structural steel, and metalwork for diverse industries. Our skilled team delivers superior products, on time, and to the highest standards of quality and precision.

Our values are the foundation of every project we take on. We go all out, bringing our maximum effort and commitment to tasks large and small. We never cut corners. Our team has built a solid reputation on our relentless pursuit of perfection — the "Cooper Steel Attitude." We always operate with integrity, doing what's right and raising the bar for the entire industry. Along the way, we create a seamless experience for our customers, from estimation to completion.

Customized solutions and expert craftsmanship empower us to get the impossible done — every time. We tackle projects head-on and exceed expectations at each touchpoint. From our family ownership to our state-of-the-art fabrication shops, Cooper Steel serves as a true partner for projects of all sizes.

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Dear Team,

At Cooper Steel, safety is first - always. The safety of each person on our project sites and in our shops and offices is not only the responsibility of a single person or department. Each of us is accountable for protecting not only ourselves, but also our coworkers.

As a member of the Cooper Steel team, you must take all of the following steps to ensure a safe work environment:

- Understand and adhere to Cooper Steel's Safety and Health Program;
- Participate in safety meetings and training sessions;
- Remain drug free;
- Avoid abusive lifestyle practices that affect your level of alertness;
- Be proactive in reporting any unsafe conditions to your supervisor;
- Don't wait until an accident happens to point out an unsafe condition or practice;
- Report all accidents or injuries immediately;
- Offer safety suggestions to the Safety Department promptly; and
- Cooperate fully and maintain a positive attitude about safety.

It is your job to remain vigilant, prioritizing the safety of the group just as you would members of your own family. Together, we will continue to build strong and ensure that we all return home safely when our work is done.

Sincerely,

Gary K. Cooper, CEO

02 INTRODUCTION

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-02
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 **VERSION:** 2.0

As an employer, Cooper Steel is responsible for providing a place of employment free from recognized hazards that are likely to cause serious physical harm to our employees. The purpose of our safety and health program is to set guidelines to follow to eliminate recognized hazards in the workplace and make provisions for the hazards we cannot eliminate.

As an employee, you also have the responsibility to read and understand the rules and regulations set forth in our safety and health program and also to abide by these rules and apply good safety and health practices while performing your job duties.

We depend on each individual employee to be accountable for their own safety, as well as that of their coworkers, by reporting problems and finding solutions. As employees, we are the direct link to our customers- reflecting a visual representation of this company and our mission. At Cooper Steel, our mission is to deliver superior steel products and services with uncompromising integrity. When we say “superior products and services,” that means the industry’s best. Being the best requires every employee, regardless of their title, to give their best – including you.

1. **Purpose**
    a. The purpose of this policy is to equip individuals with the knowledge, skills, and resources necessary to recognize, avoid, and respond effectively to potential hazards to their personal safety and well-being. This program aims to cultivate a proactive safety mindset, empowering individuals to navigate their daily lives with confidence and a reduced risk of harm.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Field, Fabrication and Maintenance employees.

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The VP of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. Management and supervision will ensure each employee participates in this program and review all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.

4. **Introduction**
    a. As an employee of Cooper Steel, YOU are the most important person in charge of your safety and the safety of your co-workers. You must be able to recognize hazards as this is the most influential factor in incident prevention and a successful job. We all have a role to play in preventing workplace injuries. While the hazards we see and identify may seem small to us, the impact of our actions can change the life of someone else. When we understand and commit to workplace safety, we can help make sure this impact is a positive one – where there's no injury and no trauma, where everyone works and goes home safely.
    b. You are responsible for the safety of your own actions while on the job. Conduct yourself professionally and focus on your safety and the safety of others around you at all times; the workplace is no place for horseplay or lack of attention. Serve as a good role model to co-workers for safe work practices and behavior. Maintain your personal work area and common areas in a clean and orderly manner; good housekeeping means a safer workplace. Always wear the appropriate personal protective equipment required for your job tasks.
    c. Talk with your supervisor if you have a suggestion to make a process or equipment safer. No one knows your job and tools better than you. Immediately warn co-workers and notify your supervisor of any malfunctioning

equipment, hazardous conditions, and unsafe behavior in the workplace – someone's life may depend on it.

5. **The Employee's Role**
    a. As a Cooper Steel Employee, you are responsible and accountable for being aware of workplace hazards and your safety, just as the company is responsible and accountable. We will provide you with whatever you need to ensure your safety. The responsibilities of the employee are many but be assured that the company stands with you.
        i. Encourage a positive attitude towards workplace safety.
        ii. Identify safety and health hazards through safety assessments and take actions to eliminate or control the hazards.
        iii. Follow task specific safety procedures.
        iv. Strive to be a positive role model to co-workers for safe-work practices and behavior.
        v. Follow applicable rules, policies, procedures, and guidelines.
        vi. Participate in daily pre-task stretch and flex exercises.
        vii. Report all work-related injuries and illnesses, including any near-miss occurrences, to your supervisor.
        viii. Use and maintain all safety devices and personal protective equipment as needed.

6. **The Supervisor's Role**
    a. The supervisor, more than anyone else, plays a vital role in implementing a strong safety culture within the company. They must maintain day-to-day safety requirements as set forth by the company Safety & Health Program and motivate their crews to work safely. Our supervisors must be competent to identify and mitigate hazards, in a reasonable and practical way.
    b. The supervisor is responsible and accountable for being aware of workplace hazards and protecting the workers accordingly, just as the company is responsible and accountable. The responsibilities are many but be assured that the company stands with you. We will provide you with whatever you need to ensure the safety of every employee.
        i. Encourage a positive attitude about job safety in the workplace.
        ii. You must ensure all the company safety and health rules are being followed.
        iii. Ensure employees have been provided job-specific safety training.
        iv. Ensure employees are qualified and able to perform the required duties.
        v. Document in detail all safety violations you observe by your workers.
        vi. Incident and near miss reports should be reported immediately to the Safety Department.
        vii. Ensure work areas are cleaned up at the end of each workday.
        viii. Make sure no one operates a company vehicle, either on or off the workplace, without a valid driver's license and company approval.
        ix. Perform and document daily Jobsite Safety Analysis (JSA) if applicable.
        x. Ensure daily pre-task stretch and flex exercises are performed.

xi. **Remember, safety shall never be compromised by production demands or profit or loss on a job, regardless of the demands placed before us by the job's schedule or contract obligations. It is your responsibility to ensure the safety of each one of your workers. If the crew size or production schedule is such that you feel safety may be compromised in any way, call the Executive VP, Safety immediately and request help. This is company policy.**

7. Tool Box Talks

a. Supervisors are responsible for holding a weekly Tool Box Talk training session. Tool Box Talks are assigned by the Safety Director. This is done to educate all employees in safety and health as a means of continuing education, and to solicit comments and suggestions from the employees on safer or healthier methods to perform their work.
b. The supervisor must document these Tool Box Talks, and shall have the following information listed below.
   i. Location
   ii. Tool Box Talk topic
   iii. Date of training session
   iv. Signature of employees in attendance
   v. Any comments or suggestions
   vi. Signature of the person presenting the training.
c. A signed copy of the tool box talk is to be sent to the Safety Training Administrator upon completion.

8. Job Safety Analysis

a. Prior to beginning work of non-routine tasks, the supervisor is responsible for holding and documenting a Jobsite Safety Analysis. In this meeting with the crew you will:
   i. Observe the work area for safety hazards.
   ii. Review all tasks to be completed that day.
   iii. Mitigate all hazards created by those tasks.
   iv. Review all hazards and procedures with the crew.
   v. Document meeting on Cooper Steel JSA form
b. The JSA form will be available to workers during work hours and will be turned in or kept on file.

NEW EMPLOYEE ORIENTATION

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-04
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 **VERSION:** 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   New employee safety orientation is the process of introducing new, inexperienced, and/or transferred workers to Cooper Steel, their supervisors, co-workers, work areas, jobs, and especially the health and safety requirements of their work environment.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Employees.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and EHS Specialists shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in the company's New Hire Training Program and reviews all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.

4. **Policy**
   Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in the company's New Hire Training Program and reviews all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.
   The safety orientation must include the following elements at a minimum:
   a. Review of the company's Health and Safety Policy
   b. Overview of applicable health and safety legislation including employee right to refuse unsafe work
   c. Overview of the company Health and Safety program including:
      i. Health and Safety responsibilities
      ii. Hazard Assessment, Analysis & Control
      iii. Company Rules & Safe Work Procedures applicable to the employees position
      iv. Disciplinary Policy
      v. Substance Abuse Policy
      vi. Workplace Violence Policy
      vii. Personal Protection Equipment applicable to the employees position
      viii. Fire Protection & Fire Extinguisher
      ix. Injury, Incident, and Near Miss Reporting

x. Emergency Response
xi. Modified Duty Program
xii. Workplace Inspections
xiii. Harassment/Workplace Violence Policy
xiv. Equipment operator certification required for the employees position.

d. Site specific health & safety requirements when assigned to remote projects.
e. Any additional regional/divisional health and safety requirements as deemed necessary by local management.
f. There will be a verification/evaluation process to ensure the information has been clearly understood by the worker. This can include a written evaluation, oral evaluation, or work practice evaluation. This is an important phase with monitoring and mentoring the employees.
g. To ensure that all employees remain familiar with the company's health and safety requirements, including any legislative changes or safety program updates and revisions, all employees will be required to participate in an annual health and safety training. This annual update review must be performed by a supervisor or competent designate. All training records must be formally documented and filed in the employee file.
h. Cooper Steel will monitor and mentor any new employee, a temporary employee or an employee who has changed job roles.

5. Employee Position Change

a. When an employee changes job roles the Supervisor will ensure the change is communicated to the Safety Department. The employee must complete the training program required for their new position.

6. Training

a. Supervisors and EHS Specialists will ensure that all applicable employees are trained in the requirements of this policy. Training shall be documented, and training records shall be maintained on file at the facility.

05 FIT FOR DUTY

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SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   a. The Fit for Duty program aims to safeguard the well-being of all employees by ensuring they possess the physical and mental capacity to perform their essential job functions safely and effectively, while also minimizing workplace risks and complying with Cooper Steel safety policies.

2. **Scope**
   a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Employees

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Manager/supervisor responsibilities
      i. Observing the attendance, performance, and behavior of employees they supervise.
      ii. Interviewing an employee when a Reliable Report is received or the employee appears to the manager/supervisor to not be Fit for Duty and referring an employee for a Medical Evaluation when appropriate.
      iii. Recording the reasons/observations that triggered a Fitness for Duty Medical Evaluation referral.
      iv. Utilizing this policy in a fair and consistent manner, respecting the worker's privacy and the confidentiality of medical information.
   d. Employee Responsibilities
      i. Reporting to work, Fit for Duty.
      ii. Notifying the manager/supervisor when not Fit for Duty.
      iii. Notifying the manager/supervisor when observing a co-worker who may not be Fit for Duty (in cases where the possibly impaired individual is the worker's manager, the worker should make the notification to the Human Resources Department).
      iv. Cooperating with a manager/supervisor's directive, and, or referral for a Medical Evaluation.

4. **Definitions**
   a. Fitness for Duty / Fit for Duty - physical and mental health status that facilitates the performance of essential job duties in an effective manner and protects the health and safety of oneself, others and property.

b. Medical Certification - a document from a medically appropriate, licensed provider attesting to a employee's Fitness for Duty. Allowable costs to obtain the certification are paid by Workers Compensation for work-related absences, and by the employee and the worker's health insurance for absences which are not work-related.
c. Medical Evaluation - An examination performed by a designated health professional, including but not limited to a health history, physical and/or psychological examination and any medically indicated diagnostic studies. The cost is paid by the employer.
d. Reliable Report - self-disclosure or third-party opinion about a employee's possible lack of Fitness for Duty which is assessed as reasonable by the manager/supervisor considering such factors as the relationship of the reporter to the employee, the seriousness of the employee's condition, the possible motivation of the reporter and how the reporter learned the information.
e. Working Hours - beginning with a employee’s starting time and ending with the employee's quitting time as well as any time a employee is on call. All work activities are included whether they occur on or outside Cooper Steel properties.

5. Procedures

a. A “Triggering Event” occurs when a manager/supervisor observes or receives a Reliable Report of an employee's possible lack of fitness for duty. Observations may include, but are not limited to an employee’s self reports, manual dexterity, coordination, alertness, speech, vision acuity, concentration, response to criticism, interaction with coworkers and supervisors, change in personal hygiene, memory. Management actions in response to a Triggering Event include:
    i. Manager/supervisor interviews employees, when possible.
    ii. Manager/supervisor assesses magnitude of safety risk and contacts Human Resources Department to develop a plan of action.
b. Return to Work (after an extended medical absence)
    i. The Employee will attend a Fit for Duty examination by a medical professional.
    ii. The Medical Professional will evaluate the employee per their job description and provide a Medical Certification if the employee is fit to return to work.
    iii. The Human Resources Department receives Medical Certification from employee’s medical provider prior to their return to work, with suggested accommodations, if applicable.
    iv. The Human Resources Department, Safety Department, and Manager/Supervisor will determine whether employee can perform essential functions of the job with or without accommodation, accepting suggested accommodations or developing alternative accommodations, where available.

v. Employee shall comply with medical direction provided by physician or healthcare professional.

DISCIPLINARY PROGRAM

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-06

SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   a. Cooper Steel's progressive discipline policy and procedures are designed to provide a structured corrective action process to improve and prevent a recurrence of undesirable workers unsafe behavior. It has been designed consistent with Cooper Steel's organizational values, human resource (HR) best practices and employment laws.

2. **Scope**
   a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Employees

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.

4. **Procedures**
   a. There are two classes of disciplinary enforcement. Class 1 violations are those that are less serious in nature, while Class 2 violations are considered willful or cause immediate danger to life and/or health. Each class will be broken down into levels of severity.

Class 1 Violation	**Class 2 Violation**
Level 1 – Verbal Warning	Level 1 – One to three days off without pay
Level 2 – Written Warning	Level 2 – One week off without pay
Level 3 – One to three days off without pay	Level 3 – Termination
Level 4 - Termination	**<u>Note: Class 2 violations require re-training</u>**

   b. The Company reserves the right to combine or skip steps depending on the facts of each situation and the nature of the offense. The level of disciplinary intervention may also vary. Some factors that will be considered are whether the offense is repeated despite coaching, counseling, and training.
   c. This Policy applies to all company personnel while in the office, fabrication facility, project sites, or any company functions. Verbal and written warnings and citations must be reported through the safety department to the recording personnel. The above procedures are based on the seriousness of the

violation. The supervisor as well as the safety representative will be involved with the process. The Safety Director will be involved for all Class 2 violations and will make the final decision of any disciplinary actions implemented. Re-training will be required for all Class 2 violations before the employee may return to work. In the event of termination, the employee will not be allowed to work for Cooper Steel in any capacity for a minimum period of three months.

5. **Documentation**
    a. The employee will be provided copies of safety progressive discipline documentation. The employee will be asked to sign copies of this documentation attesting to their receipt and understanding of the corrective action outlined in these documents.
        i. Copies of these documents will be placed in the worker's official personnel file.

6. **Training**
    a. Plant Managers, Director of Field Safety, and Facility Safety Managers will ensure that all applicable employees are trained in the requirements of this policy. Training shall be documented, and training records shall be maintained on file at the facility.

7. **COOPER STEEL RESERVES THE RIGHT TO IMMEDIATELY DISMISS AN EMPLOYEE FOR ANY DELIBERATE AND/OR SERIOUS VIOLATION OF COMPANY POLICY.**

SHORT SERVICE EMPLOYEE

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-07
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. This policy is intended to provide guidance and instruction to prevent incidents and injuries to new hires and temporary workers for Cooper Steel, and to ensure that Company employees with less than six months experience are identified, adequately supervised, trained, and monitored to prevent injury to themselves or others, property damage, or environmental harm.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel temporary employees or new field or fabrication employees with less than 6 months of experience in their current position.

3. **Definitions**
    a. Short Service Employee (SSE) – A new employee with less than six months experience in the same job or with the company.
    b. Mentor - An experienced employee, who has been assigned to help and work with a SSE by his/her manager.

4. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. Safety Training Administrator and Field & Facility Safety Managers
       This person is responsible for:
        i. Ensuring the Initial Safety Orientation and Training needed by the SSE is provided.
        ii. Maintaining training records of all SSE's, Managers, and Mentors.
    d. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.
    a. **Managers**
       These people are responsible for:
        i. Ensuring the SSE is appropriately identified and making initial assignment of Mentor.
        ii. Ensuring that the SSE mentor maintains proper knowledge and skills in particular jobs that are assigned.

iii. Ensuring the assigned that SSE Mentor is adequately training their SSE.
iv. Ensuring the SSE is gaining the particular knowledge and skills for the position.
v. Following all company safety rules and policies.

b. **Mentors**
These people are responsible for:
i. Having a firm understanding of their role, responsibility, and accountability for the SSE.
ii. Having the desire, a patient disposition, and willingness to devote the necessary time to succeed as a mentor.
iii. Acting as the designated person(s) at the site who is responsible and accountable for guiding and monitoring the performance of the SSE.
iv. Possessing the knowledge and skills in the job tasks that are assigned to the SSE.
v. Effectively communicating with the SSE to determine if the SSE is learning and retaining the knowledge being imparted.
vi. Providing a positive Safety Attitude, avoiding criticism, and building confidence and self-esteem in the SSE.
vii. Assure SSE's understanding of company Safety policies and maintaining a positive Safety Culture.
viii. Refraining from taking short cuts or putting the SSE in unsafe situations.
ix. Following all company safety rules and policies.

c. **Short Service Employee**
These people are responsible for:
i. Completing the New Hire Training Program and other required training applicable to their position.
ii. Visual Reference of SSE's will be by:
   1. Field Employees: Visual reference will be through yellow employee number hard hat decals.
   2. Shop Employees: Shop employees will be recognized on the "New Employee Recognition" board.
iii. Following all instructions as set forth by the SSE Mentor and Manager
iv. Repeating the mentoring program in the event of any non-compliance with company safety policies or procedures.
v. Reporting any unsafe conditions or concerns.
vi. Reporting all injuries and incidents immediately.
vii. Participating in safety meetings, trainings, and initiatives.
viii. Completing the SSE program. Only after meeting prerequisites will an employee be removed from the Short Service Employee designation, including:

1. Completion of New Hire Training Program (for specific position)
2. Completion of Standard Machine Operating Procedures (as applicable for position)
3. Completion of Mobile Equipment Operator Certification including (as applicable for position):
    a. Crane Operator Certification (NCCCO or equivalent)
    b. Forklift/Telehandler Operator Certification
    c. Aerial Lift Operator Certification
    d. Overhead Crane Operator Certification
    e. Combi-lift Operator Certification
    f. Skid Steer Operator Certification
4. Completion of 6 months of service in designated position

08 WORKING ALONE

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-08
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. To ensure the safety of workers/employees who are working alone. There may be situations where personnel sometimes work alone. Examples include:
        i. Staying late to complete a job that must be done before the next day's work.
        ii. Completing a task where there is only room for one worker.
        iii. Working on equipment in a remote area.
        iv. Servicing equipment in a remote area.
        v. Cleaning up scrap and debris when work is done for the day.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Employees.

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.
    d. The supervisor shall ensure that any worker working alone is aware of real and potential hazards in the area. The worker should be trained in hazard recognition and in the procedures and equipment required to do the job safely. The supervisor must also ensure that:
        i. A method of checking in with the worker has been established.
        ii. Check-in intervals are clearly understood.
        iii. The designated contact person is aware of the work schedule.
    e. Communication equipment shall be used.
        i. Any communication equipment used is in good working order.
        ii. Obstructions or interference that may block radio communications are prohibited.

4. **Procedures**
    a. A person is “working alone,” when:
        i. He or she is on their own at work

        ii. When they cannot be seen or heard by another person
        iii. When emergency assistance is not readily available
    b. The greatest risk in working alone is that no one is available to help a worker who may be injured, trapped, or unconscious. Even if co-workers realize that someone is missing, it may be difficult to locate an injured worker.
    c. Working alone is only permissible when all other means of working in a team are exhausted and the plan must be approved by the Safety Director.
    d. Planning
        i. Inspect the jobsite for real and potential hazards and take whatever steps are required to safeguard workers.
        ii. If any personal protective equipment or clothing is required, it will be provided, along with instructions on its proper use.
        iii. All safety and work-related procedures will be reviewed with workers to ensure that each procedure is clearly understood and in accordance with Cooper Steel's health and safety policy.
        iv. In some situations, like confined spaces, regulations under the Occupational Health and Safety Act prohibit entry or work without another person standing by outside the area.

5. **Communication**
    a. Communication is crucial in accounting for personnel working alone. A system must be established where, at regular intervals, someone checks on the worker or the worker reports to a designated person. A check at the end of the work shift must be done.
    b. A procedure to follow in case the worker cannot be contacted, including provisions for emergency rescue.
    c. Where hazard exposure is high, intervals should be kept short.
    d. If a site telephone is involved, it must be clearly identified, conveniently located, and working properly.
    e. Two-way radios can also provide effective communication. Test the units on-site to ensure that reception is reliable.

6. **Employees Who Perform Hazardous Work**
    a. Employees who perform hazardous work alone, without routine interaction with other employees and the public may be unable to get immediate help. The strategy is to control the hazards associated with the work.
    The following prevention strategies are essential in reducing the risks associated with this type of working alone situation:
        i. **Safe Work Procedure** – Having written safe work procedures for hazardous work is essential. They provide standard instructions to all employees to carry out the work safely.
        ii. **Equipment Safety** – Cooper Steel will ensure that employees use equipment as intended and according to the manufacturer's

specifications. All equipment used at a work site must be maintained in good working condition, whether or not it is being used in a “working alone” situation. High hazard equipment should have a dead man switch to prevent continued activation of the equipment. The switch should always be in good working order.

   iii. **Equipment and Supplies** – In addition to proper equipment, appropriate first aid and emergency supplies must be provided to employees who are working alone at a work site.
   iv. **Travel Plan** – If employees are working alone in a remote location, Cooper Steel will establish a sign-out procedure to track their whereabouts. An “overdue employee” procedure should also be in place for locating employees who fail to report on time.

7. **Employees Who Travel Alone**
   a. Some of the risks to employees who travel alone involve injuries from motor vehicle accidents. The risk is greater when employees cannot communicate in remote areas or are unable to summon help. Employees in the transportation industry and businesspeople in transit are exposed to the risk.
   b. The prevention strategies for this situation focus on safety on the road. The following strategies should be addressed in the overall management of the risk:
      i. **Safe Work Procedures -** Employees must have full concentration on the road when travelling alone. Cooper Steel will allow sufficient rest time for employees who are travelling on long trips.
      ii. **Equipment and Supplies -** Well-maintained vehicles prevent exposing employees to unnecessary risk. Appropriate first aid and emergency supplies must be provided.

8. **In a working alone situation the employer must:**
   a. **Conduct a hazard assessment -** Cooper Steel will closely examine and identify existing or potential safety hazards in the workplace. The assessment must be in writing and communicated to all affected staff. Affected employees will be involved in conducting the hazard assessment, and in the elimination, reduction, or control of the identified hazards.
   b. **Eliminate or reduce the risks -** Cooper Steel will take practical steps to eliminate the hazards identified. If it is not practicable to do so, Cooper Steel will implement procedures to reduce or control the hazards.
   c. **Provide an effective communication system -** Cooper Steel will provide an effective communication system for employees to contact other people who can respond to the employees’ need. The system must be appropriate to the hazards involved and include regular contact by the supervisor (or their designate) at intervals appropriate to the nature of the hazard associated with the worker’s work.

d. **Ensure employees are trained and educated -** Cooper Steel will ensure employees are trained and educated so they can perform their job safely.
e. Employees must be made aware of the hazards of working alone and the preventative steps that can be taken to reduce or eliminate potential risks.
f. These rules consider a wide variety of situations where employees work alone. Cooper Steel's intent is to consider the hazards specific to the work site and to adopt safety measures that address these hazards.

09 SUBSTANCE ABUSE POLICY

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-09
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 VERSION: 2.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. Cooper Steel is committed to providing a safe work environment and to fostering the well-being and health of its employees. That commitment is jeopardized when any Cooper Steel employee illegally uses drugs on or off the job, comes to work under their influence, possesses, distributes or sells drugs in the workplace, or abuses alcohol on the job. All employees of Cooper Steel are expected to understand the risks of alcohol and drug use to workplace safety, and to be able to identify and respond to those risks in compliance with this policy.
    b. The goal of this policy is to balance our respect for individuals with the need to maintain a safe, productive and drug-free environment. The intent of this policy is to offer a helping hand to those who need it, while sending a clear message that the illegal use of drugs and the abuse of alcohol are incompatible with employment at Cooper Steel.
    c. Cooper Steel offers resource information on various means of employee assistance in our community, including but not limited to drug and alcohol abuse programs. Employees are encouraged to use this resource file, which is located in the HR Department. In addition, we will distribute this information to employees for their confidential use.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Employees

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety and Human Resources shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The VP of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.

4. **Work Rules**
    a. All employees will be informed of this policy at the time of employment. Additionally, it will be discussed periodically at weekly safety meetings.

b. The following actions are strictly prohibited:
    i. While on company property or at a company worksite, to use, consume, possess, distribute, sell or transfer:
        1. Alcohol (unless contained in sealed (unopened) packaging, and secured in vehicle for transfer to home or official company-sanctioned event)
        2. Drugs other than those permitted by this policy as described below
        3. Drug paraphernalia
    ii. From reporting to work or performing work while the worker's ability to safely perform their duties is adversely affected by use of drugs or alcohol.
    iii. From refusing to:
        1. Comply with a request to confirm they are following this policy when a supervisor or manager has reasonable grounds to believe the worker may not be complying.
        2. Comply with a request to submit to an alcohol or drug test when the worker is selected for testing under the provisions of this program
    iv. This Work Rule permits the possession or use of prescription and non-prescription drugs under the following conditions:
        1. Any prescription drug in the worker's possession or used by the worker is prescribed to the worker, and
        2. The worker is using the prescription or non-prescription drug for its intended purpose and in the manner directed by the worker's physician or pharmacist or the manufacturer of the drug, and
        3. The use of the prescription or non-prescription drug does not adversely affect the worker's ability to safely perform his or her duties, and
        4. The worker has notified his or her supervisor or manager before starting work of any potentially unsafe side effects associated with the use of the prescription or non-prescription drug.

5. Testing Procedures

a. Any employee reporting to work visibly impaired will be deemed unable to perform required duties and will not be allowed to work. If possible, the employee's supervisor will first seek another supervisor's opinion to confirm the employee's status. Next, the supervisor will consult privately with the employee to determine the cause of the observation, including whether substance abuse has occurred. If, in the opinion of the supervisor, the employee is considered impaired, the employee will be sent home or to a medical facility by taxi or other safe transportation alternative - depending on the determination of the observed impairment - and accompanied by the supervisor or another employee if necessary. A drug or alcohol test may be in order. An impaired employee will not be allowed to drive.

b. When an employee or job applicant submits to a drug and/or alcohol test, they will be given a form by the specimen collector that contains a list of common medications and substances which may alter or affect the outcome of a drug or alcohol test. This form will also have a space for the donor to provide any information that he/she considers relevant to the test, including the identification of currently or recently used prescription or nonprescription medication or other relevant information. The information form should be kept by the job applicant or employee for their personal use.
c. **On Site Testing** Cooper Steel will designate personnel authorized to perform On-Site Testing. These employees will be trained in administering the test and determining the results. If an employee tests positive they will be required to submit to a laboratory test.
d. **Laboratory Testing** Cooper Steel will designate the laboratories to perform substance testing on urine or blood specimens in accordance with standards set forth by an established industry standard. The substances covered by this testing program are set forth below. Workers may be asked by collection site personnel to indicate whether there is the potential that they will test positive for prescription or other substances. A consent form and information sheet will be provided. If the worker fails to provide an acceptable urine specimen the company may take the following steps:
    i. Extend the stay of the worker at the designated collection site, if feasible, until an acceptable specimen can be collected.
    ii. Reschedule the test due to unusual circumstances, (i.e., post-operative situations).
    iii. Discipline the worker, up to and including termination, on the first offense for failing to cooperate or refusing to provide an acceptable specimen.
e. All positive specimen test results for workers on active status will be confirmed by standard laboratory procedures. In the case of testing by means other than urine (i.e., breath or other samples), reliable laboratory or instrument testing procedures will be followed.

6. Testing Criteria

a. Cooper Steel has adopted testing practices to identify employees who illegally use drugs on or off the job or who abuse alcohol on the job. It shall be a condition of employment for all employees to submit to substance abuse testing under the following circumstances:

i. **Pre-Employment:** All job applicants at Cooper Steel will undergo testing for substance abuse as a condition of employment. Any applicant with a confirmed positive test result will be denied employment.
    1. Applicants will be required to submit voluntarily to a urinalysis test at a laboratory chosen by Cooper Steel, and by signing a consent agreement will release this Company from liability.
    2. If the physician, official or lab personnel have reasonable suspicion to believe that the job applicant has tampered with the specimen, the applicant will not be considered for employment.
    3. Cooper Steel will not discriminate against applicants for employment because of a past history of drug or alcohol abuse. It is the current illegal use of drugs and/or abuse of alcohol, preventing employees from performing their jobs properly, that will not be tolerated.

ii. **Reasonable Suspicion:** When there is reasonable suspicion to believe that an employee is illegally using drugs or abusing alcohol. 'Reasonable suspicion' is based on a belief that an employee is using or has used drugs or alcohol in violation of the employer's policy drawn from specific objective and articulable facts and reasonable inferences drawn from those facts in light of experience. Among other things, such facts and inferences may be based upon, but not limited to, the following:
    1. Observable phenomena while at work such as direct observation of substance abuse or of the physical symptoms or manifestations of being impaired due to substance abuse.
    2. Abnormal conduct or erratic behavior while at work or a significant deterioration in work performance.
    3. A report of substance abuse provided by a reliable and credible source.
    4. Evidence that an individual has tampered with any substance abuse test during his or her employment with the current employer.
    5. Information that an employee has caused or contributed to an accident while at work; or
    6. Evidence that an employee has used, possessed, sold, solicited, or transferred drugs while working or while on the employer's premises or while operating the employer's vehicle,

machinery, or equipment.

iii. **Post Incident:** When employees have caused or contributed to an on-the-job injury that resulted in a loss of work-time, which means any period of time during which an employee stops performing the normal duties of employment and leaves the place of employment to seek care from a licensed medical provider. An employer may send employees for a substance abuse test if they are involved in on-the-job accidents where personal injury or damage to company property occurs.
iv. **Random:** Periodically random groups of employees will be required to undergo drug and alcohol testing.
v. **Re-employment:** Former employees returning to employment will be required to undergo substance abuse testing.
vi. **Follow Up:** As part of a follow-up program to treatment for drug abuse.
vii. **Fit for Duty:** Routine fitness-for-duty drug or alcohol testing. A covered employer must require an employee to submit to a drug or alcohol test if the test is conducted as part of a routinely scheduled employee fitness-for-duty medical examination where the examinations are required by law, regulation, are part of the covered employer's established policy, or one that is scheduled routinely for all members of an employment classification group.
viii. **As required by contract:** Substance abuse testing may be required by contract with a general contractor, prior to our employees reporting to work at certain sites.

7. Alcohol Testing

a. The consumption or possession of alcoholic beverages on this Company's premises is prohibited. (Company sponsored activities which may include the serving of alcoholic beverages are not included in this provision.) An employee whose normal faculties are impaired due to alcoholic beverages, or whose blood alcohol level tests .02% by weight while on duty/company business shall be guilty of misconduct, and shall be subject to discipline up to and including termination.

8. Testing Substances

a. As a minimum, the following substances shall be tested for:
   i. Alcohol level equal to or in excess of 0.02 BAL.
   ii. Drugs or Classes of Drugs

Amphetamines	Methamphetamines, meth, speed, ecstasy
THC	Cannabinoids, marijuana, hash
Cocaine	Coke, crack
Opiates	Heroin, opium, codeine, morphine
Phencyclidine	PCP, angel dust
Barbiturates	Phenobarbital, butalbital, secobarbital
Benzodiazepines	Diazepam, alprazolam, clonazepam
Methaqualone	Quaaludes
Methadone	Opiate analgesic
Propoxyphene	Darvocet

iii. Concentrations at or in excess of acceptable levels, which will be determined by reliable laboratory standards, shall be conclusive proof of use of unauthorized, prohibited, illegal or controlled substances.

9. Confidentiality

a. No information collected about a worker under this policy will be disclosed to any person unless the worker has given consent or the supervisor or manager in possession of the information is legally required to disclose it.

10. Disciplinary Action for Policy Violation

a. Violations of this policy are subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

   i. Applicants - If the final result of a pre-employment drug screen is positive, the applicant will not be employed. No applicant in a safety sensitive position can be reconsidered for employment sooner than six (6) months following the date of the positive drug screen.

   ii. Workers - No drug test will be conducted without written consent. However, any worker who refuses to provide such written consent and fully cooperate with this policy will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including discharge from employment.

      1. Under certain circumstances, disciplinary action may include a mandatory referral to and enrollment in an approved rehabilitation program at the worker's expense. This action may also require an indefinite suspension of regular employment.
      2. A worker's job is not in jeopardy by reason of his voluntary admission to having a substance problem and request for help and referral to an approved rehabilitation program, provided that such request is made prior to, and well in advance of, any consideration of being tested under the provisions of this policy. Workers participating in this rehabilitation program will be subject to follow-up or "maintenance" testing.

11. **Opportunity to Contest or Explain Test Results**
    a. Employees and job applicants who have a positive confirmed drug or alcohol test result may explain or contest the result to the medical review officer within five (5) working days after receiving written notification of the test result from the medical review officer. Employees and job applicants have the right to consult with a medical review officer for technical information regarding prescription and non-prescription medicine.
    b. If an employee's or job applicant's explanation or challenge is unsatisfactory to the medical review officer, the medical review officer shall report a positive test result back to Cooper Steel.

12. **Client Requirements**
    a. In the event that a client has an Alcohol and Drug Testing Guideline that is more stringent than those outlined above, the client's guidelines will be followed for all work done with that client. Examples of more stringent guidelines include but are not limited to:
        i. A greater number of substances (panels) to be tested for.
        ii. A lower detection/cut off levels.
        iii. Specified number or percent of workers to be tested on the site.
        iv. DOT or similar mandated programs.

FIRST AID/CPR PROGRAM

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-10
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   Cooper Steel is committed to the safety and health of workers and to ensuring employees are adequately prepared to respond effectively to medical emergencies, providing prompt medical attention for injuries until professional medical help arrives.

2. **Scope**
   This program applies to all Cooper Steel Employees.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and will review all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.
   d. Employer Responsibilities
      i. Ensure every worker receives training that explains first aid procedures.
      ii. Determine who must be trained to render first aid with the appropriate practices and techniques, including response to site-specific hazards.
      iii. Ensure the first aid response plan, amount of first aid trained personnel, equipment and all other hazard controls reflect workplace hazards as determined in job hazard analyses and worksite inspections.
      iv. Ensure first aid kits remain fully stocked and any emergency response equipment is in good condition.
   e. Worker Responsibilities
      i. Follow the first aid program.
      ii. If trained in first aid, render care as needed.

4. **Procedures**
   a. **First Aid/CPR Training**
   First aid and medical facilities will be made available on site. In the absence of medical facilities there shall be a minimum of (1) First Aid/CPR Certified Employee to every 10 workers on each shift to provide adequate first response medical care.

Each designated employee will receive training and will have a valid certificate in first aid training from the American Heart Association (AHA) or equivelent certifying authority..

b. **First Aid Kits**

The Company provides a First Aid Kit on the premises. It is there for worker's use in the treatment of minor scratches, burns, headaches, nausea, etc. All workers shall know the location of the First Aid Kit and shall notify their supervisor if they need to use them. If a worker has a work related injury or illnesses that requires professional medical assistance, they shall notify their supervisor as soon as possible.

The Field/Facility Safety Manager, or EHS Specialist shall inspect First Aid Kits before the kits are sent out to each job and on a monthly basis to ensure each kit has the required amount of supplies.

c. **Medical Treatment**

   i. **Non-Emergency Medical Treatment**

   For non-emergency work-related injuries requiring professional medical assistance, management must first authorize treatment. If a worker sustains an injury requiring treatment other than first aid, they shall:

      1. Inform their supervisor
      2. Provide details for the completion of the accident investigation report
      3. Workers shall use the nearest wash facility or eyewash station in the event a worker accidentally spills or splashes injurious chemicals or liquids on their clothing or body

d. **Emergency Medical Treatment**

If a worker sustains a severe injury requiring emergency treatment:

   i. Injured workers should call for help and seek assistance from a co-worker or supervisor immediately.
   ii. A trained first aid provider will render emergency first aid and request assistance for transportation to the local hospital emergency room or other resources as needed.
   iii. Prior to the start of a job, Cooper Steel will ensure that arrangements are in place to transport injured workers from the jobsite to the nearest health care facility.
   iv. The name, address, phone numbers, and maps to occupational medical clinics, and hospital/ERs will be conspicuously posted in the jobsite trailer and listed in the site-specific safety plan and be provided to all employees for response to an emergency condition.
   v. If an ambulance is not available, Cooper Steel will ensure other transportation is available to accommodate the injured. This transportation will:
      1. Be suitable, considering the distance to be travelled and the types of acute illnesses or injuries that may occur at the work site
      2. Protect occupants from the weather

3. Have systems that allow the occupants to communicate with the health care facility to which the injured or ill worker is being taken
4. Be able to accommodate a stretcher and an accompanying person if required

vi. Provide details for the completion of the accident investigation report.

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BLOODBORNE PATHOGENS

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-11
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 VERSION: 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   Cooper Steel recognizes the need to protect all employees against hazards related to bloodborne pathogens. This educational information is to make each employee aware of the OSHA standards and to provide basic information in the recognition and avoidance of unsafe conditions to eliminate, or at the very least, minimize our employee's exposure.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Facilities and Project Sites

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.

4. **Definitions**
   a. Bloodborne pathogens - are microorganisms that are present in human blood and can cause diseases in humans. These pathogens include, but are not limited to, hepatitis B virus (HBV) and human immunodeficiency virus (HIV).
   b. HBV or hepatitis B virus - is a virus which causes liver disease. HBV may severely damage your liver which may lead to cirrhosis and almost certain death.
   c. HIV - is responsible for AIDS, or acquired immunodeficiency syndrome. HIV is transmitted primarily through sexual contact, but also may be transmitted through contact with blood and certain body fluids. Sooner or later, most people infected with HIV contract AIDS. AIDS has no known cure yet.
   d. Universal Precautions - is that all employees shall treat any blood or body fluids as if they are known to be infectious for HBV, HIV, and other bloodborne pathogens.
   e. Exposure Incidents – exposure incident is specific eye, mouth, other mucous membrane, non-intact skin, or parenteral contact with blood or other potentially infectious materials, which result from the performance of an employee's response to an accident.

5. **General**
   It has been determined that there are no job classifications within our company where ALL employees may come into contact with human blood or other potentially infectious materials (OPIM) which may result in possible exposure to bloodborne pathogens. It has also been determined that there are no normal, everyday work activities which involve potential exposure to bloodborne pathogens. It has also been determined that company designated first aid responders primary job assignments are not rendering of first aid.

   Unlike other facilities or operations which may include job classifications or operations where employees may regularly come into contact with human blood or other potentially infectious materials such as saliva and mucous, Cooper Steel's plan was developed to primarily to address any situation where an employee may come into contact with blood or other potentially infectious materials.

   In compliance with OSHA and to protect our employees, Cooper Steel makes available, free of charge and at a reasonable time and place, the hepatitis B vaccination series to designated first aid responders. Any employee who declines the vaccination must sign a declination form (see sample). If, in the future, the employee continues to have occupational exposure to blood or other potentially infectious materials, that employee can receive the vaccination series free of charge.

   All employees are instructed to use proper work practice controls to aid in eliminating or minimizing employee exposure to bloodborne pathogens. The following rules should be observed to eliminate or minimize exposure:
   a. Handwashing facilities must be provided on site. If handwashing facilities are not provided by the Controlling Contractor antiseptic hand cleansers and/or towelettes will be provided.
   b. Employees shall wash their hands immediately after removal of potentially contaminated gloves or other personal protective equipment.
   c. Following any contact of body areas with blood or any OPIM, all employees shall wash their hands and any other exposed skin with soap and water as soon as possible. They must also flush exposed mucous membranes with water.
   d. Eating, drinking, smoking, applying cosmetics, and handling contact lenses is prohibited where there is potential for exposure to bloodborne pathogens.
   e. Equipment which becomes contaminated shall be decontaminated as necessary as soon as possible. If, for any reason equipment cannot be decontaminated, an appropriate biohazard warning label must be attached to the equipment identifying the contaminated portions.

6. **Personal Protective Equipment**
   Personal protective equipment is to be used and considered as a line of defense against any bloodborne pathogen. Cooper Steel provides the personal protective equipment, at no cost to the employee, which is necessary to prevent exposure to bloodborne pathogens. This equipment includes, but not is limited to disposable gloves, aprons, disposable boots, disposable fluid resistant masks, mouthpieces, and respirators. This personal protective equipment is included as part of the emergency first aid equipment provided for Cooper Steel's employees. To ensure that personal protective equipment is used effectively, all employees shall adhere to the following practices when using this equipment:
   a. Any garments penetrated by blood or other infectious materials must be removed immediately, or as soon as possible.
   b. All potentially contaminated personal protective equipment must be removed prior to leaving the area in which it was used.
   c. Disposable gloves shall be worn whenever any employee anticipates hand contact with a potentially infectious material and/or when handling or touching contaminated areas.
   d. Disposable equipment shall be replaces after contamination, or if it is torn or otherwise loses its ability to function as an exposure barrier.
   e. Masks and eye protection must be used whenever splashes or sprays may generate droplets of infectious materials.
   f. Protective clothing must be used whenever potential exposure to the body is anticipated.
   g. Contaminated materials must be disposed of by properly placing items in the biohazard bag provided.

7. **Labels and Signs**
   a. Cooper Steel's biohazard labeling and signage program consists of labeling any contaminated equipment with the appropriate biohazard warnings and using the appropriate containers (red color bags) when disposing of the contaminated waste.
   b. Cooper Steel, Inc., is not affected by the special signage requirements that HIV and HBV research laboratories and other medical facilities are affected by, such as posting biohazard signs at entrances.

8. **Housekeeping**
   a. All equipment and surfaces shall be cleaned and decontaminated after contact with blood or other potentially infectious materials.
   b. All regulated waste such as bandages, gauze, etc., must be discarded or "bagged" in containers that are: closeable, puncture resistant (if the materials discarded have the potential to penetrate the container), leak proof, red in color, or labeled with the appropriate biohazard warning label.
   c. Surfaces contaminated with blood or potentially infected materials shall be decontaminated with the appropriate disinfectant, using household bleach at ten parts water to one part bleach, or bio infectious waste spill kit.

9. **Exposure Incidents**
   An exposure incident is specific eye, mouth, other mucous membrane, non-intact skin, or parenteral contact with blood or other potentially infectious materials, which result from the performance of an employee's response to an accident.
    a. **Exposure Control Plan:** This plan will be provided to all employees upon initial employment and also readily available in the office for review.
        i. Employees must immediately report exposure incidents, to allow for timely medical evaluation and follow up by a health care official.
        ii. All medical reports will be treated in the strictest confidence.
        iii. After consent of obtained from the employee, a prompt request for evaluation of the individual's HIV and HBV status and collecting and testing of exposed employee's blood is initiated by the reported exposure.
        iv. At the time of exposure, the employee must be offered evaluation by a health care professional, who shall receive:
            1. A copy of the bloodborne pathogen standard
            2. Description of employee's job duties as the relate to the incident
            3. Report of the specific exposure
            4. Relevant employee medical records, including Hepatitus B vaccination reports
            5. If the source is known to be infectious for HIV or HBV, testing need not be repeated
            6. The exposed employee will be provided with the test results and information about applicable disclosure laws and regulations.
            7. Following the post-exposure evaluation, the health care professional shall provide a written opinion to Cooper Steel. This opinion is limited to a statement that the employee has been informed of the results of the evaluation, and told of the need, if any, for further evaluation or treatment. All other findings are confidential. Cooper Steel must provide a copy of the written opinion to the employee within fifteen (15) days of the evaluation.

10. **Recordkeeping**
    A confidential medical record for each employee with potential for exposure will be maintained by Cooper Steel, according to OSHA's rule governing access to employee medical records. The records must be kept for the duration of employment plus 30 years:
    a. Employee's name and social security number
    b. Copy of employee's hepatitis B vaccination status and any medical records related to the employee's ability to receive vaccinations.
    c. Results of examinations, medical testing and post exposure evaluation and follow up procedures.
    d. Copy of information provided to health care professional

11. **Training**

Cooper Steel shall ensure that all workers with occupational exposure participate in a training program in accordance with local jurisdiction. Training is conducted for all workers with occupational exposure before initial assignment and within 1 year of previous training. Training shall include:

a. What bloodborne pathogens are; how to protect themselves from exposure
b. Methods of warnings (signs, labels, etc.)
c. The requirements of the bloodborne pathogens program
d. The Hepatitis B vaccine and vaccine series will be made available to all workers who have an occupational exposure. It must be made available within 10 working days of the initial assignment if there is an occupational exposure. If workers decline the vaccination, they must sign a statement of declination.
e. The Hepatitis B vaccine shall be made available to all workers that have occupational exposure at no cost to the worker(s)

HEPATITIES B VACCINATION DECLINATION FORM

FATIGUE MANAGEMENT POLICY

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-12
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   To ensure Cooper Steel employees recognize the effect of fatigue as related to safely being able to perform work and to establish guidelines for work hours and equipment to reduce fatigue in our business and at our client locations.

2. **Scope**
   This program applies to all Cooper Steel employees.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.
      i. Responsible for the implementation of this fatigue management policy.
      ii. Responsible for the implementation and maintenance of this program for their facility/site and ensuring all assets are made available for compliance with the program.
   b. Employees
      i. Must present in a fit state, free from alcohol and drugs.
      ii. Must not chronically use over the counter or prescription drugs to increase mental alertness.
      iii. Prohibited from taking any substance known to increase fatigue in that employee, including fatigue that sets in after the effects of the drug wear off.
      iv. Shall report tiredness/fatigue and lack of mental acuity to supervisor and supervisor shall take appropriate action to assist the employee.
      v. Must be rested prior to starting work.
      vi. Must monitor their own performance and take regular periods of rest to avoid continuing work when tired.
4. **Policy**
   a. The guiding principles of fatigue management shall be incorporated into the normal management functions of the business and include the following:
      i. Employees must be in a fit state to start work
      ii. Employees must be fit to complete work
      iii. Employees must take minimum periods of rest to safely perform their work

b. These principles will be managed through:
    i. The appropriate planning of work tasks;
    ii. Providing appropriate equipment to help reduce stress and fatigue;
    iii. Regular medical checkups and monitoring of health issues as required by legislation;
    iv. The provision of appropriate accommodation where required and available; and
    v. Ongoing training and awareness of worker health and fatigue issues

5. Procedures

a. Work Hour Limitations

Cooper Steel has set the following work hour limitations and will control job rotation schedules to control fatigue, allow for sufficient sleep and to increase mental fitness.

i. Breaks - Employees working six (6) or more hours in one day will be scheduled for an unpaid lunch period of at least 30 minutes. Additional breaks will be given if required by State/local regulations.
    1. Additional breaks may be given at the discretion of management.

ii. Driving - Property Carrying Drivers
    1. 30-Minute Driving Break - Drivers must take a 30-minute break when they have driven for a period of 8 cumulative hours without at least a 30-minute interruption.
    2. 11-Hour Driving Limit – Employees may drive a maximum of 11 hours after 10 consecutive hours off duty.
    3. 14-Hour Limit – Employees may not drive beyond the 14th consecutive hour after coming on duty, following 10 consecutive hours off duty. Off-duty time does not extend the 14-hour period.

b. Equipment and Evaluation

Cooper Steel will provide equipment such as anti-fatigue mats for standing, lift assist devices for repetitive lifting, and other ergonomic devices as deemed appropriate. Cooper Steel will also periodically analyze and evaluate work tasks to control fatigue.

6. Training

Cooper Steel is committed to ensuring that all employees are competent to perform their tasks. Cooper Steel will provide initial and annual training on how to recognize and control fatigue through appropriate work and personal habits, and report fatigue to supervision.

A record of individual fatigue training and competency will be maintained by Cooper Steel.

RECORDS RETENTION

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-13
SUPERSEDES: VERSION: 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. The purpose of this policy is to provide employees and their designated representatives with a right of access to relevant exposure and medical records.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all employee exposure and medical records, and analyses thereof, made or maintained in any manner.

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.

4. **Medical Records**
    a. **Medical records** are records concerning the health status of a worker which are made or maintained by a physician, nurse or other health care provider or technician.
    Medical records consist of:
        i. Medical questionnaires or histories;
        ii. The results of medical examinations and laboratory tests (including chest and other X-ray examinations taken for the purposes of establishing a baseline or detecting occupational illness, and all biological monitoring not defined as an "employee exposure record");
        iii. Medical opinions, diagnoses, progress notes, and recommendations;
        iv. First aid records;
        v. Descriptions of treatments and prescriptions; and
        vi. Employee medical complaints.

5. **Notification**
    a. Employees will be briefed upon initial employment and, at least annually thereafter, informed via a bulletin board or community location posting of the following:
        i. The existence, location, and availability of employee records for exposure to toxic substances or harmful physical agents;
        ii. The person responsible for maintaining and providing access to the records; The employee's right of access to those records; and
        iii. The availability of the entire section pertaining to records retention.

6. **Record Keeping**
    a. The Human Resources Department is responsible for maintaining and providing access to employees' occupational medical records. These records are kept separately from other employee records. All medical records will be retained pursuant to local, company and jurisdictional requirements including:
        i. Biological monitoring—level of chemical in the blood, urine, hair, fingernails, etc.
    b. Employee exposure records shall be maintained by the Safety Department for the duration of employment and for 30 years thereafter and should include the following:
        i. Environmental (workplace) monitoring including personal, area, grab, swipe (wipe over a designated area), etc. type samples.
        ii. Safety data sheets or a chemical inventory or any other record which reveals where and when used and the identity (e.g., chemical, common, or trade name) of a toxic substance or harmful physical agent.
    c. Upon written request from an approved requestor such as a local or federal jurisdiction, Cooper Steel will remove all personal identifiers before releasing the medical/exposure records.

7. **Access**
    Each employee or designated representative has the right to request access to his/her records. Cooper Steel shall ensure that access is provided in a reasonable time, place, and manner.
    a. The employee may access his/her records by making a written request to the Human Resources Department and or the Safety Department.
    b. The Human Resources Department will release an employee's medical records only if the employee has given specific, written consent.

c. If Cooper Steel cannot reasonably provide access to the record within fifteen (15) working days, the company shall within the fifteen (15) working days apprise the employee or designated representative requesting the record of the reason for the delay and the earliest date when the record can be made available.
    i. There will be no charge to the employee for copies of records provided in response to an initial request; however, shipping costs may apply. Cooper Steel may charge reasonable, non-discriminatory administrative costs (i.e., search and copying expenses) for a request by the employee or designated representative for additional copies of the record.
    ii. There will be no charge for an initial request for a copy of new information that has been added to a record which was previously provided.
    iii. There will be no charge for an initial request by a recognized or certified collective bargaining agent for a copy of a employee exposure record or an analysis using exposure or medical records.

14 JEWELRY POLICY

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-14
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   a. Cooper Steel is committed to providing a safe and healthy working environment and to protecting the health and safety of all people while they are at work. The occupational health, safety and welfare of the individual is the prime consideration when determining the suitability of any cosmetic jewelry. This includes the likelihood and consequences of this jewelry being caught in machinery, protruding objects, or on material being handled.
   b. There is a risk of accident or personal injury due to uncovered jewelry. Serious injuries have occurred from contact with hazards such as electricity, moving equipment / machinery, hot surfaces and because of catching rings while climbing, etc.

2. **Scope**
   a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel employees.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The VP of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and will review all necessary health and safety information.
   d. Employees shall conform to the requirements of this policy.

4. **Policy**
   a. This policy provides a guide to the minimum standards relating to the wearing of jewelry in the work environment for all Employees, Contractors and Visitors to the Cooper Steel Fabrication Facility and any Project Site.
   b. Personnel in administrative jobs with no exposure to workplaces outside of the office environment are exempt from the requirements of this policy. However, when entering those active work areas, compliance with this policy is mandatory.

5. **Definition**
   a. Jewelry refers to finger rings, earrings, studs, facial attachments such as chains and rings, bracelets (including medical bracelets), necklaces and watches.

6. **Procedure Details**
    a. **<u>Necklaces</u>** must be always worn inside the shirt and must not be permitted to fall out.
    b. **<u>Bracelets</u>** must not be worn except for Medic Alert type medical bracelets.
    c. **<u>Rings</u>** are not permitted to be worn (nonmetallic “tear away” rings are permitted).
    d. **<u>Earrings</u>** must be small, stud or sleeper type (no hanging components).
    e. **<u>Piercings</u>** that risk entanglement or injury must be removed.
    f. **<u>Watches</u>** should be completely covered by clothing cuffs. Watchstraps should be fitted with a quick release catch (no buckle type watch bands).

15 ERGONOMIC SAFETY

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-15
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 VERSION: 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. The purpose of this policy is to minimize and control ergonomic hazards in the workplace to prevent musculoskeletal disorders (MSDs) and foster a healthier and more productive work environment.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Employees

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The VP of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.

4. **Planning**
    a. Proper lifting technique is critical to back safety, but perhaps more important is proper planning. Before you lift an object, take a moment to consider your action:
        i. Do you need to lift the item manually?
        ii. How heavy is it?
        iii. Where are you moving the item from?
        iv. Where does it have to go?
        v. What route do you have to follow?
    b. Many times the item you are moving could be moved with a piece of equipment – a dolly, hand truck, a forklift, or a crane. Consider using mechanical help wherever possible. If the item needs to be moved manually, and it is heavy or ungainly, ask for help. Use mechanical help if the object weighs more than 75 pounds, or 75 pounds per person if more than one person is involved. If there is a question to the weight of the object, then use mechanical assistance.
    c. When using mechanical help, remember to push, not pull. You will have more control and greater leverage. Fasten the load to the equipment, so sudden stops or vibration don't jar it off.
    d. When rotating material manually:
        i. Do not exceed 75lbs. of force in any direction.
        ii. Only use certified and approved hand tools to assist in rotating material.

    iii. Only use mechanical equipment (crane, forklift, material rotation equipment) to rotate material heavier than 500lbs.

e. When moving an item from a hard-to-reach place, be sure to position yourself as close to the load as possible. Slide it out to get it closer and be sure that you have adequate room for your hands and arms. Be aware of adjacent obstructions, on either side or above the load.
f. Think about where the item will be placed before you've lifted it. Will it be overhead? Under an overhang? In a narrow spot? Try to allow yourself as much room as possible to set the load down. You can always shift it slightly later.
g. Check your path from place to place – remove tripping hazards, protect openings, set up a well wheel or bucket and line if you need to get materials up a ladder. Make sure that the lighting is sufficient to see where you are going. Stabilize uneven or loose ground, or choose an alternate route. The shortest way isn't always the fastest or the safest.

5. **Balance**
    a. As in life in general, moderation and balance are important considerations in care and maintenance of your back. You need to correct proportions of strength, flexibility, and overall quality of life to eliminate back injuries.
    b. Exercise, diet, and flexibility all contribute to help prevent back injuries and also help in recovering from any injuries. In addition, a reduction in stress levels can help to relieve the muscle tension that can contribute to injuries. Remember that most back injuries can be attributed to one of these five causes:
        i. Posture
        ii. Body Mechanics/Work Habits
        iii. Stressful Living
        iv. Loss of flexibility
        v. Poor Conditioning
    c. Also consider that not all back injuries are a result of sudden trauma, most are of a cumulative type, where a repeated minor injury has flared up, or continued use of a heavy tool in the same position has caused pain, or a great deal to time is spent in the same position.

6. **Technique**
    a. Stand close to the load
    b. Grip firmly
    c. Bring the load close to your body
    d. Lift head and shoulders first, and with your back straight, use your legs to slowly and smoothly lift
    e. Make sure you can see over the load
    f. DON'T TWIST YOUR BODY. Torquing action can be especially dangerous. Move your feet first to change direction.
    g. Bend your knees to lower the load
    h. Keep your fingers from under the load

i. Lower slowly and smoothly
j. When in doubt, ASK FOR HELP!

7. **Conclusion**
   a. Care and maintenance of your back is every bit as important as the care and maintenance of your vehicle, your home, or your tools, but this most important asset of our physical being is commonly overlooked or neglected.
   b. Your back is the foundation and the structure upon which the rest of your body relies for balance and support. Used improperly, or unsafely, your back can suffer injuries that can literally change the way you live.
   c. Care of your back is a lifelong endeavor that requires commitment, intelligence, and common sense.

8. **Training**
   a. Field Safety Directors, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers will ensure that all applicable employees are trained in the requirements of this policy. Training shall be documented, and training records shall be maintained on file.

SAFETY AUDIT PROGRAM

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-16
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   a. Workplace safety audits are a systematic, ongoing and periodic review of the entire occupational safety management system of Cooper Steel, Including the policy and programs used to promote healthy and safe workplaces and prevent workplace accidents/incidents and work-related illnesses.
   b. Audits are conducted to determine the effectiveness of management systems and to identify the strengths and opportunities for improvements. The initial safety audit can be used to establish standards against which future audits can be measured. An audit will also provide an objective outlook of the status of occupational health and safety management system within the workplace.

2. **Scope**
   a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel offices, facilities, and project sites

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. Safety department personnel and supervisors are responsible for performing periodic safety audits. Frequency will be determined by the Safety Director. Safety audits will be performed in the following areas:
      i. Field Project Sites (per OSHA 1926 Construction Standards)
      ii. Fabrication Facility (per OSHA 1910 General Industry Standards and OSHA 1926 Construction Standards as applicable)
      iii. Office Facilities (per OSHA 1910 General Industry Standards)
   c. Safety audits will be made available and will be reviewed by executive management. Trending audit results will be reviewed quarterly at safety department meetings.

FIRE PROTECTION AND PREVENTION

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-17
SUPERSEDES: Rev.9 **VERSION:** 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   Fire Prevention/Protection Policy is intended to provide compliance with all related regulations and standard safe work practice. The purpose of the policy is to prevent fires and to provide guidelines for action if a fire does occur.
   - **a.** Fire prevention program combines the following policies:
     - **i.** PPE Policy
     - **ii.** Electrical Safety Policy
     - **iii.** Emergency Action Plan
   - **b.** These policies encompass methods used for incidence avoidance, incident response and specialized training required in the event of a fire.
   - **c.** Issues addressed in the above policies include, but are not limited to:
     - **i.** Evacuation Procedure
     - **ii.** Extinguisher Training
     - **iii.** Hot Work Safety Training
     - **iv.** Emergency Life Support Training
     - **v.** Assured Grounding Programs

2. **Scope**
   - a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel facilities, sites, and office locations.

3. **Responsibilities**
   - a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   - b. VP of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facility Safety, and Facility Safety Manager:
     - i. Has overall responsibility for compliance to this policy. Communicates to employees those parts of the fire prevention policy necessary for self-protection.
     - ii. Ensure fire suppression systems are periodically inspected and maintained to a high degree of working order.
     - iii. Provide employees adequate training on the use of fire extinguishers and evacuation routes and procedures.
     - iv. Maintain compliance with all applicable laws, codes, and local regulations.
   - c. Employees:
     - i. Report emergencies.
     - ii. Comply with Cooper Steels policy on smoking.
     - iii. Always observe all “No Smoking” posted areas, smoking is also prohibited in the vicinity of operations that pose a fire hazard.
     - iv. Smoking is prohibited within 50 feet of any fueling operation, or fuel transfer.
     - v. All personal items (fans, radios, space heaters, etc.) must be approved

for use.

vi. Observe practices for storage, use and handling of flammable/combustible liquids.
vii. Follow precautions and identify violations of this fire prevention policy.

4. **Policy**

Workers shall be informed of the proper actions to take in the event of a fire. This includes, but is not limited to, notification and evacuation procedures. It is STRESSED that at no time does the task of fighting fire supersede an employee's primary duties of:

a. Ensuring their own personal safety and the safety of others.
b. Reporting the incident to the proper authority and ensuring personnel accountability for yourself and all subordinates in accordance with company and client policy.

5. **Prevention**

a. The volume of flammable and combustible liquids in the area of use shall not exceed one day's estimated requirements.
b. Drums of flammable liquids used for dispensing purposes must be properly grounded and transfer of flammable liquids shall be done with bonding cables to prevent accumulation of static electricity.
c. Ordinary combustibles shall not be stored in the vicinity of flammable and combustible liquids.
d. Survey existing and planned operations for fire and explosion potentials:
e. Identify the flammable and combustible materials to be used or brought into areas in containers. Change the materials and methods as practical to reduce the risk.
f. Identify potential sources of heat that could ignite fires. Remove, isolate or safeguard as appropriate and practical.
g. Facility Design:
    i. Provide and maintain emergency exits and adequate routes of egress to meet or exceed the life safety codes.
    ii. Provide fire barriers to protect vital records and high value equipment or materials.

6. **Procedures**

a. Adequate aisles shall be provided and maintained for unobstructed exit and movement of personnel and fire protection equipment at all times.
b. Storage practices shall provide adequate aisles for exits, access for firefighting equipment, and operation of fire doors.
c. All workers are responsible for good housekeeping practices to enhance fire prevention methods.
d. Supervisors will be held accountable for the housekeeping of their facilities or job sites.
e. Only properly rated fuel tanks and/or safety cans will be used during fueling operations.

i. A safety can is an approved self-closing container of not more than 5-gallon capacity, having a flash-arresting screen, spring loaded lid and spout cover, so designed that it will safely relieve internal pressure when subjected to fire exposure.
ii. Fuel tanks are to be protected from impact by vehicles and equipment. This is to be done by means of concrete barriers or location away from such traffic.
iii. Fuel storage tanks shall have a spill containment system capable of containing the full contents of the tank. This containment system may be a double-walled tank or containment bin.

f. Each fueling area shall have at least one fire extinguisher having a rating of at least 20BC located no closer than 25 feet nor more than 75 feet from the fueling area.
g. The motors of all equipment being fueled shall be shut off during the fueling operation.
h. Combustible and flammable liquids shall be handled and stored in approved containers, cabinets, and areas that are designed for fire prevention. All combustible and flammable materials will be handled and stored in compliance with applicable regulations and client requirements. The quantity of flammable/combustible material shall be kept to a minimum on the job site.
i. Welding, cutting, and grinding sparks shall be contained.
j. Hot work areas shall be clear of combustible materials a minimum distance of 35’, and a fire extinguisher will maintained in close proximity.
k. Oily rags shall be immediately disposed of in designated hazardous waste containers.
l. Report all spills or suspicious odors immediately.

7. Fire Extinguishers

a. A fire extinguisher shall be provided for each 3,000 square feet of the protected area.
b. Maintain portable fire extinguisher access so that travel distance to an extinguisher is no greater than 100 feet.
c. Access to fire extinguishers shall remain clear at all times.
d. Fire extinguishers shall not be rated less than 2A.
e. A fire extinguisher shall be attached to, or adjacent to each welding machine, aerial lift, forklift, and cranes.
f. A fire extinguisher rated not less than 10B shall be provided within 50 feet where more than 5 pounds of flammable gas or more than 5 gallons of flammable or combustible liquid is used.
g. Fire extinguishers must have an inspection tag attached and be maintained in a fully charged, ready to operate state. Portable fire extinguishers are to be inspected monthly and annually with documentation supporting the inspection and maintenance schedule.
h. Types of Fire Extinguishers
    i. **Water** - extinguisher for ordinary combustible fires
    ii. **Dry Chemical or CO2** - extinguisher for electrical equipment

fires and for flammable liquid fires

iii. **Multipurpose Dry Chemical** - extinguisher for ordinary combustible fires, liquid fires, and electrical equipment fires

iv. **Foam** - extinguishing agent for hydrocarbon fires

8. **Training**

Initial and annual training will be provided to all workers who use or may use fire extinguishers. Fire extinguisher training will include general principles of fire and extinguisher use, inspection, and the hazards involved with incipient stage firefighting including the PASS procedure:

- **a. PULL** the pin, this unlocks the operating lever and allows you to discharge the extinguisher.
- **b. AIM** low, point the extinguisher nozzle (or hose) at the base of the fire.
- **c. SQUEEZE** the lever, this discharges the extinguishing agent, releasing the lever will stop the discharge.
- **d. SWEEP** from side to side, move carefully toward the fire, keep the extinguisher aimed at the base of the fire, and sweep back and forth until the flames are out.

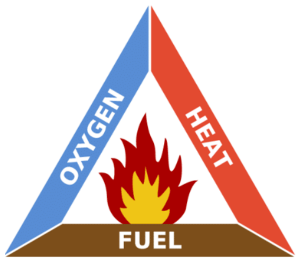
Training records will be maintained by the Safety Training Administrator.

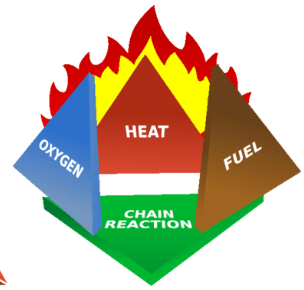
9. **In the Event of a Fire**

- **a.** Remain calm
- **b.** Only extinguish a fire when it is clearly within your abilities and the equipment available
- **c.** Know the location of the nearest alarm and how to activate the emergency system
- **d.** Know the evacuation routes and collection points
- **e.** If the fire cannot be extinguished, leave the area immediately and report to your evacuation area
- **f.** Await further instructions from your supervisor, or designated responsible personnel
- **g. NEVER** put yourself or others at risk while attempting to extinguish an incipient fire.
- **h. NEVER** attempt to extinguish a pressurized fuel fed fire.
- **i. DO NOT** direct a fire nozzle with a straight stream at any type of LPG fire. This action could extinguish the fire, producing an LPG vapor cloud capable of detonation.
- **j. DO NOT APPLY** water to any acid or caustic release as it can cause a violent reaction. Additionally, low concentration acids or caustics become extremely corrosive, causing an increasing leak condition.

10. **Basic Fire Science**

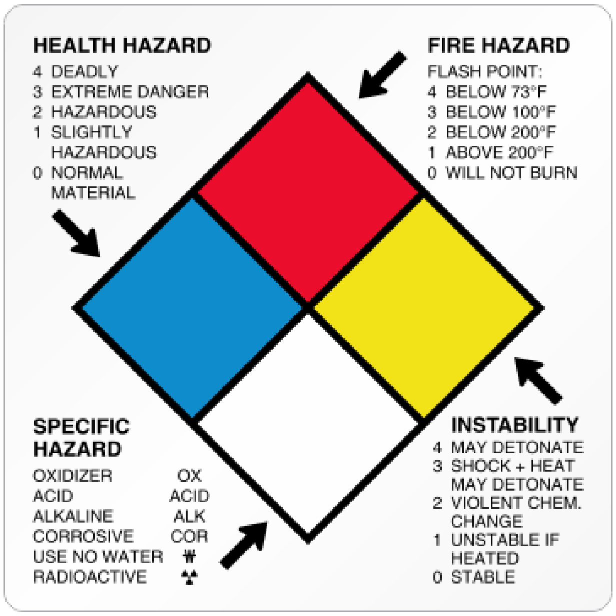
The combination of fuel, heat, oxygen equals the well-known fire triangle. To understand fire better, a fourth factor is added, a molecular chain reaction. This is due to the fact that fire results from a series of reactions in which complicated molecules “crack” into easily oxidized fragments. Disruption of this chain, along with the removal of fuel, heat or oxygen, is recognized as a method of fire extinguishment through the use of dry chemical extinguishers.





a. **Heat Energy** - Can be produced by building up molecules (composition) or breaking apart (decomposition) by heat or a solution when materials are dissolved in a liquid, or by combustion.
b. **Heat Transfer** - A law of physics states that heat tends to flow up from a hot substance or place to a cold substance or place. This is through conduction (transfer of heat through a medium such as metals) or through convection (transfer of heat with a medium-usually circulatory).
c. **Fuels** - Those substances that will burn when heat is applied. The most common fuels are not pure elements such as carbon, but compounds and mixtures such as paper and wood.
d. **Oxygen** - Atmospheric oxygen is the major source of oxygen that supports combustion. Oxygen itself does not burn, however, without it, combustion is impossible. Normal burning is the combination of fuels with oxygen under the influence of heat.
e. **Combustion** - A rapid oxidation or chemical combination accompanied by heat.
f. **Oxidation** - The ability of materials to produce oxygen during a chemical reaction.
g. **Spontaneous Combustion** - When oxidation is allowed to occur, enough oxygen is available, heat is produced, molecules become more energetic and combine with oxygen at an increasing rate, temperatures rise, and visible heat (flames) are produced.
h. **Classes of Fires**
    i. Class A - **Ordinary combustibles (wood/paper/textiles)**
    ii. Class B - **Flammable liquids (gasoline/oils/grease)**
    iii. Class C - **Live electric (wiring/generators/motors)**
    iv. Class D - **Combustible metals (finely divided form/chips, turnings)**
    v. Class K – **Kitchen (oils/grease)**

NFPA Diamond:



18

STOP WORK AUTHORITY

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-18

SUPERSEDES: VERSION: 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. The purpose of this policy is to ensure that all workers are given the responsibility and authority to Stop Work when they believe that a situation exists that places them, coworker(s), contractors, or the public at risk or in danger pertaining to the service provided by Cooper Steel. A worker's responsibility and authority to Stop Work also includes situations that, if allowed to continue, could adversely affect the safe operation, or cause serious damage to a facility or equipment, or adversely affect the environment.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel locations, project sites, maintenance, and fabrication facilities. It is applicable to all Cooper Steel employees working at these locations

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy, monitors compliance of the SWA program, and ensures workers and contractors initiate stop work and support stop work initiated by others.
    c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary facility and project specific health and safety information.
    d. All workers have the right and obligation to stop any job or task when there are questions or concerns regarding the control of hazards or unsafe acts.
    e. Management establishes a culture that promotes SWA and supports use of SWA without potential for retribution, supervisors, and managers honor SWA requests and resolve before resuming operations.

4. **Procedures**
    a. A Stop Work intervention should be initiated for conditions or behaviors that could reasonably be expected to pose a risk or danger to worker(s), safe operation of a facility, serious damage to equipment or adversely affect the environment. Situations that warrant a Stop Work intervention may include, but are not limited to the following:
        i. Unsafe conditions
        ii. Change in conditions

iii. Changes to scope of work or work plan
iv. Equipment used improperly
v. Lack of knowledge, understanding or information
vi. To clarify work instructions
vii. To propose additional controls

b. Any Stop Work issue(s) requiring corrective action(s) to resolve the issue(s), shall be documented on a Stop Work Authority Form (Attachment A) or through EHS Insight.

5. Steps of Stop Work Authority

a. Stop - When a worker(s) perceives conditions or behaviors that pose imminent danger, they must immediately initiate a stop work intervention.
    i. Workers are protected from retribution or reprimand for exercising SWA. Any form of retribution or reprimand will not be tolerated against workers who exercise SWA.
b. Notify - Notify affected workers and supervision of the stop work action.
c. Investigate - Affected workers will discuss the situation and come to an agreement on the stop work action.
    i. No work can resume once SWA is exercised until all issues and concerns have been addressed.
d. Correct – Take immediate or as soon as possible actions to rectify the known unsafe act or condition
    i. Corrective actions - Will be made according to the corrections agreed upon in the investigation to prevent a recurrence of the unsafe act or condition.
e. Resume - All affected workers will be notified of what corrective actions were implemented and work will resume only when it is safe to do so.

6. Documentation

a. All SWA when exercised must be documented for lessons learned and corrective actions.
b. All SWA occurrences shall be documented to evaluate the effectiveness of the program and identify areas for improvement.
c. Management must review SWA reports to measure participation, establish the quality of SWA interventions, and corrective actions, establish trends, discover opportunities for improvement, and establish lessons learned.
d. Cooper Steel places a high importance of follow-up after a Stop Work Intervention has been initiated and closed. It is the desired outcome of any Stop Work Intervention that the identified safety concern(s) have been addressed to the satisfaction of all involved workers prior to the resumption of work. Most issues can be adequately resolved in a timely manner at the work site, occasionally additional investigation and corrective actions may be required to identify, address and correct root causes.

7. **Training**
   All workers will be trained on SWA prior to their initial assignment. The training will be documented in the Cooper Steel LMS and include the workers' name and date of training.

19 WORKING IN INCLEMENT WEATHER

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-19
SUPERSEDES: VERSION: 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. Working in extreme temperatures (hot or cold) can overwhelm the body's internal temperature control system. When the body is unable to warm or cool itself, heat or cold related stress can result. Heat and cold stress can contribute to adverse health effects which range in severity from discomfort to death.
    b. This program is intended to minimize the effects of heat and cold stress on Cooper Steel employees. This program contains the procedures and practices for safely working in temperature extremes.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel employees exposed to heat and cold stress environments.

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy including: provide monitoring, upon request, and assist employees with the development of procedures to minimize the adverse effects of heat and cold stress in the workplace.
    c. Supervisors - Each supervisor managing employees exposed to heat and/or cold stress has the following responsibilities:
        i. Review and comply with the provisions outlined in this program.
        ii. Assess the day-to-day heat or cold stresses on employees.
        iii. Assess employees' workload and assigning work and rest schedules as needed.
        iv. Ensure all employees have the appropriate personal protective equipment (PPE) prior to working in extreme temperature conditions.
        v. Ensure employees are familiar with this safety program.
    d. Employees - Employees exposed to heat and/or cold stress when performing their job duties have the following responsibilities:
        i. Review and comply with the provisions outlined in this program.
        ii. Wear the appropriate PPE.
        iii. Report heat and cold stress concerns to their supervisor.

4. **Heat-Related Illnesses: Signs, Treatment, and Prevention**
    a. **Signs and Treatment**
    While working in hot conditions, the human body may not be able to maintain a normal temperature just by sweating. If this happens, heat-related illnesses may occur. The most common health problems caused by hot work environments include:
        i. **Heat stroke** – This is the most serious heat related effect. Heat stroke occurs when the body temperature increases above 104 degrees F. Signs and symptoms of heat stroke are confusion, loss of consciousness, seizures, and lack of perspiration. This condition must be treated as a medical emergency and the employee must receive immediate medical attention. While waiting on medical assistance, the victim should be moved to a cool/shaded area, cooled with water/wet towels/ice packs, and fanned to increase cooling.
        ii. **Heat exhaustion** – Signs and symptoms of heat exhaustion include headache, nausea, dizziness, weakness, irritability, confusion, thirst, heavy perspiration and a body temperature greater than 100.4 degrees F. Employees experiencing heat exhaustion should be moved to a cool area, given fluids to drink and given cold compresses for their head, face and neck. Employees should also be taken to a clinic or emergency room to be monitored by medical personnel.
        iii. **Heat cramps** – Signs and symptoms of heat cramps include muscle pains usually caused by the loss of body salts/fluids, this can happen later as well. Employees should replace fluid loss by drinking water and/or carbohydrate-electrolyte replacement liquids every 15 to 20 minutes. If cramps are severe, seek medical attention.
        iv. **Heat rash** – Heat rash is caused by excessive perspiration and looks like a red cluster of pimples or small blisters. Heat rash usually appears on the neck, upper chest, in the groin, under the breasts and in elbow creases.
        v. **Dehydration** – Dehydration is a major factor in most heat disorders. Signs and symptoms of dehydration include increasing thirst, dry mouth, weakness or light-headedness (particularly if worse upon standing), and a darkening of the urine or a decrease in urination. Dehydration can be reversed or put back in balance by drinking fluids that contain electrolytes that are lost during work related activities. Avoid caffeinated drinks.
    b. **Prevention**
    While heat related illnesses are dangerous and potentially life threating, they can be prevented. Prevention methods include:
        i. **Acclimation** – Acclimation is a process by which the physical processes of an employee's body adjusts to the environment over a period of time. This process usually takes five to seven days. This

process could take up to three weeks depending on the individual and their work environment. The process requires a consistent work level for at least two hours each day during the acclimation period in order for an employee to become acclimatized. Mere exposure to heat does not confer acclimatization, nor does acclimatization at one heat stress level confer resistance to heat stress at a higher temperature or more vigorous workload. Employees who are not adequately acclimatized to the heat may experience temporary heat fatigue resulting in a decline in performance, coordination or alertness. They may also become irritable or depressed. This can be prevented through gradual adjustment to the hot environment. People in good physical condition tend to acclimatize better because their cardiovascular systems respond better.

ii. **Engineering Controls** – For employees working indoors, the best way to prevent heat-related illness is to make the work environment cooler. Where and if possible, use air conditioning to cool the work area. Alternatively, increase the general ventilation as much as possible by opening windows or doors. When available, use cooling fans to aid in increasing ventilation.

iii. **Safe Work Practices** – For employees working outdoors or working indoors without air conditioning or ventilation, take scheduled breaks in cool areas. Ensure there is plenty of cool water to drink and take water breaks as needed. Immediately report any problems to a supervisor. Supervisors should consider scheduling the hottest work for the coolest part of day, assigning extra employees to high demand tasks, and using work-saving devices (e.g. power tools, hoists or lifting aids) to reduce the body's workload. All employees should watch out for the safety of their coworkers.

c. **Heat Index** – The Heat Index is a single numeric value that uses both temperature and humidity to inform the public on how the weather outdoors "feels". The higher the Heat Index, the hotter the weather feels. The following protocol will be followed by employees working in hot conditions:

i. **Level 1 <91° Heat Index**

1. Take short breaks as needed.
2. Remain hydrated.
3. Monitor changing weather conditions and temperature increases.

ii. **Level 2 91°-103° Heat Index**

1. Continue Level 1 precautions.
2. Employees should drink one pint of water per hour.
3. Increase electrolyte intake (Gatorade/Squencher, etc.).
4. Increase monitoring of workers for signs of heat illness and use the "Buddy System".

5. Train workers on signs of heat related illness.
6. Plan strenuous work for cooler times of the day.
7. Cool down areas including shade and ventilation are to be established.

iii. **Level 3 >103° Heat Index**

1. Continue Level 1 and 2 precautions.
2. Alert workers of high-risk conditions and Level 3 precautions.
3. Mandatory 10-minute break in cool down area every 90 minutes or as needed in between.
4. Mandatory supervisor monitoring/check-in of workers for signs of heat illness.

5. **Cold-Related Illnesses and Injuries: Signs, Treatment, and Prevention**

a. **Signs and Treatment**

During cold weather, an employee's body will use energy to maintain a normal internal body temperature. This will result in a shift of blood flow from employee's extremities (hands, feet and legs) and outer skin to the employee's core (chest and abdomen). If this happens, cold-related illnesses and injuries may occur if exposed to cold conditions for an extended period. The most common health problems caused by cold work environments include:

i. **Hypothermia** – Hypothermia is a potentially serious health condition. Hypothermia occurs when body heat is lost faster than it can be replaced. When the core body temperature drops to approximately 95°F, the onset of symptoms normally begins. The employee may begin to shiver, lose coordination, have slurred speech, and fumble with items in the hand. The employee's skin will likely be pale and cold. As the body temperature continues to fall these symptoms will worsen and shivering will stop. Once the body temperature falls to around 85°F severe hypothermia will develop and the person may become unconscious, and at 78°F, vital organs may begin to fail.
Treatment depends on the severity of the hypothermia. For cases of mild hypothermia move to warm area and stay active. Remove wet clothes and replace with dry clothes or blankets, cover the head. To promote metabolism and assist in raising internal core temperature drink a warm (not hot) sugary drink. Avoid drinks with caffeine. For more severe cases do all the above, plus contact emergency medical personnel, cover all extremities completely, place very warm objects, such as hot packs or water bottles on the victim's head, neck, chest and groin. Arms and legs should be warmed last. In cases of severe hypothermia, treat the employee very gently and do not apply external heat to rewarm. Hospital treatment is required.

ii. **Frostbite** – Frostbite occurs when the skin freezes and loses water. In severe cases, amputation of the frostbitten area may be required. While frostbite usually occurs when the temperatures are 30° F or lower, wind chill factors can allow frostbite to occur in above freezing temperatures. Frostbite typically affects the extremities, particularly the feet and hands. The affected body part will be cold, tingling, stinging or aching followed by numbness. Skin color turns red, then purple, then white, and is cold to the touch. There may be blisters in severe cases. Do not rub the area to warm it. Wrap the area in a soft cloth, move the employee to a warm area, and contact medical personnel. Do not leave the employee alone. If help is delayed, immerse in warm (maximum 105 °F), not hot, water. Do not pour water directly on affected part. If there is a chance that the affected part will get cold again do not warm. Repeated heating and cooling of the skin may cause severe tissue damage.

iii. **Trench Foot** – Trench Foot is caused by having feet exposed to damp, unsanitary and cold conditions including water at temperatures above freezing for long periods of time. It is similar to frostbite but considered less severe. Symptoms usually consist of tingling, itching or burning sensation. Blisters may be present. For treatment, soak feet in warm water, then wrap with dry cloth bandages. Drink a warm, sugary drink. Seek medical attention if necessary.

iv. **Dehydration** – It is easy to become dehydrated during cold weather. Signs of dehydration include increasing thirst, dry mouth, weakness or light-headedness (particularly if worse upon standing), and a darkening of the urine or a decrease in urination. Dehydration can be reversed or put back in balance by drinking fluids that contain electrolytes that are lost during work related activities. Avoid caffeinated drinks

b. **Prevention**
Just as with heat related illness, cold related illnesses and injuries are dangerous and potentially life threating, however, they can be prevented. Prevention methods include:

c. **Acclimation**
Employees exposed to the cold should be physically fit, without any circulatory, metabolic, or neurologic diseases that may place them at increased risk for hypothermia. New employees should be introduced to the work schedule slowly and be trained accordingly.

d. **Engineering Controls**
For employees working indoors, the best way to prevent cold-related illness is to make the work environment warmer. Where and if possible, use heaters to warm the work area.

e. **Safe Work Practices**
For employees working outdoors or working indoors without heat, take scheduled breaks in warm areas. Ensure there is plenty of water to drink and take water breaks as needed. Immediately report any problems to a supervisor. Supervisors should consider scheduling the most work during the warmest part of day, assigning extra employees to high demand tasks that will require longer periods in cold areas. All employees should watch out for the safety of their coworkers.

f. **Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)**
PPE is an important factor in preventing cold stress related illnesses and injuries. Employees should adhere to the following recommendations when dressing for work in a cold environment:

i. Wear at least three layers of clothing; an inner layer of wool, silk or synthetic to wick moisture away from the body; a middle layer of wool or synthetic to provide insulation even when wet; an outer wind and rain protection layer that allows some ventilation to prevent overheating.
ii. Wear a hat or hood; up to 40% of body heat can be lost when the head is left exposed (do not wear ball caps under a hard hat).
iii. Wear insulated socks.
iv. Do not wear tight clothing; loose clothing provides better ventilation.
v. Keep a change of clothing available in case work clothes become wet.

6. Training
Employees who may be exposed to extreme hot or cold conditions must receive training prior to working in such conditions. This training will cover the general safety precautions related to heat and cold stress. However, employees must still be trained on any additional precautions specific to their equipment or work areas.

LADDER SAFETY

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-20
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 **VERSION:** 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   Portable Ladders present unique opportunities for unsafe acts and unsafe conditions. Employees who use ladders must be trained in proper selection, inspection, use and storage. Improper use of ladders has caused a large percentage of accidents in the workplace. Use caution on ladders.

2. **Scope**
   a. This policy applies to ladder use by all Cooper Steel employees.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and shall review all necessary health and safety information.

4. **Portable Ladder Hazards**
   Falls from ladders can result in broken bones and death. Ladder safety is a lifesaving program at Cooper Steel. Ladders shall be used for their intended purposes only.
   a. **Hazards Include:**
      i. Ladders with missing or broken parts.
      ii. Using a ladder with an inadequate weight rating
      iii. Using a ladder that is too short for its intended purpose.
      iv. Using metal ladders near electrical wires.
      v. Using ladders as a working platform
      vi. Objects falling from ladders

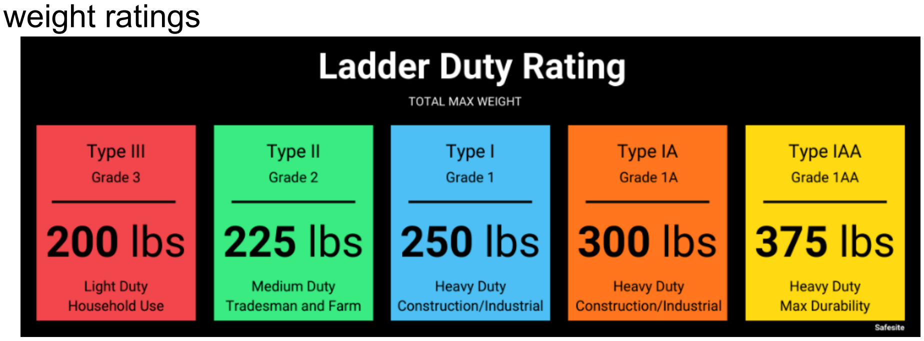
5. **General Rules**
   a. Ladders must comply with the American Ladder Institute Type 1A rating (300lb. capacity) at a minimum.
   b. Do not allow others to work under a ladder in use.
   c. If you have a fear of heights - don't climb a ladder.
   d. Ladders must not be loaded above the maximum intended load or beyond their rated capacity.
   e. Maintain 3 points of contact at all times when ascending and descending a ladder.
   f. Front of body must face the ladder at all times. Do not ascend or descend or stand on a ladder with your back or side to the rungs.

g. Do not lean out from the ladder in any direction. The center of your chest should remain between the side rails of the ladder.
h. Never allow more than one person on a ladder at one time.
i. When work is being performed from ladder above 4’ (General Industry) or 6’ (Construction) the employee must establish an anchor point above for fall protection and be tied off at all times.
j. Never step on the top two steps of a stepladder.
k. Use carriers and tool belts to carry objects up a ladder.
l. Do not use a step ladder to gain access to an upper level.
m. Aluminum or metallic frame ladders are prohibited.
n. Limits on ladder length
    i. A stepladder should be no more than 20 feet high.
    ii. An extension ladder can go to 30 feet, but the sections must overlap.

6. **Portable Ladder Inspection**
    a. Inspect ladders before each use in accordance with the manufacturer’s recommendations including at a minimum:
        i. All rungs and steps are free of oil, grease, dirt, etc. and be uniformly spaced and meet OSHA specifications.
        ii. All fittings are tight.
        iii. Spreaders or other locking devices are in place.
        iv. Non-skid safety feet are in place.
        v. No structural defects, all support braces must be intact.
    b. Do not use broken ladders. Most ladders cannot be repaired to manufacturer specifications. All broken ladders must be tagged “Do Not Use” and removed from service.

7. **Portable Ladder Storage**
Store ladders in designated areas where they cannot be damaged. If ladders are stored vertically they shall be secured to prevent them from tipping over. Store to prevent warping or sagging. Do not hang anything on ladders that are in a stored condition.

8. **Portable Ladder Ratings**
Ladder weight ratings



<u>Only Type IA and Type IAA ladders are permitted. Type I, Type II, and Type III ladders are prohibited. This rule applies to Step and Extension Ladders.</u>

9. **Portable Ladder Setup**
   The following procedure must be followed to prevent ladder accidents:
   a. Ladders shall be used only on stable and level surfaces unless they are secured properly to prevent displacement.
   b. Extend the ladder a minimum of 42” above the top support or work area.
   c. Anchor the top of the ladder and, if required to prevent displacement, hold or anchor at the bottom.
   d. Place the ladder base at a 1 (distance) to 4 (elevation) slope from the wall when using an extension ladder.
   e. Fully lock the spreader bars on stepladders prior to use.
   f. If ladders must be used in walkways, points of egress, or vehicle traffic areas, the area must be barricaded to prevent accidental displacement.

10. **Portable Ladder Maintenance**
   a. Keep ladders clean
   b. Never replace broken parts unless provided by the original manufacturer
   c. Do not attempt to repair broken side rails
   d. Keep all threaded fasteners properly adjusted
   e. Replace worn steps with parts from manufacturer

11. **Training**
   a. All employees shall be trained on the proper use, inspection and maintenance of ladders.

HOT WORK — WELDING AND CUTTING

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-21
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 VERSION: 2.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. This policy is to ensure Cooper Steel employee safety during welding and cutting operations, along with the protection of property (including equipment) from Hot Work operations conducted at the Cooper Steel Fabrication Facility. Hot Work is defined as “work involving burning, welding, or similar operation that is capable of initiating fires or explosions.” Hot Work, Welding and Cutting tasks will not be performed in areas that are not in compliance with this policy.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel employees exposed to hot work, welding and cutting operations.

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. The safety department is responsible for reviewing hazards and incidents associated with Hot Work conducted along with developing training programs for Hot Work operations, performing health hazard evaluations, and performing safety inspections of welding work areas and equipment.
    d. The Supervisor is responsible for making sure employees who will be performing Hot Work operations are properly trained on Cooper Steel procedures before performing work.
    e. A JSA will be completed providing specific rules and instructions concerning Hot Work including the safe operation of equipment, incorporating information from Safety Data Sheets (SDS) welding materials used, appropriate PPE, evaluation of combustible materials and hazardous areas present or likely to be present in the work location.
    f. Whenever a Hot Work Permit is required, the Supervisor is responsible for designating the following:
        i. **Hot Work Operator:** Is the employee who is qualified and authorized by management to perform hot work such as welding, cutting, and other associated work tasks.
        ii. **Fire Watch:** is the employee who is trained in hot work safety and monitors the hot work area for changing conditions and watches for fires and extinguishes them if possible.

1. A Fire Watch is required when:
    a. Combustible/Flammable materials can't be removed from the area (35' away)
    b. Equipment is in the area that can't be moved.
    c. There is potential for sparks and slag to fall into places that can't be monitored.
2. The Fire Watch must have a minimum 20lb Fire Extinguisher or equivalent and signaling device.
3. Multiple Fire Watch(s) will be required in situations where the potential for sparks and slag to fall in areas or elevations that can't be monitored by one person are incurred. In this situation a Fire Watch will be posted in each area and elevation where it is possible for sparks and slag to fall.

g. Employee performing hot work SHALL:
    i. Before use of welding equipment, read and understand all safety practices outlined in the manufacturer's instruction manual for the specific type(s) of welding equipment used for the work process. Read and understand Safety Data Sheets (SDSs), and Job Safety Analysis (JSA) including the requirements of this Policy.
h. Employees performing hot work, Fire Watches, and Supervisors of hot work operations, must complete annual Fire Safety Training ("hands-on") and complete the Cooper Steel Hot Work/Fire Watch Safety Training Course.
i. Inspect all welding equipment daily prior to use.
j. If a hot work permit is required for the task, operators shall follow all the safety requirements outlined in the issued Hot Work Permit (obtained prior to start of hot work activities).
k. Hot Work permit will be in the area at all times during hot work operations. Hot work permit will be displayed in a protective sleeve or equivalent.
l. Use all required personal protective equipment for the specific job.
m. Report any unsafe condition immediately to the Supervisor.

4. Fire Prevention and Protection for Welding and Cutting

a. Welding, cutting, and similar processes produce molten metal, sparks, slag, and hot work surfaces that can cause fire or explosion if precautionary measures are not followed.
b. Flying sparks are the main cause of fires and explosions in welding and cutting. Sparks can travel up to 35 feet from the work area. Sparks and molten metal can travel greater distances when falling. Sparks can pass through or become lodged in cracks, clothing, holes, and other small openings in floors, walls, or partitions.
c. Typical combustible materials found inside buildings include: wood, paper, rags, clothing, chemicals, flammable liquids and gases, and dusts. Parts of buildings such as floors, partitions, and roofs may also be combustible.

d. Welding and cutting can cause explosions in spaces containing flammable gases, vapors, liquids, or dusts.

Fire Hazard Prevention Guidelines:

a. Welding and cutting operations shall ideally be conducted in a separate, well-ventilated room with a fire-retardant floor.
b. Remove combustible materials for a minimum radius of 35 feet around the work area or move the work to a location away from combustible materials.
c. Protect combustibles with covers made of fire-resistant materials (see below for a description of approved fire-resistant materials for hot work).
d. If possible, enclose the work area with portable, fire-resistant screens.
e. Cover or block all openings, such as doorways, windows, cracks, or other openings with fire resistant material.
f. Welding/Fire Blankets must meet ANSI FM 4950 Standards at a minimum.
g. When required, have a qualified Fire Watch in the work area during and for at least 30 minutes after hot work is finished.
h. Do not dispose of hot slag in containers holding combustible material.
i. Fire extinguishers shall be readily available and maintained in a state of readiness for instant use at all times.
j. Welding or cutting is not permitted in or near rooms containing flammable or combustible liquids, vapors, or combustible dusts. Do not weld or cut in atmospheres containing reactive, toxic, or flammable gases, vapors, liquids, or dust.
k. Defective hot work equipment shall be tagged "Do Not Use" and removed from service immediately.
l. Do not apply heat to a work piece covered by an unknown substance or coating that can produce flammable, toxic, or reactive vapors when heated.
m. Provide safety supervision for outside contractors conducting hot work. Inform contractors about site-specific hazards including the presence of flammable materials.

5. Electric Shock Hazards and Safety Precautions

Electric shock from electrical welding and cutting equipment can result in severe burns or death. Additionally, serious injury can occur if the welder falls as a result of the shock. This safety hazard is associated with operations that use electricity to generate heat, such as arc or resistance welding and cutting.

Employees are to use proper precautionary measures and recommended safe practices at all times to avoid electrical shocks. Personnel using electrical welding and cutting equipment must be trained on safe work practices and procedures before use of this equipment. Some measures to prevent electrical shock include:

a. Never use a bare hand or wet glove to change electrodes.
b. Do not touch an energized electrode while you are in contact with the work circuit.

c. Never stand on a wet or grounded surface when changing electrodes.
d. Do not allow the electrode holder or electrode to come in contact with any other person or any grounded object.
e. Remove the electrode from the electrode holder when not in use.
f. Ensure all insulating materials are in place and free from cracks and breaks.
g. Ground the frames of welding units.
h. Wear properly designed and approved rubber-soled boots in good condition.
i. If utilizing long lengths of cable, suspend them overhead whenever possible. If run along the floor, be sure they do not create a tripping hazard, become damaged, or tangled.
j. Additional safety precautions are required when welding is performed under any of the following electrical hazardous conditions: in damp locations or while wearing wet clothing, on metal floors, gratings, scaffolds, or other metal structures; in cramped positions such as sitting, kneeling, or lying; or when there is a high risk of unavoidable or accidental contact with the workpiece and ground. Where these conditions are present, use one of the following types of equipment presented in order of preference:
    i. Semiautomatic DC constant voltage metal electrode (wire) welder,
    ii. DC manual covered electrode (stick) welder,
    iii. AC welder with reduced open-circuit voltage. In most situations, use of a DC constant voltage wire welder is recommended.
k. **<u>Do not work alone!</u>**

6. **Ventilation Requirements for Welding**

Adequate ventilation shall be provided for all welding and cutting and related operations. Ventilation shall be adequate to ensure personnel exposures to hazardous concentrations of airborne contaminants are maintained below the allowable limits.

Ventilation is used to control overexposures to fumes and gases during welding and cutting. Adequate ventilation will keep the fumes and gases from the welder's breathing zone. The heat of the arc or flame creates fumes and gases (fume plume). Fumes contain respirable particles. Gases include the shielding gas, and combustion products. The heat from the arc or flame causes the fume plume to rise. Overexposure to welding fumes and gases can cause dizziness, illness, and even unconsciousness and death. The following measures and precautions are to be instituted to protect employee health:

a. General Welder Safety Precautions: Keep your head out of the fume plume. Reposition the work, your head, or both to keep from breathing smoke and fumes. Do not breathe the fumes. Use ventilation to control the fumes and gases produced from cutting and welding.
b. Adequate ventilation: All welding, cutting, and heating operations shall be ventilated (natural or mechanical) such that personnel exposures to

hazardous concentrations of airborne contaminants are within acceptable limits. Adequate ventilation can be obtained through natural or mechanical means or both.

   i. Natural ventilation is the movement of air through a workplace by natural forces. Roof vents, open doors and windows provide natural ventilation. The size and layout of the area/building can affect the amount of airflow in the welding area. Natural ventilation can be acceptable for welding operations if the contaminants are kept below the allowable limits.
   ii. Mechanical ventilation is the movement of air through a workplace by a mechanical device such as a fan. Mechanical ventilation is reliable. It can be more effective than natural ventilation.

7. **Personal Protective Equipment**

   Employees exposed to the hazards created by welding, cutting, or brazing operations shall be protected by personal protective equipment (PPE) in accordance with the requirements of OSHA standard 1910.132 at a minimum. Appropriate protective clothing required for any hot work operation will vary with the size, nature and location of the work to be performed. The Supervisor shall ensure that each employee who is exposed to the hazards of flames or electric arcs does not wear clothing that, when exposed to flames or electric arcs, could increase the extent of injury that would be sustained by the employee. PPE must protect against hazards such as burns, sparks, spatter, electric shock, and optical radiation.

   a. **Foot and Leg Protection:** Wear leather, safety-toed, high-topped boots in good condition. They will help protect your feet and ankles from injury. In heavy spark and slag areas, use fire-resistant boot protectors or leather spats strapped round your pant legs and boot tops to prevent injury and burns. Do not wear pants with cuffs. Wear the bottoms of your pants over the tops of your boots to keep out sparks and flying metal. Do not tuck pant legs into your boots.
   b. **Hand Protection:** Wear flame-resistant gloves, such as leather welder's gloves. Always wear dry, hole-free, insulated welding gloves in good condition. They will help protect your hands from burns, sparks, heat, cuts, scratches, and electric shock.
   c. **Hearing Protection:** If loud noise is present, wear approved ear plugs or earmuffs to protect your hearing and prevent hearing loss. When working out of position, such as overhead, wear approved earplugs or muffs. They prevent sparks, spatter, and hot metal from entering your ears and causing burns.
   d. **Eye and Face Protection:** Welding, cutting, and other hot work processes present various hazards to the welder's eyes and face: the intense heat from arc rays and welding sparks can cause burns to the skin and eyes, during electric welding and welding processes. Personal Protective Equipment for

the eyes and face is very important for both the welder and other personnel working near welding operations. Filter lens shall be in accordance with ANSI Z87.1.-2020

   i. Goggles or other approved eye protection shall be worn by persons in the work area during oxyfuel gas welding and cutting operations.
   ii. For Other Work Associated with Welding (Such as Grinding): Welding helmets with filter lenses are intended to protect users from arc rays and from weld sparks and spatter which impinge directly against the helmet. They are not intended to protect against slag chips, grinding fragments, wire wheel bristles, and similar hazards unless they are ANSI Z.87+ compliant. Spectacles with side shields or impact safety goggles, combined with the use of a face shield approved at the ANSI Z87+ level is required for protection against these hazards. The PPE should be stamped ANSI Z87+. The spectacles or goggles may have either clear or filtered lenses, depending upon the amount of exposure to adjacent welding or cutting radiation. Others in the immediate welding area should wear similar eye protection.

8. **Approved Fire Resistant Materials for Hot Work Areas**
   Fire resistant materials must meet ANSI FM 4950 Standards at a minimum.
   a. **Welding Blanket:** A heat-resistant fabric designed to be placed in the vicinity of a hot work operation. Intended for use in horizontal applications with light to moderate exposures such as that resulting from chipping, grinding, and light horizontal welding. Designed to protect machinery and prevent ignition of combustibles such as wood that are located adjacent to the underside of the blanket. They are made from different materials such as fiberglass, Silica, and other fire resistant materials.
   b. **Welding Pads:** A heat-resistant fabric designed to be placed directly under a hot work operation such as welding or cutting. Welding pads are intended for use horizontal applications with severe exposures such as that resulting from molten substances of heavy horizontal welding. Designed to prevent the ignition of combustibles that are located adjacent to the underside of the pad.
   c. **Welding Curtain:** A heat-resistant fabric designed to be placed in the vicinity of a hot work operation. Intended for use in vertical application with light to moderate exposures such as that resulting from chipping, grinding, heat treating, and light horizontal welding. Designed to prevent sparks from escaping a confined area.

9. **Oxyfuel Gas Welding and Cutting Operations**
   a. **Oxygen Gas Cylinders and Apparatus:** Oxygen cylinders and apparatus shall be kept free from oil, grease, and other flammable or explosive substances. Oxygen cylinders or apparatus shall not be handled with oily hands or oily gloves. Oxygen cylinders and apparatus shall not be used

interchangeable with any other gas. Oxygen shall not be used as a substitute for compressed air. Oxygen shall not be used for any other work purpose other than welding and cutting (e.g., do not use to blow out pipelines, to dust clothing, do not strike against an oily surface, greasy clothing, or enter fuel oil other storage tanks, etc.). Inside of buildings, cylinders shall be stored in a well-protected, well-ventilated, dry location, at least 20 feet from highly combustible materials such as oil or excelsior. Cylinders should be stored in assigned places away from elevators, stairs, or gangways. Assigned storage spaces shall be located where cylinders will not be knocked over or damaged by passing or falling objects, or subject to tampering by unauthorized persons.

Cylinders shall not be kept in unventilated enclosures such as lockers, trailers, conex boxes, etc. Empty cylinders shall have their valves closed. Valve protection caps, where cylinder is designed to accept a cap, shall always be in place, hand-tight, except when cylinders are in use or connected for use.

Oxygen cylinders shall not be stored near highly combustible material, especially oil and grease; or near reserve stocks of other fuel-gas cylinders, or near any other substance likely to cause or accelerate fire.

Oxygen cylinders in storage shall be separated from fuel-gas cylinders or combustible materials (especially oil or grease), a minimum distance of 20 feet (6.1 m) or by a noncombustible barrier at least 5 feet (1.5 m) high having a fire-resistance rating of at least one-half hour.

b. **Torch Operation:** Connections shall be checked for leaks after assembly and before lighting the torch. Before lighting the torch for the first time each day, hoses shall be purged individually. Hoses shall not be purged into confined spaces or near ignition sources. Hoses shall be purged after a cylinder change.
    i. Torch Lighting: Torches shall be lit by a friction lighter or other approved device, not by matches, cigarette lighters, or welding arcs. Point the torch away from persons or combustible materials. Whenever work is suspended, Torch valves shall be closed, and the gas supply shut off.
    ii. Hose and Hose Connections: Hose connections shall be clamped or otherwise securely fastened in a manner that will withstand, without leakage, twice the pressure to which they are normally subjected in service, but in no case less than a pressure of 300 psi (2.04 MPa). Oil-free air or an oil-free inert gas shall be used for the test. Hose showing leaks, burns, worn places, or other defects rendering it unfit for service shall be repaired or replaced. Note: Oxygen and acetylene hoses should be different colors. Red is generally used for fuel and green for oxygen. Black is generally used for inert gas and air hoses.

iii. Flash-Back Arrestors: Gas cylinders shall be protected from a Flash-Back Arrestors shall be installed adjacent to the cylinders between the supply lines and gauges, or torches with Integral Flash-Back arrestors may be used.

10. Electric Arc Welding and Cutting Operations

a. Standard Machines for Arc Welding: Arc Welding Machines shall be designed and constructed to carry their rated load and shall be suitable for operation in atmospheres containing gases, dust, and light rays produced by the welding arc.
b. Manual Electrode Holders: Only manual electrode holders specifically designed for arc welding and cutting of a capacity capable of safely handling the maximum rated current required by the electrodes may be used. All current carrying parts of the holder that are gripped by the welder or cutter, and the outer jaws of the holder, shall be fully insulated against the maximum voltage encountered to ground.
c. Welding Cable and Connectors: Cables shall be completely insulated, flexible, capable of handling the maximum current requirements of the work in progress, and in good repair. Welding leads will have no repair within 10' of the electrode holder.
d. Grounding: The frames of arc welding and cutting machines shall be adequately grounded in accordance with the manufacturer, OSHA electrical standards, and ANSI standards.
e. Equipment Loading: Care shall be taken in applying arc welding equipment to ensure that the ampere rating chosen is adequate to handle the job. Welding machines shall not be operated above the ampere ratings and corresponding rated duty cycles as specified by the manufacturer and shall not be used for applications other than those specified by the manufacturer.
f. Environmental Conditions: The welding operator shall take special care to prevent electrical shock. The manufacturer shall be consulted, and a hazard assessment shall be performed before unusual service conditions are encountered. Unusual service conditions may exist, and in such circumstances machines shall be especially designed to safely meet the requirements of the service. Chief among these conditions are:
    i. Exposure to unusually corrosive fumes.
    ii. Exposure to steam or excessive humidity.
    iii. Exposure to excessive oil vapor.
    iv. Exposure to flammable gases.
    v. Exposure to abnormal vibration or shock.
    vi. Exposure to excessive dust.
    vii. Exposure to weather.
g. Water or perspiration may cause electrically hazardous conditions. Electrical shock may be prevented by performing a hazard assessment before work,

relocating work to a safe location, avoiding contact with live electrical parts, and lastly by use of personal protective equipment the use of nonconductive gloves, clothing, and shoes.

h. Other examples of electrically hazardous conditions are locations in which the freedom of movement is restricted so that the operator is forced to perform the work in a cramped (kneeling, sitting, lying) position with physical contact with conductive parts, and locations that are fully or partially limited by conductive elements and in which there is a high risk of unavoidable or accidental contact by the operator. These hazards can be minimized by performing a hazard assessment before work is performed and by insulating conductive parts near the vicinity of the operator.

HAND AND POWER TOOL SAFETY

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-22
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 VERSION: 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. Cooper Steel Health and Safety has developed this policy to ensure the safety of employees working with hand tools, portable powered tools and other hand-held equipment. This program is intended to comply with the Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) Standards.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel employees who may use hand tools, portable powered tools and equipment during the course of work. Employees must be able to use hand and portable powered tools and equipment safely and shall comply with manufacturer guidelines.

3. **Responsibility**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy and:
        i. Ensure that hand and portable powered tool safety measures are in place according to this program and the applicable OSHA standards;
        ii. Maintain training records; and
        iii. Periodically evaluate program implementation
    c. Supervisors are responsible for:
        iv. Ensuring that all hand and portable powered tools and other hand held equipment used at Cooper Steel are free from defects and are working and maintained properly;
        v. Ensuring that tools are used in accordance with manufacturer recommendations;
        vi. Ensuring that all affected employees have been trained;
        vii. Ensuring that all affected employees comply with this program;
        viii. Taking damaged tools out of service immediately if they are defective; and
        ix. Conducting periodic inspections of work areas.
    d. Employees are responsible for:
        x. Attending required training programs;
        xi. Inspecting hand and portable powered tools and equipment for defects or possible hazards prior to use;
        xii. Tagging any defective tools as out of service immediately; and

xiii. Reporting any defects to their supervisor immediately.

4. **Training and Recordkeeping**
   All employees shall be trained in the proper use of tools prior to using hand and power tools and other hand-held equipment. Employees shall be trained in the following:
   a. Recognition of the hazards associated with different types of tools and the safety precautions necessary for use;
   b. The PPE required during use; and
   c. The proper use of hand and power tools and other hand-held equipment.
   Employees shall be retrained as necessary to maintain their understanding and knowledge on the safe use of hand and power tools and other hand-held equipment.

5. **General Safety Requirements**
   Tools and equipment shall be kept in safe condition. The following help prevent hazards associated with the use of hand and power tools:
   a. Keep all tools in good condition with regular maintenance;
   b. Use the right tool for the job;
   c. Inspect each tool for damage before use;
   d. Never use damaged tools - take damaged tools out of service immediately;
   e. Operate tools according to the manufacturers' instructions; and
   f. Use the proper personal protective equipment (PPE).

6. **Guards**
   The exposed moving parts of power tools shall be guarded. Safety guards must never be removed when a tool is being used. Belts, gears, shafts, pulleys, sprockets, spindles, drums, flywheels, chains, or other reciprocating, rotating, or moving parts of equipment must be guarded.
   Machine guards must be provided to protect the operator and others from the following:
   a. Point of operation;
   b. In-running nip points;
   c. Rotating parts; and
   d. Flying chips and sparks.

7. **Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)**
   Employees who use hand and power tools and are exposed to the hazards of noise, vibration, falling, flying, abrasive, and splashing objects, or to harmful dusts, fumes, mists, vapors, or gases must be provided with the appropriate personal protective equipment.
   The following considerations should be evaluated at a minimum in the selection and use of PPE when using hand and portable powered tools:

a. Safety glasses or goggles must be worn at all times when using hand and powered tools;
b. A face-shield may be used in addition to safety glasses or goggles to protect the face and neck;
c. Hearing protection is recommended when using power tools.

Before working with hand and power tools, consult the hazard evaluation for the task you will be performing to determine if additional PPE is required. Refer to Cooper Steel's PPE Program for specific information regarding the use of PPE.

8. **Hand Tools**

Hand tools are tools that are powered manually. Some examples of hand tools include spud wrenches, bull pins, drift pins, files, hammers, hand boring tools, pliers, punches, saws, scissors, screw drivers, etc.. Hazards associated with hand tools result from misuse and improper maintenance. To prevent injury, follow the guidelines listed below:

a. Hand tools shall be used for their intended purpose only.
b. Inspect tools for damage prior to use;
c. Hand tools shall be maintained in good condition free of damage.
d. Bent screwdrivers or screwdrivers with chipped edges shall be replaced;
e. Always direct tools such as knives, saw blades, etc. away from aisle areas and away from other employees working in close proximity;
f. Knives and scissors must be sharp; dull tools can cause more hazards than sharp ones;
g. Cracked saw blades must be removed from service;
h. Wrenches must not be used when jaws are sprung to the point that slippage occurs;
i. Impact tools such as drift pins, wedges, and chisels must be kept free of mushroomed heads;
j. Iron or steel hand tools may produce sparks that can be an ignition source around flammable substances. Spark-resistant tools made of non-ferrous materials should be used where flammable gases, highly volatile liquids, and other explosive substances are stored or used;
k. Keep the work area and tools clean. Dirty, greasy tools and floor may cause accidents;
l. Tools shall be stored in a dry secure location;
m. Carry and store tools properly. All sharp tools shall be carried and stored with the sharp edge down. Do not carry sharp tools in a pocket; and
n. Wear the proper personal protective equipment (PPE).

9. **Power Tools**
Power tools must be equipped with guards and safety switches. They can be hazardous when used improperly. Types of power tools are determined by their power source: electric, pneumatic, liquid fuel, hydraulic, and powder-actuated. To prevent hazards associated with the use of power tools, workers should observe the following general precautions:
    a. Read the owner's manual to understand the tool's proper applications, limitations, operation, and hazards;
    b. Never carry a tool by the cord or hose;
    c. Never yank the cord or the hose to disconnect it from the receptacle;
    d. Keep cords and hoses away from heat, oil, and sharp edges;
    e. Ensure tools are properly grounded; use Ground Fault Circuit Interrupter (GFCI) for corded tools when on temporary/portable power;
    f. Disconnect tools when not using them, before servicing and cleaning, and when changing accessories such as blades, bits, and cutters;
    g. Keep all people not involved with the work at a safe distance from the work area;
    h. Secure work with clamps or a vise, freeing both hands to operate the tool;
    i. Avoid accidental starting. Do not hold fingers on the switch button while carrying a plugged-in tool;
    j. Maintain tools sharp and clean;
    k. Be sure to keep good footing and maintain good balance when operating power tools;
    l. Wear proper apparel for the task. Loose clothing, ties, or jewelry can become caught in moving parts; and
    m. Inspect tools for damage before each use. Remove all damaged portable electric tools from use and tag them: "Do Not Use."

10. **Electric Tools**
Electric tools may cause electrical burns and shocks. To prevent the user from electrocution, electric tools shall have a three-wire cord with a ground and be plugged into a grounded receptacle, be double insulated, or be powered by a low voltage isolation transformer to protect from burns and shocks. Three-wire cords contain two current carrying conductors and a grounding conductor. When an adapter is used to accommodate a two-hole receptacle, the adapter wire must be attached to a known ground. The third prong must never be removed from the plug. Double-insulated tools are available that provide protection against electrical shock without third-wire grounding. On double insulated tools, an internal layer of protective insulation completely isolates the external housing of the tool. The following general practices should be followed when using electric tools:
    a. Operate electric tools within their design limitations;
    b. Use gloves and appropriate safety footwear when using electric tools;
    c. Store electric tools in a dry place when not in use;

d. Do not use electric tools in damp or wet locations unless they are approved for that purpose;
e. Keep work areas well lighted when operating electric tools;
f. Ensure that cords from electric tools do not present a tripping hazard.

11. **Pneumatic Tools**

Pneumatic tools are powered by compressed air and include chippers, drills, hammers, and sanders. Some hazards associated with pneumatic tools include noise, vibration, fatigue, and strains. Additional hazards are described below:

a. The greatest hazard is being hit by one of the tool's attachments or by a fastener used with the tool. Eye protection must be worn for employees working with pneumatic tools;
b. Pneumatic tools must be checked to ensure that they are fastened securely to the air hose to prevent them from becoming disconnected. A short wire or positive locking device attaching the air hose to the tool must also be used and will serve as an added safeguard;
c. If an air hose is more than 1/2-inch in diameter, a safety excess flow valve must be installed at the source of the air supply to shut off the air automatically in case the hose breaks;
d. When using pneumatic tools, a safety clip or retainer must be installed to prevent attachments such as chisels on a chipping hammer from being ejected during tool operation;
e. Pneumatic tools that shoot nails, rivets, staples, or similar fasteners and operate at pressures more than 100 pounds per square inch, must be equipped with a special device to keep fasteners from being ejected, unless the muzzle is pressed against the work surface;
f. Airless spray guns that atomize paints and fluids at pressures of 1,000 pounds or more per square inch must be equipped with automatic or visible manual safety devices that will prevent pulling the trigger until the safety device is manually released;
g. Compressed air guns should never be pointed toward anyone. Workers should never "dead-end" them against themselves or anyone else.

12. **Liquid Fuel Powered Tools**

Fuel-powered tools are usually operated with gasoline. The most serious hazard associated with the use of fuel-powered tools is from fuel vapors that can burn or explode and also give off dangerous exhaust fumes. Fuel must be handled, transported, and stored only in approved flammable liquid containers, according to proper procedures for flammable liquids. Before refilling a fuel-powered tool tank, shut down the engine and allow it to cool to prevent accidental ignition of hazardous vapors. When a fuel-powered tool is used inside a closed area, effective ventilation and/or proper respirators such as atmosphere-supplying respirators must be utilized to avoid breathing carbon monoxide. Fire extinguishers must also be available in the area.

13. Operating Controls and Switches

The following hand-held power tools must be equipped with a constant-pressure switch or control that shuts off the power when pressure is released:

a. Drills
b. Impact Guns
c. Horizontal, vertical, and angle grinders with disks more than 2 inches in diameter
d. Disc sanders with discs greater than 2 inches
e. Reciprocating saws
f. Other similar tools.

The constant-pressure control switch should be regarded as the preferred device. Other hand-held power tools such as circular saws having a blade diameter greater than 2 inches, chain saws, and percussion tools with no means of holding accessories securely must be equipped with a constant-pressure switch.

14. Powder-Actuated Tools

Powder-actuated tools require special training and shall not be used at Cooper Steel without prior approval from Cooper Steel Safety Department.

15. Tool Tethers

Tool tether will be required when overhead protection can not be provided by exclusion zones. Tool tethers must meet the following criteria:

a. Tethers and tool attachments must meet the ANSI 121-2018 standard.
b. Tethers and tool attachments must have a weight rating a minimum of 25% higher than the weight of the tool.
c. Tools weighing 5lbs. or more shall not be tethered to the body. Confirm the weight of the tool.
d. Do not use tool tethers where machinery entanglement is a concern.

23 ELECTRICAL SAFETY

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-23
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 **VERSION:** 2.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. It is the policy of Cooper Steel to ensure compliance with all applicable laws, regulations, standards and best management practical to ensure the protection of people and property from the hazardous aspects of electrical systems. This electrical safety policy and program is designed to provide safety guidelines that will meet the needs of Qualified Personnel to work within the Arc Flash Protection Boundaries described in NFPA 70 Article 100, while maintaining compliance with all other applicable OSHA, NEC and NFPA 70E standards.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel work sites, i.e., company offices, facilities, maintenance facilities, and client job sites, etc.

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.

4. **Definitions**
    a. Approved - acceptable to the authorities.
    b. Authorized Person - a person approved or assigned by Cooper Steel to perform a specific duty or duties or to be at a specific location or locations at the jobsite.
    c. Cabinet - an enclosure designed either for surface or flush mounting.
    d. Competent Person - one who is capable of identifying existing and predictable hazards in the surroundings or working conditions which are unsanitary, hazardous, or dangerous to workers, and who has the authorization to take prompt corrective measures to eliminate them.
    e. Conditionally Qualified - The employee is undergoing on-the-job training and has, in the course of such training, demonstrated an ability to perform duties safely. The employee is at all times under the direct supervision of an appropriately qualified and authorized person; and the employee has been authorized by management to perform such tasks.
    f. Conductor (bare) - a conductor having no covering or electrical insulation whatsoever.

g. Conductor (insulated) - a conductor encased within material of composition and thickness that is recognized as electrical insulation.
h. Defect -any characteristic or condition that tends to weaken or reduce the strength of the tool, object, or structure of which it is a part.
i. Disconnect -a device, or group of devices, or other means by which the conductors of a circuit can be disconnected from their source of supply.
j. Enclosed - surrounded by a case, housing, fence, or walls which shall prevent persons from accidentally contacting energized parts.
k. Enclosure - the case or housing of apparatus, or the fence or walls surrounding an installation to prevent personnel from accidentally contacting energized parts, or to protect the equipment from physical damage.
l. Exposed (as applied to live parts) - capable of being inadvertently touched or approached nearer than a safe distance by a person. It is applied to parts not suitably guarded, isolated, or insulated.
m. Guarded - covered, shielded, fenced, enclosed, or otherwise protected by means of suitable covers, casings, barriers, rails, screens, mats, or platforms to remove the likelihood of approach to a point of danger or contact by persons or objects.
n. Isolated - not readily accessible to persons unless special means for access are used.
o. Labeled - equipment or materials to which has been attached a label, symbol or other identifying mark of a qualified testing laboratory which indicates compliance with appropriate standards or performance in a specified manner.
p. NEC - stands for National Electric Code.
q. Qualified – Individuals are considered qualified when they possess the skills and working knowledge of the techniques necessary to distinguish exposed live (energized) parts from other parts of electrical equipment, the skills and working knowledge of the techniques necessary to determine the nominal voltage of exposed live parts, and Knowledge of the safe approach/clearance distances and corresponding voltages, and are well acquainted with and thoroughly conversant in the electric equipment (construction and operation) and the potential electrical hazards involved with the work being performed.
r. Receptacle - a contact device installed at the outlet for the connection of a single attachment plug. A single receptacle is a single contact device with no other contact device on the same yoke. A multiple receptacle is a single device containing two or more receptacles.
s. Unqualified - Individuals are considered "unqualified" if they have not received all training required for qualified employees, do not meet any one or more of the other requirements listed above for "qualified" employees or have not been authorized by management to perform work with, on or near exposed energized parts, but may, due to their job assignments become exposed to electrical shock hazards. Potential exposure based on job assignments includes such items as working on, near or with (1) Premises wiring, (2)

Wiring for connection to supply, (3) Other wiring and (4) Optical fiber cable (where installations are made along with electrical conductors). These employees are required, among other things, to be familiar with the basic existence and purpose of the Electrical Safety program, all actions necessary to perform their jobs in a safe manner and the procedures for reporting any conditions they may feel present a potential hazard.

5. Procedures

a. General

i. Feasible engineering and administrative controls shall be applied to mitigate or minimize the risk of injury and illness from exposure to electrical hazards. Where such hazards still exist after application of these controls, 'hot work' procedures shall apply, and Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) shall be used and comply with NFPA 70E.

ii. Where feasible, workers shall not perform live electrical work. Branches that engage in live work are required to provide applicable safe work procedures, PPE, and equipment.

iii. In existing installations, no changes in circuit protection shall be made to increase the load in excess of the load rating of the circuit wiring.

iv. Worn or frayed electric cords or cables shall be removed from work areas for repair or disposal. Plugs equipped with a grounding prong must have the prong in place. Damaged plugs must be repaired. Repairing cords shall be limited to being completed by an authorized qualified person. as determined by the Safety Director.

v. Working spaces, walkways, and similar locations must be kept clear of cords to eliminate hazards.

vi. Extension cords shall not be fastened with staples, hung from nails, or suspended by wire. Control equipment, utilization equipment, and busways approved for use in dry locations only shall be protected against damage from the weather during building construction.

vii. Extension cords must be inspected daily before use. Damaged cords will be disposed of immediately.

viii. Extension cords must be a minimum of 12ga. Wire.

ix. Metal raceways, cable armor, boxes, cable sheathing, cabinets, elbows, couplings, fittings, supports, and support hardware shall be of materials appropriate for the environment in which they are to be installed.

x. Electrical switches shall be labelled to indicate the system, equipment, service, or tool they control. This includes switch boxes, cabinets, motor control cabinets, stationary equipment, control panels, and other such switches or disconnects.

xi. Workers who perform electrical work shall wear hard hats that are proof tested to 20,000 volts and shall not wear clothing with or without PPE that could increase injury (100% cotton is better than blended materials).

xii. In work areas where the exact location of underground electric power lines is unknown, workers using jackhammers, bars, or other hand tools that may contact a line shall be provided with insulated protective gloves. Gloves must be rated to (or exceed) the voltage for which they may be exposed. The gloves shall be inspected before use and replaced as per the manufacturer's specifications.

xiii. Wiring components and equipment in hazardous environments shall be maintained in a condition consistent with NEC requirements (i.e., no loose or missing screws, gaskets, threaded connections, seals, or other impairments to a tight condition).

xiv. Hazardous locations are those locations where flammable vapors, liquids or gases, or combustible dusts or fibers may be present. There are six "classifications" for these types of locations, as follows:

1. Class I Division 1 and Division 2
2. Class II Division 1 and Division 2
3. Class III Division 1 and Division 2

xv. Equipment, wiring methods, and installations of electrical equipment in hazardous (classified) locations must be designated as "intrinsically safe" or be approved for the classification location.

b. Energized Electrical Parts and Systems

This section does not apply to power distribution or transmission lines. Refer to CFR Subpart "R" 1910.269 (servicing) and/or CFR Subpart "V" 1926.950 (Construction) for overhead power transmission and distribution line requirements.

i. Safety-related work practices shall be employed to prevent electric shock or other injuries resulting from either direct or indirect electrical contact when work is performed near or on equipment or circuits which are or may be energized. The specific safety-related work practices shall be consistent with the nature and extent of the associated electrical hazards.

ii. Live parts to which a worker may be exposed shall be de-energized before the worker works on or near them, unless it can be demonstrated that de-energizing introduces additional or increased hazards or is infeasible due to equipment design or operational limitations. Live parts that operate at less than 50 volts to ground need not be deenergized if there will be no increased exposure to electrical burns or to explosion due to electric arcs.

iii. If the exposed live parts are not de-energized (i.e., for reasons of increased or additional hazards or infeasibility), other safety-related work practices shall be used to protect workers who may be exposed to the electrical hazards involved. Such work practices shall protect workers against contact with energized circuit parts directly with any part of their body or indirectly through some other conductive object. The work practices that are used shall be suitable for the conditions under which the work is to be performed and for the voltage level of the exposed electric conductors or circuit parts.

c. Hazard Labeling
   Cooper Steel shall use NFPA 70 E approved labeling. At a minimum electrical disconnects, panels, control cabinets, or any enclosure subject to maintenance, examination, adjustment, servicing, or inspection must be labeled. This equipment must be marked with either the required level of PPE or the available incident energy.
d. Working on or near exposed de-energized parts
   This section applies to working on exposed de-energized parts near enough to expose worker(s) to an electrical hazard.
   i. While a worker is exposed to contact with fixed electrical equipment or circuits which have been de-energized, the circuits energizing the parts shall be locked out in accordance with the Energy Control (lockout) section of this manual.
   ii. The circuits and equipment to be worked on shall be disconnected from electrical energy sources (and locked out). Control circuit devices, such as push buttons, selector switches, and interlocks, shall not be used as the sole means for de-energizing circuits or equipment.
   iii. Procedures for the release of stored electric energy shall be managed according to this policy.
   iv. When capacitors or associated equipment are handled, they shall be treated as energized.
   v. Stored non-electrical energy in devices that could reenergize electrical parts shall be blocked or relieved to the extent that the parts could not be accidentally energized by the device.
e. Working on or near exposed energized parts
   Every effort shall be made to preclude work on energized electrical parts. When this is not possible, the requirements of this section shall apply. Potential contact with live energized parts includes work performed on exposed live parts (involving either direct contact or contact by means of tools or materials) or near enough to them for workers to be exposed to any hazard they present.
   i. Only qualified people shall work on electrical equipment that has not been de-energized.
   ii. If work is to be performed near overhead lines, the lines shall be de-energized and grounded, or other protective measures shall be provided before work is started.
   iii. If the lines are to be de-energized, arrangements shall be made with the person or organization that operates or controls the electric circuits involved in de-energizing and grounding them. If protective measures, such as guarding, isolating, or insulating are provided, these precautions shall prevent workers from contacting such lines directly with any part of

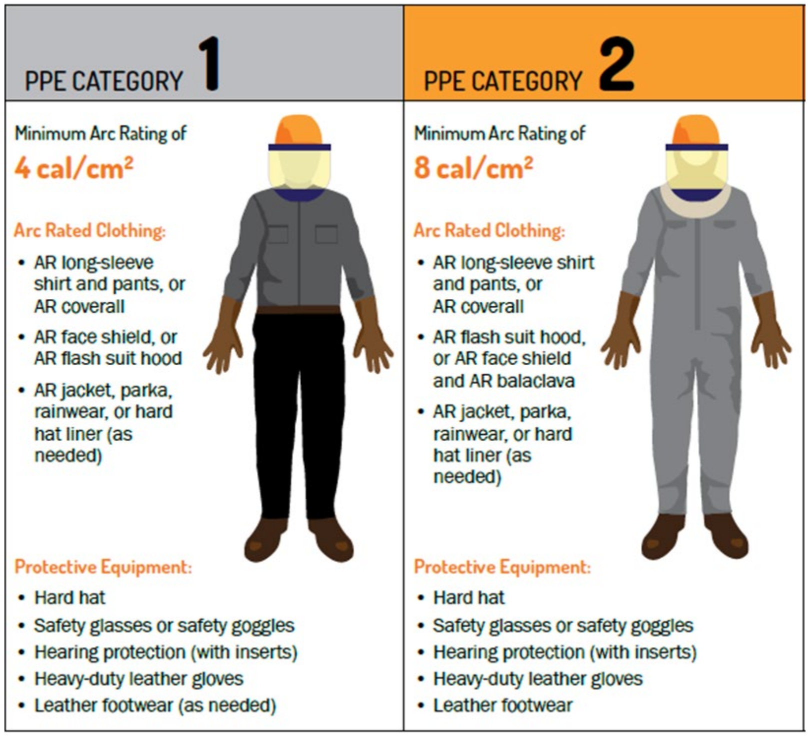
their body or indirectly through conductive materials, tools, or equipment.

f. Hazard and Risk Evaluation Procedure
   i. It is Cooper Steel's intention that all employees and contractors work in a non-energized environment. When working in a deenergized environment creates a Greater Hazard, is Infeasible, or is Greater Than 50 Volts, an Energized Work permit must be obtained.
   ii. To work on energized devices as identified in this program you must be:
      1. Listed as qualified or a conditionally qualified employee
      2. Completed Electrically Qualified Employee Certification
      3. Completed all necessary electrical safety training
   iii. Energized Electrical Work Permit must be completed before any work may be performed.
      1. The Long Form is for construction/maintenance. It must be completely filled out and submitted to the Facility Safety Manager prior to any work being done. The Long form must be filled out for each operation.
      2. The Short Form is for service work such as Trouble Shooting, etc. It shall be completely filled out and submitted to Facility Safety Manager prior to any work being done. The Short form is active for 30 days then it must be renewed.
   iv. Trouble Shooting defined as: The testing of live electrical circuits known as troubleshooting shall be confined to the purpose of diagnostic readings of voltage and amperage only. Resetting a motor control with an insulated probe will be considered trouble shooting. Replacing a fuse or the use of a tool will be considered maintenance and will not be allowed under Trouble Shooting conditions. Short form may not be used for 600 volts and above.
   v. Testing live electrical circuits known as troubleshooting for the purpose of diagnostic readings of voltage and amperage only. Category 1 PPE at a minimum is required for 240 volts and below and an arc-flash boundary of 18". Category 2* PPE at a minimum is required for 240 volts and above and an arc-flash boundary of 3 feet.
   vi. Resetting a motor control with an insulated probe as part of trouble shooting. Category 1 PPE at a minimum is required for 240 volts and below and an arc-flash boundary of 18". Category 2* PPE at a minimum is required for 240 volts and above and an arc-flash boundary of 3 feet.

g. Personal Protective Equipment

   All Cooper Steel employees shall wear the Personal Protective Equipment identified in Table 130.7 (10) of NFPA 70E. The appropriate PPE with the corresponding Hazard/Risk Category. The category shall be identified on the labeling attached to the electrical equipment.

Where an Arc Flash hazard assessment has not been performed, PPE shall be selected based on Table 130.7(C)(15)(A)(a); 130.7(C)(15)(A)(b) and 130.7(C)(16) of NFPA 70E. In general, this can be accomplished by utilizing PPE for Category 2, as define in NFPA 70E for work under 600 volts. This is an interim protective measure as is not a substitute for conducting the required risk assessments.



h. Overhead electrical lines

   i. While conducting site activities near overhead lines, field personnel need to be aware of the location of the lines so as not to use conductive equipment (e.g., cranes, forklifts, aerial lifts, etc.) in close proximity to power lines.
   ii. OSHA 29 CFR 1926.550 requires that any vehicle or mechanical equipment capable of having parts of its structure elevated near energized overhead lines shall be operated so that a clearance distance of at least 10 feet is maintained.
   iii. When calculating clearance distances for aerial equipment, consider both the length of the boom and the sway of the machine. Position the equipment such that will still be at least 10 feet away from the power lines. Note that extended booms of cranes, forklifts, and aerial lifts can lean or sway when elevated so it may be necessary to maintain more than a 10- foot distance on the ground to ensure that there is a 10-foot horizontal distance between them and the power line.
   iv. Higher voltages require greater clearance distances. Contact the electrical utility company to verify line voltage. If the voltage is higher than 50kV, the clearance shall be increased 4 in. for every 10kV over that voltage.

Table 12-1	
Voltage	**Required Clearance**
0-50 kV	10 feet
50-200 kV	15 feet
200-350 kV	20 feet
350-500 kV	25 feet
500-750 kV	35 feet
750-1000 kV	45 feet

   v. Under any of the following conditions, OSHA allows the required clearance to be reduced:
      1. If a vehicle is in transit with its structure lowered, the clearance shall be reduced to 4 ft. If the voltage is higher than 50kV, the clearance shall be increased 4 in. for every 10kV over that voltage
      2. If insulating barriers (boots) are installed to prevent contact with the lines, and if the line being guarded and are not a part of or an attachment to the vehicle or its raised structure, OSHA allows the clearance to be reduced to a distance within the designed working dimensions of the insulating barrier. However, while this is permissible according to OSHA, some utility companies are

recommending that safe distances, as described previously, be maintained in addition to the insulating barrier.

vi. When an unqualified person is working in an elevated position near overhead lines or working on the ground in the vicinity of overhead lines, the location shall be such that the person and the longest conductive object he or she may contact cannot come closer to any unguarded, energized overhead line than the clearance distances indicated in Table 12-1.

vii. For voltages normally encountered with overhead power lines, objects which do not have an insulating rating for the voltage involved shall be considered to be conductive.

viii. When a qualified person is working in the vicinity of overhead lines, whether in an elevated position or on the ground, the person shall not approach or take any conductive object without an approved insulating handle closer to exposed energized parts than the clearance distances indicated in Table 12-2, unless:

1. The person is insulated from the energized part (gloves, with sleeves, if necessary, rated for the voltage involved are considered to be insulation of the person from the energized part on which work is performed), or
2. The energized part is insulated both from other conductive objects at a different potential and from the person, or
3. The person is insulated from conductive objects at a potential different from that of the energized part.

Table 12-2

Approach Distances for Qualified Workers - Alternating Current

Voltage range (phase to phase)	**Minimum approach distance**
300V and less	Avoid contact
Over 300V, not over 750V	1 ft. 0 in.
Over 750V, not over 2kV	I ft. 6 in.
Over 2kV, not over 15kV	2 ft. 0 in.
Over 15kV, not over 37kV	3 ft. 0 in.
Over 37kV, not over 87.5kV	3 ft. 6 in.
Over 87.5kV, not over 121kV	4 ft. 0 in.
Over 121kV, not over 140kV	4 ft. 6 in.

ix. If the equipment is an aerial lift insulated for the voltage involved, and if the work is performed by a qualified person the clearance (between the uninsulated portion of the aerial lift and the power source) may be reduced to the distance indicated in Table 12-2. However, workers standing on the ground shall not contact the vehicle or mechanical equipment or any of its attachments, unless:

1. The worker is using protective equipment rated for the voltage or the equipment is located so that no uninsulated part of its structure (that portion of the structure that provides a conductive path to workers on the ground) can come closer to the line than permitted in this section.
2. If any vehicle or mechanical equipment capable of having parts of its structure elevated near energized overhead lines is intentionally grounded, workers working on the ground near the point of grounding shall not stand at the grounding location whenever there is a possibility of overhead line contact. Additional precautions, such as the use of barricades or insulation, shall be taken to protect workers from hazardous ground potentials, depending on earth resistivity and fault currents, which can develop within the first few feet or more outward from the grounding point.

i. Illumination

Workers shall not enter spaces containing exposed energized parts unless illumination is provided that enables the workers to perform the work safely. Where lack of illumination or an obstruction precludes observation of the work to be performed, workers shall not perform tasks near exposed energized parts. Workers shall not reach blindly into areas which may contain energized parts.

j. Confined Space or enclosed space work

When a worker works in a confined or enclosed space that contains exposed energized parts, protective shields, protective barriers, or insulating materials shall be used as necessary to avoid inadvertent contact with these parts. Doors, hinged panels, and the like shall be secured to prevent swinging into a worker and causing the worker to contact exposed energized parts.

k. Conductive materials and equipment

Conductive materials and equipment that are in contact with any part of a worker's body shall be handled in a manner that will prevent them from contacting exposed energized conductors or circuit parts.

For instance, a worker should measure the length of a sledgehammer and the expected radius of his swing prior to using the hammer near an energized circuit. If such a circuit is present, a sign must be posted to warn the workers. The job supervisor must inform the workers of the location of the lines, the hazards involved, and the protective measures to be taken.

l. Portable ladders

Portable ladders shall have nonconductive siderails if they are used where the worker or the ladder could contact exposed energized parts. Conductive (Aluminum) ladders are prohibited.

m. Conductive apparel

Conductive articles of jewelry and clothing (such as watch bands, bracelets, rings, key chains, necklaces, metalized aprons, cloth with conductive thread, or metal headgear) shall not be worn if they might contact exposed energized parts. However, such articles may be worn if they are rendered nonconductive by covering, wrapping, or other insulating means. Jewelry must meet the requirements of the Cooper Steel Jewelry Policy.

n. Housekeeping duties

Where live parts present an electrical contact hazard, workers shall not perform housekeeping duties at such close distances to the parts that there is a possibility of contact, unless adequate safeguards (such as insulating equipment or barriers) are provided.

Electrically conductive cleaning materials (including conductive solids such as steel wool, metalized cloth, and silicon carbide, as well as conductive liquid solutions) shall not be used in proximity to energized parts unless procedures are followed which will prevent electrical contact.

o. Interlocks

Only a qualified person following the requirements of this section may defeat an electrical safety interlock, and then only temporarily while working on the equipment. The interlock system shall be returned to its operable condition when this work is completed.

p. Grounding, GFCIs and Assured Grounding Procedures

Equipment, tools, and cord sets shall be provided and used to protect workers from electrical shock and to prevent fire.

q. Equipment and tools

Note: Portable equipment which is "double insulated" and endorsed by a nationally recognized testing facility need not have a grounding conductor but is subject to the inspection requirements of this section.

Tools and equipment subject to inspection and testing include:

i. Portable Electrical Tools such as grinders, drills, and stapling guns
ii. Stationary tools such as table saws, drill presses, and jig saws
iii. Portable electrical extension cords
iv. Portable and Temporary lighting systems and cords

Receptacles shall be of the grounding type and their contacts shall be grounded by connection to the equipment grounding conductor of the circuit supplying that receptacle in accordance with the National Electrical Code (NEC).

r. Visual inspection

Visual inspection of tools and equipment is required prior to each use and shall include:

i. General condition
ii. Plugs and caps, and presence of ground prong
iii. Electrical cord sets

iv. External defects, and missing parts

Defective tools shall be tagged, taken out of service, and placed in a secured location until they are repaired or destroyed.

s. Testing

The following tests shall be performed on all applicable equipment:

i. Equipment grounding conductors shall be tested for continuity and shall be electrically continuous
ii. Receptacle and attachment cap or plug shall be tested for correct attachment of the equipment-grounding conductor. The equipment-grounding conductor shall be connected to its terminal

Required tests should be performed as indicated below:

iii. Before first use
iv. Before being returned to service following any repairs
v. Before being used, after any incident that can be reasonably suspected to have caused damage (for example, when a cord set is run over)
vi. At intervals not to exceed 3 months

Test equipment must be evaluated for proper operation immediately before and after tests are conducted.

t. Removal from service

Any equipment failing any test shall be taken out of service, shall be tagged with a "Danger, Do Not Use" tag, secured and repaired or destroyed.

6. Ground Fault Circuit Interrupters (GFCI's)

a. Ground Fault Circuit Interrupters (GFCI's) shall be used on receptacles >15 amps up to and including 30 amps for tool and equipment used in construction applications and potentially wet environments (either indoors or outdoors). Receptacles of temporary wiring systems and portable generators shall be protected with a GFCI.

The minimum requirements relative to the use of Ground Fault Circuit Interrupters are:

i. Prior to use verify that the GFCI is in good working order. (e.g., Plug the GFCI into an outlet, plug a power tool or light in to the GFCI, hit the "test" button and verify that it interrupts current flow). Periodically re-test the GFCI to ensure continued effectiveness.
ii. Remove from service any GFCI that has insufficient load capacity, is damaged or is ineffective for any reason. Affix a "Danger, Do Not Use" tag and store the GFCI in a secure location until it can be replaced or repaired. Destroy and discard any GFCI that cannot be repaired or re-used.

b. Train workers in the provisions of this section as related to safe use of GFCIs. This training should include:

i. Double insulated tools
ii. Defective cords and plugs
iii. Heavy moisture, and wet conditions

iv. Operation, selection, and use of GFCI's

7. **Assured Grounding Program**
   When it is not possible to use GFCI's, the Assured Grounding procedures in this section shall apply. If unavoidable, the elements of this program shall include as a minimum:
   a. Written description of program
   b. Program coordinator
   c. Inspections
   d. Documented Testing
   e. Availability of Equipment
   f. Integrity of testing equipment (repairs/testing of test equipment)
   g. Handling of defective tools and equipment
   h. Who will perform tests, and repairs
   i. Recordkeeping
   j. How receptacles will be provided with GFCI's
   k. Only qualified persons shall perform inspection and of tools and equipment.

8. **Clearances in the Workplace**
   a. Workers shall not be permitted to work in such proximity to any part of an electric power circuit that the worker could contact the electric power circuit in the course of work unless the worker is protected against electric shock by deenergizing the circuit and grounding it (if appropriate) or by guarding it effectively by insulation or other means.
   b. Supervisors and/or Competent Person(s) shall ascertain by inquiry, direct observation, or by instruments, whether any part of an energized electric power circuit, exposed or concealed, is so located that the performance of the work may bring any person, tool, or machine into physical or electrical contact with the electric power circuit. The supervisor/Competent Person shall post and maintain proper warning signs where such a circuit exists. The supervisor/Competent Person shall advise workers of the location of such lines, the hazards involved, and the protective measures to be taken.
   c. Barriers or other means of guarding shall be provided to ensure that workspace for electrical equipment will not be used as a passageway during periods when energized parts of electrical equipment are exposed.

9. **Fuses**
   a. Installing or removing fuses shall be considered as work with live electrical energy and shall be followed according to this policy section for operations conducting such activities.

b. Persons who perform work on high voltage fuses (over 600 volts) shall wear appropriate head, face, body flash suits, protective footwear, and insulated gloves.
c. Insulating electrical gloves, sleeves, aprons, and other protective electrical clothing shall be tested for leaks and integrity prior to initial use and periodically.
d. Protector gloves shall be worn over insulating gloves, except as defined in the above referenced standard.
e. Only manufacturer-qualified personnel shall inspect and make repairs to electrical insulating protective clothing.

10. Workspace Clearances - 480 Volts, nominal, or less

a. Working space about electric equipment Sufficient access and working space should be provided and maintained for electric equipment to permit ready and safe operation and maintenance of such equipment.
b. Working clearances Except as required or permitted elsewhere in this section, the dimension of the working space in the direction of access to live parts operating at 480 volts or less and likely to require examination, adjustment, servicing, or maintenance while live shall not be less than indicated in the table below.

   In addition to the dimensions shown in the following table, the workspace shall not be less than 30 inches wide in front of the electric equipment. Distances shall be measured from the live parts if they are exposed or from the enclosure front or opening if the live parts are enclosed. Walls constructed of concrete, brick, or tiles are considered to be grounded.

   Working space is not required behind assemblies such as dead-front switchboards or motor control centers where there are no renewable or adjustable parts such as fuses or switches on the back and where connections are accessible from locations other than the back.

Minimum Depth of Clear Working Space in Front of Electric Equipment (feet)			
Nominal voltage to ground conditions*	**(a)***	**(b)***	**(c)***
0-150	3	3	3
151-480	3	3 1/2	4
*Conditions (a), (b), and (c) are as follows: (a) Exposed live parts on one side and no live or grounded parts on the other side of the working space, or exposed live parts on both sides effectively guarded by insulating material. Insulated wire or insulated bus bars operating at not over 300 volts are not considered live parts. (b) Exposed live parts on one side and grounded parts on the other side. (c) Exposed live parts on both sides of the workspace [not guarded as provided in Condition (a)] with the operator between.			
Note: For International System of Units (SI): one foot=0.3048m.			

Working space required in this section shall not be used for storage. When normally enclosed live parts are exposed for inspection or servicing, the working space, if in a passageway or general open space shall be guarded.
At least one entrance should be provided to give access to the working space for electrical equipment.
Where there are live parts normally exposed on the front of switchboards or motor control centers, the working space in front of such equipment shall not be less than 3 feet.
The minimum headroom of working spaces for service equipment, switchboards, panel boards, or motor control centers shall be 6 feet 3 inches.

11. Guarding Of Live Parts

Except as required or permitted live parts of electrical equipment operating at 50 volts or more shall be guarded against accidental contact by cabinets or other forms of enclosures, or by any of the following means:

a. By location in a room, vault, or similar enclosure that is accessible only to qualified persons
b. By partitions or screens so arranged that only qualified persons will have access to the space within reach of the live parts. Any openings in such partitions or screens shall be so sized and located that person are not likely to come into accidental contact with the live parts or to bring conducting objects into contact with them
c. By location on a balcony, gallery, or platform so elevated and arranged as to exclude unqualified persons

In locations where electric equipment could be exposed to physical damage, enclosures or guards should be so arranged and of such strength to prevent damage. Entrances to rooms and other guarded locations containing exposed live parts shall be marked with conspicuous warning signs forbidding unqualified persons to enter.

12. Enclosure For Electrical Installations

a. Electrical installations in a vault, room, closet or in an area surrounded by a wall, screen, or fence, access to which is controlled by lock and key or other equivalent means, are accessible to qualified persons only.
b. A wall, screen, or fence less than 8 feet in height is not considered adequate to prevent access unless it has other features that provide a degree of isolation equivalent to an 8-foot fence. The entrances to buildings, rooms or enclosures containing exposed live parts or exposed conductors operating at over 600 volts, nominal, shall be kept locked or shall be under the observation of a qualified person at all times.

13. Installations Accessible To Qualified Persons Only

Electrical installations having exposed live parts shall be accessible to qualified persons only and shall comply with the requirements of this standard and applicable regulatory standards.

14. **Installations Accessible To Unqualified Worker(S)**
Electrical installations that are open to unqualified workers shall be made with metal-enclosed equipment or shall be enclosed in a vault or in an area, access to which is controlled by a lock. Metal-enclosed switchgear, unit substations, transformers, pull boxes, connection boxes, and other similar associated equipment shall be marked with appropriate caution signs. If equipment is exposed to physical damage from vehicular traffic, guards shall be provided to prevent such damage. Ventilating or similar openings in metal-enclosed equipment shall be designed so that foreign objects inserted through these openings will be deflected from energized parts.

15. **Workspace About Equipment**
    a. Sufficient space shall be provided and maintained for electrical equipment to permit ready and safe operation and maintenance of such equipment. Where energized parts are exposed, the minimum clear workspace shall not be less than 6 feet 6 inches high (measured vertically from the floor or platform), or less than 3 feet wide (measured parallel to the equipment). The depth shall be as required in the table below. The workspace shall be adequate to permit at least a 90-degree opening of doors or hinged panels.
    b. The minimum clear working space in front of electric equipment such as switchboards, control panels, switches, circuit breakers, motor controllers, relays, and similar equipment shall not be less than specified in the following table, unless otherwise specified. Distances shall be measured from the live parts if they are exposed, or from the enclosure front or opening if the live parts are enclosed.
    c. However, working space is not required behind equipment such as dead front switchboards or control assemblies where there are no renewable or adjustable parts (such as fuses or switches) on the back and where connections are accessible from locations other than the back. Where rear access is required to work on de-energized parts on the back of enclosed equipment, a minimum working space of thirty (30) inches horizontally shall be provided.

Minimum Depth of Clear Working Space in Front of Electric Equipment (feet)			
Nominal voltage to ground conditions*	**(a)***	**(b)***	**(c)***
601 to 2,500	3	4	5
2,501 to 9,000	4	5	6
9,001 to 25,000	5	6	9
25,001 to 75 kV	6	8	10
Above 75kV	8	10	12

*Conditions (a), (b), and (c) are as follows: (a) Exposed live parts on one side and no live or grounded parts on the other side of the working space, or exposed live parts on both sides effectively guarded by insulating materials. Insulated wire or insulated bus bars operating at not over 300 volts are not considered live parts. (b) Exposed live parts on one side and grounded parts on the other side. Walls constructed of concrete, brick, or tiles are considered to be grounded surfaces. (c) Exposed live parts on both sides of the workspace [not guarded as provided in Condition (a)] with the operator between.
Note: For International System of Units (SI): one foot=0.3048m.

16. Lighting Outlets And Points Of Control

The lighting outlets shall be so arranged that workers changing lamps or making repairs to the lighting system will not be endangered by live parts or other equipment. The points of control shall be so located that workers are not likely to come in contact with any live part or moving part of the equipment while turning on the lights.

17. Elevation Of Unguarded Live Parts

Unguarded live parts above working spaces shall be maintained at elevations not less than specified in the following table.

Elevation of Unguarded Energized Parts Above Working Space	
Nominal voltage between phases	**Minimum elevation**
601-7,500	8 feet 6 inches
7,501-35,000	9 feet
Over 35kV	9 feet + 0.37 inches per kV above 35kV
Note: For SI units: one inch=25.4 mm; one foot=0.3048 m.	

18. Entrance And Access To Workspace

At least one entrance not less than 24 inches wide and 6 feet 6 inches high shall be provided to give access to the working space for electrical equipment. On switchboard and control panels exceeding 48 inches in width, there shall be one entrance at each end of such board where practicable. Where bare energized parts at any voltage or insulated energized parts above 600 volts are located adjacent to such entrance, they shall be guarded.

19. Training

Cooper Steel will ensure that:

a. Unqualified workers who face a higher-than-normal risk of electrical exposure or accident will be trained in safety-related work practices that pertain to their job scope.
b. Qualified workers will receive specific training relative to working with or near exposed de-energized and/or energized parts. Electrical safety training will provide clear understanding and expectations of safety-related work practices.

ELECTRICAL SAFETY FORMS

24 LOCKOUT TAGOUT

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-24
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 VERSION: 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   It is the policy of Cooper Steel to ensure compliance with all applicable laws, regulations, standards and best management practices to ensure that each and every employee or outside contractor providing maintenance or service on electrical, hydraulic or pneumatic equipment will place equipment in a zero mechanical state any and all potential energy sources before working on the equipment.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all Cooper Steel employees. These are the minimum requirements and are not considered as all encompassing.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.
   d. This policy will be reviewed annually and at any time there are changes to equipment that would require changes to the LO/TO procedures.

4. **Definitions**
   a. Lockout - The term that means the locking of the energy source of a piece of equipment in such a way that the equipment cannot be energized without the lock being removed.
   b. Electrical lockout- Disconnecting the electrical power from equipment at the source of electric current by pulling a disconnect switch and attaching a lock. Equipment powered by sources other than electricity shall be locked in the following manner as appropriate:
      i. Close the supply valve, chain and lock or remove the handle.
      ii. Bleed the line or lines and disconnect or blank.
      iii. Insert a blocking device and tag it.
   c. Tagout - The placement of a tagout device on an energy isolating device to indicate that the energy isolating device and equipment being controlled may not be operated until the tagout device is removed. All tags shall conform to requirements outlined in 1910.147 of the OSHA General Industry Standards and contain the following information:
      i. Do Not Start; Do Not Energize; Do Not Operate, etc.

ii. Name
iii. Date and Time
iv. Department
v. Purpose

d. Individual Lock - is a lock issued to an employee for their own use, for their own personal protection. The lock shall be issued to the employee with one key and it will be located on the LOTO board; one key will be kept in the locked box in the supervisor's office. The supervisor shall have the only key to the locked box.
e. Equipment Locks – is a lock that will be assigned to specific machines and will be located in the machine specific lockout box.

5. Policy

a. Every employee who works on or near equipment that is powered by an energizing source such as electric, pneumatic, hydraulic, gas, water, steam, chemical, momentum, gravity, or springs is potentially exposed to injury from electrical or stored hazardous energy.
b. Authorized employees shall lockout or tagout, and tryout the equipment PRIOR to performing any maintenance or set-up. (Includes normal production operations if a guard or other safety device is removed or by-passed, or if any part of the body is required to be in the "point of operation", or a danger zone exists during equipment operating cycle). Always consider exposed de-energized parts to be live when working in close proximity to equipment.
c. Selection and Use of Safe Work Practices
    i. Safety-related work practices shall be employed to prevent electric shock or injuries resulting from electrical contacts.
        1. Live parts to which an employee may be exposed shall be de-energized by a qualified employee who has specific knowledge of the magnitude of hazardous stored energy that may be present, using lockout/tagout techniques, as specified in the lockout/tagout Program before the employee works on or near them unless a greater hazard is introduced. The qualified employee shall test to ensure that the previously energized part is de-energized. Using an appropriate tester rated for the voltage. Where more than one employee works on de-energized equipment, group lockout must be used; the designated authorized employee shall coordinate affected workgroups and ensure continuity of protection.
        2. If it is not feasible to de-energize exposed live parts, other safety-related work practices shall be used to protect the exposed employees. Only qualified maintenance employees are permitted to work with exposed energized equipment. Procedures utilized to perform this work shall include special precautionary techniques such as use of personal protective equipment, insulating and shielding material and insulated tools.

3. Work on or near exposed live parts is not permitted without proper illumination (10 lumens minimum).
4. Employees working in confined or enclosed spaces shall de-energize or effectively barricade with protective shields or barriers any exposed live parts. Doors or hinged panels shall be secured to prevent swinging freely.
5. Conductive materials shall be handled in such a manner that will prevent them from encroaching approach boundaries as specified in Table 1. Only non-conductive ladders are allowed for use near energized parts.
6. Conductive apparel such as chains, watches, rings or necklaces shall not be worn while working on or near exposed electrical parts.
7. Interlocks shall not be bypassed unless a qualified person is temporarily working on the equipment and alternative safe procedures are in place. Equipment rated at more than 600 volts, interlocks shall NEVER be bypassed. Arc rated ports may be installed on medium voltage equipment to avoid removing covers for infrared testing.
8. Electrical disconnect switches and breakers shall be labeled including the voltage, name of device controlled and other pertinent information i.e. main disconnect, motor control switch etc.
9. Access to electrical switches, control devices and meters shall be kept free of obstructions with a minimum of 3 feet clear.
10. Employees will adhere to the approach distances outlines in NFPA 70 E Table 130.4.
11. When working on exposed energized parts, qualified employees are responsible for erecting and maintaining approach distance boundaries accordingly for the duration of the work.

ii. Lockout/Tagout is required when:
1. The energizing of a piece of equipment exposes an employee to a hazard when they are working on or near that piece of equipment. Such as when guards are removed or any part of the body is to be in the point of operation
2. The operation of a piece of equipment may cause damage to that equipment.
3. It is necessary to prevent the unauthorized use of equipment.
4. When servicing or performing maintenance on the machine.

iii. Lockout/Tagout Checklist
1. Lockout and tagout of equipment in the fabrication shop will be performed per the lockout tagout checklist. The checklist can be obtained from the Maintenance Department, the Supervisor, and from the Safety Manager. For any equipment that does not have a lockout/tagout checklist consult with Maintenance, the

Shop Foreman, and/or the Safety Manager before attempting to de-energize equipment.
   2. Adequate lighting must be available (minimum 10 lumens), in all areas, for the entire time where electrical components are exposed whether or not the equipment is energized.
iv. Lock Identification
   1. Personal safety [yellow] locks, adapters and Danger tags will be distributed only to trained Cooper Steel personnel and will be located on the LOTO board. These locks are only to be used when placing them on the machine specific lockout box.
   2. Equipment [red] locks will be placed in the machine specific lockout boxes and will be used to place on the LOTO points for that machine. Once placed on the machine the key is to be placed in the LOTO box and apply the personal safety [yellow] locks on the LOTO box. The locks are not to be used as a substitute for the employee's personal [yellow] safety lock.
   3. Equipment [red] locks and adapters can also be obtained and checked out from the LOTO board. These equipment [red] locks and adapters are to protect the equipment during periods of time when work has been suspended or interrupted or not in use.
   4. Personal [yellow] locks and tags shall have the employee's name stamped, engraved, or written on it.

6. **Lockout, Tag Out, Try Out Procedures**
   a. This is a general procedure to comply with prior to locking out or tagging out any equipment. Please refer to the Lock Out Tag Out Procedure Handbook to review equipment specific procedures:
      i. Before starting work on any piece of equipment requiring a lockout or tagout, the individual involved must first obtain permission from the production foreman responsible for the equipment. Also, if proper locking or tagging sequence is in question, check with the production foreman responsible for the equipment.
      ii. Equipment must be shut off at the appropriate energy source and any lines bled if necessary. This will ensure that the proper equipment is de-energized and locked or tagged out.
      iii. The lockout or tagout shall be made at the energy source by the person performing the work with the equipment red locks from the machine LOTO box. Switches or breakers in motor rooms or substations will be thrown or pulled by department personnel and locked out or tagged by ALL individuals performing the work.
      iv. Each person who works on a "locked out/tagged out" piece of equipment shall place their personal yellow lock and tag on the group lockout box.

1. NO GROUP SHALL WORK UNDER ANOTHER GROUP'S LOCK OR TAG! NO INDIVIDUAL SHALL WORK UNDER ANOTHER INDIVIDUAL'S LOCK OR TAG!
2. When multiple locks are required, each authorized employee will place their lockout on the group lockout box.

v. When there is doubt as to the location of the proper energy isolation device(s), the maintenance department or a contracted electrician shall be notified to ensure that the proper isolating device(s) are identified and locked/tagged out to de-energize the system or equipment.

b. Tryout Procedure
   i. The group or individuals performing the work shall, after locking out or tagging out the energy isolating device(s), attempt to operate the equipment before beginning work on the equipment.
   ii. The person trying out the equipment shall always push the stop buttons after testing.
   iii. If equipment DOES energize during the test, push the stop button and immediately contact the supervisor.

c. Removal of Locks or Tags
   i. Each person shall personally remove their own lock or tag. The last employee to remove their lock from the LOTO box shall remove the equipment red locks and place them back in the box. It shall be a safety violation, RESULTING IN DISCIPLINARY ACTION, to remove another person's lock or tag.
   ii. If work extends into subsequent shifts and individual locks or tags are being used, the original shift members must remove their own locks/tags at the end of their shift. The persons involved on all subsequent shifts shall lockout, tagout, and tryout in accordance with the above procedure.
   iii. When an employee has left their lock or tag on for an unknown reason and it has to be removed, the following procedure shall be adhered to:
      1. If the employee is in the plant, employee shall remove lock/tag.
      2. If the employee has left the plant, every effort shall be made to contact the employee to determine the reason for leaving the lock or tag in place.
      3. If the employee cannot be located either in the plant or at home, the following procedure shall be followed:
         a. The department supervisor, along with a member of the same work group as the employee, must check out the equipment and make sure it is safe to remove the lock or tag. The safety lock/tag can then be removed.
         b. The supervisor and member of the same group must fill out the back side of the tag with their signature and the reason for removal, or tag the removed lock with the same information.

c. The removed tag or tagged lock must then be forwarded to the department superintendent with details of the incident for further action.
d. A report of the incident shall be sent to the Safety Department for follow up and corrective action.
e. If this occurs, the production foreman for the equipment shall be present when the lock/tag is removed. This employee shall ensure that other employees will not be endangered, and the equipment will not be damaged when it is energized.
f. The employee shall not resume any work until they have been informed that their lock has been removed.

d. Procedure For Equipment That Cannot Be Physically Locked Out
   i. Due to the age and design of some equipment in the plant, it may not be possible to "physically" lockout some equipment. Every effort should be made to attach a device to these systems so they can be physically locked out.
   ii. For switches and valves where lockout provisions are not provided, special modifications may be necessary to correct such inadequacies.
   iii. After October 31, 1989, whenever major replacement, repair, renovation, or modification of machines or equipment is performed, and whenever new machinery of equipment is installed, energy isolating devices for such machines or equipment shall be designed to accept a lockout device.
      1. Electrical Equipment and components:
         a. Only qualified and trained personnel will work on electrical equipment and components.
         b. Insulating shielding equipment and barriers will be used as necessary.
         c. Breakers shall be placed in "open" position, pulled from cell where necessary and then tagged by the individual performing the work.
         d. Knife switches shall be pulled to open the circuit and tagged. Access to the switch shall be restricted by a barrier or enclosure.
         e. Tags, (with the information listed in "Tagout" above) shall be placed on all open breakers and at other strategic locations, (machine start buttons, etc.) by the individuals involved, notifying all people in the area that the equipment is being repaired.
      2. Other Energized Equipment - The following are other types of safeguards that shall be taken when it is impossible to "physically" lock out the equipment:
         a. Blanks in the lines.
         b. "Break" lines and drop a section out on all sides of work being performed.

c. Physically disconnect and tag the energy supply for the equipment to be repaired.
d. Release or physically block any device with stored or potential energy in the system.
e. Place an employee of the same group that is working on the equipment, and who is properly instructed, at the disconnect as a “safety person” to ensure that equipment is NOT inadvertently energized.

7. **Lockout Tagout Procedures for Outside Contractors**
   a. When it is necessary for outside contractors to lockout or tagout equipment, the following shall be required:
      i. The maintenance, production, or engineering supervisor assigned to the project shall follow the procedures outlined in this policy and lock or tag equipment.
      ii. The contractor shall accompany the supervisor or his representative while the lockout/tagout procedure is being performed and attach HIS OWN LOCKS/TAGS.
      iii. The supervisor of the project and contractor shall be responsible for removing their OWN locks/tags when the work is complete.
   b. There will be NO EXCEPTIONS to this rule. Disciplinary action shall be taken by the contractor on his employees for failure to abide by Cooper Steel Fabricators’ procedure.

8. **Training**
   a. Facility safety managers will ensure that all applicable employees are trained in the requirements of this policy as part of their initial orientation and annually. Training shall be documented, and training records shall be maintained on file at the facility.
   b. Re-training will be required when there is a change in job assignments, in machines, a change in the energy control procedures, a new hazard is introduced, or for an employee that commits a violation concerning electrical safety.

25 RIGGING SAFETY

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-25
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. The purpose of this rigging safety program is to establish and maintain a comprehensive system for safe rigging and hoisting operations, protecting personnel from injury, preventing damage to equipment and materials, and ensuring compliance with all applicable safety regulations.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel employees engaged in rigging and lifting activities.

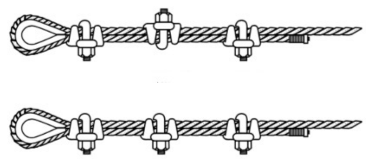
3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.

4. **Introduction**
    a. Rigging and hoisting refers to the lifting and moving of loads using mechanical devices such as hoists, slings, wire ropes, shackles, chain-falls, etc. Improper design, use, or maintenance of hoists, lifting devices, and rigging equipment can cause equipment to fail or a load to be dropped, which can result in significant property loss, personnel injury, or death. Employees that perform rigging activities have a critical role in helping to make sure each lift is a safe lift.

5. **General Rigging Safety Requirements**
    a. Only qualified personnel are authorized to perform rigging activities.
    b. Always inspect lifting equipment, cables, straps and rigging before using them each day.
    c. Defective equipment SHALL be removed from service immediately and destroyed to prevent inadvertent reuse.
    d. Rigging equipment not in use shall be removed from the immediate work area so as not to present a hazard to employees and protect the rigging from the elements.

e. Never exceed the designed load capacity for any lifting device or rigging equipment.
f. Do not walk or stand under any suspended loads unless authorized to do so.
g. Do not place your hands/fingers between a sling and its load while the sling is being tightened around the load.
    i. When more than one person is involved in the rigging process all personnel will raise their hands in view of the hoist operator when ready to lift.
    ii. The hoist operator will confirm all hands are away from the rigging and all personnel are clear of the load before proceeding with the lift.
h. Keep all body parts away from the areas between the sling and the load and between the sling and the crane or hoist hook.
i. Remain clear of loads about to be lifted and suspended. Use tag lines when necessary.
j. Employees are prohibited from riding on any lift, hook chain, or cable sling suspended from a crane or hoist.
k. Keep suspended loads clear of all obstructions.
l. Ensure that, in a choker hitch, the choke point is only on the sling body, NEVER on a splice or fitting
m. Do not rest or drop a load on a chain.
n. Do not pull a sling from under a load when the load is resting on the sling.
o. Do not drag slings on the floor or over abrasive surfaces.
p. Ensure that slings are not constricted, bunched, or pinched by the load, hook, or any fitting.
q. Eliminate all twists, knots or kinks before lifting.
r. Do not shorten or lengthen a sling by knotting or twisting.
s. Do not point load hooks. The load should be seated properly within the throat opening and centered in bowl of the hook.
t. Balance the load to avoid undue stress on one leg of multi-leg slings.
u. Never bounce, jerk or shock load a sling when lifting or lowering items. Remove slack by slowly applying the load to the chain.
v. Avoid sudden starts and stops when moving loads.
w. Do not use slings, eye bolts, shackles, or hooks that have been cut, welded, or brazed.
x. The load capacity limits SHALL be stamped or affixed to all rigging components. If missing, remove from service immediately.
y. Makeshift links or fasteners or other such attachments SHALL NOT be used.
z. Store slings in a dry area out of direct sunlight, extreme temperatures, moisture, mechanical damage or corrosive environments.
aa. Install wire rope clips (cable clamps) properly. Use the correct size and number of clips.
bb. Never install U-bolts on the live end of the wire rope. The live end is where the saddle goes, so remember, “NEVER saddle a dead horse”.

Correct



Incorrect

6. **Lift Planning**

   Ask the following questions when planning a lift:

   a. Who is the designated competent person/qualified rigger for the rigging?
   b. Has the rigging equipment been inspected?
   c. Does the rigging have proper identification?
   d. Does all rigging equipment have known working load limits?
   e. What is the weight of the load?
   f. Where is the load’s center of gravity?
   g. What is the sling angle?
   h. Will there be any side or angular loading?
   i. Are the slings padded against sharp edges?
   j. Are the working load limits adequate?
   k. Is the load rigged to the center of gravity?
   l. Is the hitch appropriate for the load?
   m. Is a tag line required to control load?
   n. Will personnel be clear of suspended loads?
   o. Will the load lift level and be stable?
   p. Are there any unusual environmental concerns?
   q. Are there any special requirements?

   Rigging must be used within manufacturer’s recommendations and industry standards that include OSHA, ASME, ANSI, API and others.

7. **Rigging a Load**

   Perform the following when rigging a load:

   a. Determine the weight of the load. DO NOT GUESS.
   b. Determine the proper size for slings and components. Look for a permanently attached identification tag on each sling stating the size, grade, rated capacity and the name of the sling manufacturer. If the identification is not attached, take the defective equipment out of service.
   c. Make sure that shackle pins and shouldered eye bolts are installed in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations.
   d. Use safety hoist rings (swivel eyes) as a preferred substitute for eye bolts wherever possible.
   e. Use wear pads to protect slings from sharp edges. Remember that edges may not feel sharp to the touch but could cut into rigging when under several tons of load. Wood, tire rubber, or other pliable materials may be suitable for padding.

f. Verify that each sling is capable of supporting the load based on the projected horizontal angle of the sling during the lift.
g. Calculate the sling tension before the lift to ensure that it can support the load.
h. Determine the center of gravity and balance the load before moving the load. Initially lift the load only a few inches to test the rigging and balance.
i. Hooks shall not be used in such a manner as to place a side load, back load, or tip load on the hook.
j. Tag lines **SHALL** be used when required to prevent the load from swinging during the lift and to keep hands clear of pinch points when controlling loads.
k. The Lift Supervisor will determine if long tag lines will be required to control the load from the starting position to the final landing position.
l. When tag lines are used the person controlling the load will not wrap the tag line around their arm, leg, or body to increase control of the load.
m. Tag lines shall be made of non-conductive material.

8. Multiple Lift Rigging Procedure

a. A multiple lift shall only be performed if the following criteria are met:
    i. A multiple lift rigging assembly is used;
    ii. A maximum of five members are hoisted per lift;
    iii. Only beams and similar structural members are lifted; and
    iv. All employees engaged in the multiple lift have been trained in these procedures in the nature of the hazards involved with multiple lifts and the proper equipment used for multiple lifts.
b. No crane is permitted to be used for a multiple lift where such use is contrary to the manufacturer's specifications and limitations.
c. Components of the multiple lift rigging assembly shall be specifically designed and assembled with a maximum capacity for total assembly and for each individual attachment point. This capacity, certified by the manufacturer or a qualified rigger, shall be based on the manufacturer's specifications with a 5 to 1 safety factor for all components.
d. The total load shall not exceed:
    i. The rated capacity of the hoisting equipment specified in the hoisting equipment load charts.
    ii. The rigging capacity specified in the rigging rating chart.
e. The multiple lift rigging assembly shall be rigged with members:
    i. Attached at their center of gravity and maintained reasonably level.
    ii. Rigged from top down.
    iii. Rigged at least 7 feet apart.
f. The members on the multiple lift rigging assembly shall be set from the bottom up.
g. Controlled load lowering shall be used whenever the load is over the connectors.

9. Rigger Responsibilities

a. Must be trained in rigging procedures.

b. Utilize appropriate rigging gear suitable for overhead lifting.
c. Utilize the rigging gear within industry standards and the manufacturer's recommendations.
d. Conduct daily inspection and maintenance of the rigging.

10. General Rigging Inspection

a. A visual inspection shall be performed by the user or a designated person each day before the rigging is used.
b. A periodic inspection shall be performed and documented by a competent person, at least annually. The rigging hardware shall be examined and a determination made as to whether it constitutes a hazard.
c. **Rejection Criteria of Rigging Hardware (pre ASME B30.26)**
   i. Missing or illegible manufacturer's name or trademark and/or rated load identification (or size required)
   ii. A 10% or more reduction of the original dimension
   iii. Bent, twisted, distorted, stretched, elongated, cracked or broken load bearing components.
   iv. Excessive nicks, gouges, pitting and corrosion.
   v. Indications of heat damage including weld spatter or arc strikes, evidence of unauthorized welding.
   vi. Loose or missing nuts, bolts, cotter pins, snap rings, latches, or other fasteners and retaining devices.
   vii. Unauthorized replacement components or other visible conditions that cause doubt as to the continued use of the sling.
   viii. Additionally, inspect wedge sockets for:
      1. Indications of damaged wire rope or wire rope slippage
      2. Improper assembly
   ix. Additionally, inspect wire rope clips for:
      1. Insufficient number of clips
      2. Incorrect spacing between clips
      3. Improperly tightened clips
      4. Indications of damaged wire rope or wire rope slippage
      5. Improper assembly

11. General Inspection of Slings

a. A visual inspection for damage shall be performed by the user or designated person each day or shift the sling is used.
b. Additional inspections shall be performed during sling use where service conditions warrant.
c. A complete inspection for damage shall be performed periodically by a designated person, at least annually. Written records of the most recent periodic inspection shall be maintained.
d. Damaged or defective slings shall be immediately removed from service.
e. **General Rejection Criteria for Slings**
   i. Missing or illegible sling identification.
   ii. Evidence of heat damage.
   iii. Slings that are knotted.
   iv. Fittings that are pitted, corroded, cracked, bent, twisted, gouged, or broken.
   v. Other conditions, including visible damage, that cause doubt as to the continued use of the sling.

f. **Rejection Criteria for Wire Rope Slings**
    i. Excessive broken wires, for strand-laid and single part slings, 10 randomly distributed broken wires in one rope lay or 5 broken wires in one strand in one rope lay.
    ii. Severe localized abrasion or scraping, kinking, crushing, bird caging.
    iii. Any other damage resulting in damage to the rope structure.
    iv. Severe corrosion of the rope or end attachments.
    v. Evidence of heat damage.

g. **Rejection Criteria for Chain Slings**
    i. Cracks or breaks.
    ii. Excessive wear, nicks or gouges.
    iii. Stretched chain links or components.
    iv. Bent, twisted or deformed chain links or components.
    v. Excessive pitting or corrosion.
    vi. Lack of ability of chain or components to hinge freely.
    vii. Weld splatter.

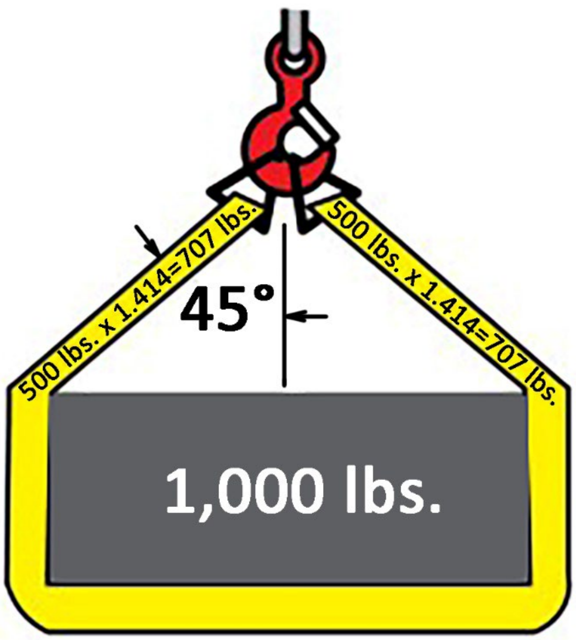
h. **Rejection Criteria for Synthetic Slings**
    i. Acid or caustic burns.
    ii. Melting or charring of any part of the sling.
    iii. Holes, tears, cuts, or snags.
    iv. Broken or worn stitching in load bearing splices.
    v. Excessive abrasive wear.
    vi. Discoloration and brittle or stiff areas on any part of the sling, which may mean chemical or ultraviolet/sunlight damage.

i. **Rejection Criteria for Endless Round Slings**
    i. Acid or caustic burns.
    ii. Evidence of heat damage.
    iii. Holes, tears, cuts, abrasive wear or snags that expose the core yarns.
    iv. Broken or damaged core yarns.
    v. Weld splatter that exposes core yarns.
    vi. Discoloration and brittle or stiff areas on any part of the slings, which may mean chemical or other damage.

j. **Rejection Criteria for Hooks**
    i. Missing or illegible hook manufacturer's identification
    ii. Missing or illegible rated load identification
    iii. Excessive pitting or corrosion
    iv. Cracks, nicks, or gouges
    v. Wear—any wear exceeding 10% (or as recommended by the manufacturer) of the original section dimension of the hook or its load pin
    vi. Deformation—any visible apparent bend or twist from the plane of the unbent hook
    vii. Throat opening—any distortion causing an increase in throat opening of 5% not to exceed 1/4", or as recommended by the manufacturer
    viii. Inability to lock—any self-locking hook that does not lock
    ix. Inoperative latch (if provided)—any damaged latch or malfunctioning latch that does not close the hook's throat
    x. Evidence of heat exposure or unauthorized welding
    xi. Evidence of unauthorized alterations such as drilling, machining, grinding, or other modifications

12. **Angle Effect on Sling Stress**

a. As the angle between the legs of the sling increases, the load each leg has to lift increases. This applies to a single sling used in a basket hitch as well as a multi-leg sling or bridle.
b. First, divide the total load to be lifted by the number of legs to be used. This provides the load per leg if the lift were being made with all the legs lifting vertically.
c. Determine the angle between the legs of the sling and the vertical.
d. Then multiply the load per leg by the load factor for the leg angle being used (from the table below) to compute the actual load on each leg for this lift and angle.
e. **Example: In the example below (sling angle of 45 degrees from vertical):**
    i. Total Load Weight= 1000 lbs./2 legs= 500 lbs. each
    ii. Load per leg= 500 x 1.414 (45 degree load factor) = 707 lbs.
    iii. **707 lbs. is the actual load on each leg at 45 degree from vertical angle.**
f. **Note: The actual load must not exceed the rated sling capacity.**



Leg Angle (degrees from vertical)	Load Factor
0	1.000
5	1.003
10	1.015
15	1.035
20	1.064
25	1.103
30	1.154
35	1.220
40	1.305
45	**1.414**
50	1.555
55	1.743

26 MOBILE ELEVATED WORK PLATFORMS

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-26
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   a. Mobile Elevated Work Platforms (MEWP's) are important pieces of equipment used every day at Cooper Steel. These lifts can be very dangerous if misused. The environments that employees work in produce many different hazards for these lifts. With proper training and procedures, Cooper Steel can reduce these hazards and help prevent accidents from occurring. This program was developed and implemented to establish a safe work environment for all employees and surrounding personnel.

2. **Scope**
   a. This policy applies to all employees operating mobile elevated work platforms.

3. **Responsibility**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.
   d. It is the employee's responsibility to use all equipment properly, follow all company and manufacturer's procedures, report all hazards and damaged equipment, and wear correct personal protective equipment.

4. **Mobile Elevated Work Platform Safety Requirements**
   a. Prior to beginning aerial tasks, inspect the area that you will be operating in for conditions that may compromise the stability of the aerial lift (ie. Mud, sand, loose gravel, debris, etc.).
   b. The manufacturer's instruction manual must be present at all times (if missing, report immediately).
   c. Boom-lift maximum occupancy will not exceed manufacturers guidelines.
   d. Boom-lift weight capacity will not be exceeded.
   e. Always use MEWP on level ground.
   f. If any damage is found, report and remove from service immediately.
   g. Never alter equipment or safety devices under any circumstances.
   h. Be sure manufacturer's instruction manual is present at all times (if missing, report immediately).
   i. Never lean ladder against lifts.
   j. Test all function controls before use.
   k. Dead-man type safety switches and controls shall not be bypassed.
   l. Always be familiar with warning labels.

m. Only certified employees are permitted to operate lifts.
n. Occupants must have an understanding of how to safely lower the basket in an emergency.
o. Be aware of all overhead obstructions. Allow an adequate amount of clearance. (electrical clearance is explained below)
p. If at any time the scent of fuel detected, do not start lift.
q. When refueling, be sure to proceed in a safe, open area. Never fuel a machine with motor running. Have a 20 lb. fire extinguisher present and remember: NO SMOKING.
r. Spotters are required in congested areas. Spotters will be familiar with the jobsite hazards and will have no other duties when acting as a spotter for mobile elevated work platforms.
s. Never travel long distances with lifts erected.

5. **Mobile Elevated Work Platform Fall Protection Requirements**
    a. A full body harness must be worn and used with a lanyard attached to an engineered anchor point at all times in a MEWP regardless of height.
    b. Tying off to the handrails is prohibited.
    c. Tying off to an adjacent pole, structure, or equipment is prohibited.
    d. Employees shall always stand firmly on the floor of the basket.
    e. No employees shall be permitted to perform work from the toeboard, midrail or toprail of a lift.
    f. It is not permitted to use planks, ladders, or other devices for a work position while working from a MEWP.
    g. Access and egress from the basket at height must be through the gate. Employees may not climb rails to enter or exit the basket.

6. **Electrical Hazards**
    MEWPs are not designed with insulation to prevent electrical current from traveling through them. Therefore, operators must be aware of electrical lines and energized equipment through pre-planning. Operators must follow the Minimum Safe Approach Distance chart when encountering electrical lines and energized equipment. Only qualified employees are allowed to approach electrical powerlines below these minimum distances unless the lines are de-energized and grounded.

VOLTAGE	**MINIMUM SAFE APPROACH DISTANCE**
0KV TO 50KV	10 FEET
Over50KV TO 200KV	15 FEET
Over 200KV to 350KV	20 FEET
Over 350KV to 500KV	25 FEET
Over 500KV TO 750KV	35 FEET
Over 750KV to 1000K	45 FEET

When lifts may be exposed to other electrical hazards such as cable trays, electrical service, switchboards, panelboards, circuit panels, the K tables in Subpart K of the 1926 standards must be followed. At no time may any lift be closer than 3’ to any energized piece of equipment.

7. **Electrical Hazard Requirements**
    a. Never touch a machine that has made contact with an electrical current.
    b. Allow for sway or sag when working near electrical current.
    c. Never use the machine as a ground for welding procedures.
    d. Notify the Supervisor when encountered with an electrical hazard.

8. **Collision Hazards**
    a. Be aware of blind spots.
    b. Always look for caught-in or -between hazards (pinch-point).
    c. Always lower lift basket when moving laterally to a minimum vertical clearance of 6’ from the top rail to any obstruction.
    d. Only travel at a speed appropriate for ground conditions.
    e. Look for the forward and backward arrows before traveling.
    f. Know your machine. Some lifts have safety devices built in; such as an automatic stop when traveling and raising lift at the same time.
    g. In tight and/or congested areas always have a spotter on the ground to help you move the lift. Ensure your spotter stays within your field of view the entire time you are moving the lift. If you lose sight of your spotter STOP MOVEMENT IMMEDIATELY until line of sight is re-established.

9. **Emergency Procedures**
    a. If you sense or notice any type of danger, immediately stop the lift and identify the problem.
    b. In the event of an emergency, the first step is to evaluate the scene. Do not enter unless the conditions are safe. The second step is to call the immediate Supervisor for help.
    c. In the event of a tip-over, do not try to jump out (it should not be possible – you should be tied-off). The correct safety procedure is to drop to your buttocks and hold on firmly to the inner rail. If the lift is not equipped with an inner rail, grab onto the basket frame on the opposite side of the tip.
    d. If personnel are injured, assist the victim to the best of your knowledge. Only certified personnel are to administer first-aid/CPR.

CHROME VI / CADMIUM AWARENESS

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-27
SUPERSEDES: VERSION: 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. The purpose of this program is to establish requirements for the use and handling of materials that may expose employees to cadmium and/or hexavalent chromium. Based on an evaluation of historical and objective data, Cooper Steel does not anticipate exposure during work activities involving routine materials and procedures. While Cooper Steel does not expect any exposure to Cadmium or Hexavalent Chromium, if the job or project that we are working is determined to contain or potentially expose our employees, then we will work with the client to first determine if the hazard can be engineered out or if we will need to establish a protocol using this policy to safely perform the work. The equipment and processes that typically contain Cadmium or Hexavalent Chromium will be identified by the work permit and or job hazard analysis systems. Procedures for elimination or minimization of exposure will be the 1st line of defense.

2. **Scope**
    a. This program covers all employees.

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. The Safety Department shall:
        i. Conduct periodic exposure assessment.
        ii. As appropriate, assist management/supervision in ensuring that workers have the necessary training and medical surveillance based upon the activity and hazard.
        iii. In evaluating chromium or cadmium hazards and specify controls for a job:
            1. utilize reliable historical exposure monitoring data generated for other similar operations or activities
            2. utilize objective data, and/or
            3. plan and conduct initial monitoring to determine exposures and assess the effectiveness of hazard controls.
        iv. Conduct initial and periodic exposure monitoring in accordance with National Institute for Occupational Safety and Health (NIOSH)/OSHA methods if lacking historical or objective data.

v. Maintain effective records of potential exposures monitored, so that a historical database can be used to specify controls and eliminate unnecessary and redundant monitoring for future activities.
vi. As necessary, quantitatively determine the presence of chromium or cadmium in materials, substrates, and other media. This may involve the collection of samples for analysis by a qualified laboratory or field testing using acceptable test methods.
vii. Provide results of any chromium or cadmium survey to management/supervision, along with information regarding hazard potential and control measures. As appropriate, make recommendations to management/supervision to maintain, modify, upgrade, or downgrade controls accordingly.

d. Managers/Supervisors
   i. Shall ensure that all employees are aware of the proper work procedures for cadmium and hexavalent chromium
   ii. Shall ensure that initial training is conducted for all employees and that retraining is conducted as needed.
   iii. As part of the JSA and other hazard evaluation processes, identifies and evaluates chromium or cadmium hazards and potential exposures during planning and the conduct of work.
   iv. Reviews and approves the Task-Specific Safety Analysis.
   v. Takes prompt corrective measures (or supports any Competent Person in this role) to eliminate hazards, such as recommending to management/supervision to implement or modify engineering, administrative, work practice, and personal protection (including respiratory protection) controls.
   vi. Support project management/supervision in responding to exposures above the PEL when workers were not adequately protected.
   vii. As appropriate, participates in pre-job and daily worker briefings regarding task-specific chromium or cadmium hazards and controls, work practices/plans (such as JSAs), and other applicable information, including any changes that are made to controls or to the work practices or plans.

e. Employees
   i. Shall follow all requirements regarding the safe work procedures for cadmium and hexavalent chromium.

4. Cadmium Procedure

a. Compliance Program
   Appearance: Cadmium metal-soft, blue-white, malleable, lustrous metal or grayish white powder. Some cadmium compounds may also appear as a brown, yellow, or red powdery substance. Cadmium can cause local skin or eye irritation. Cadmium can affect your health if you inhale or if you swallow it.

Cadmium that may be immediately dangerous to life or health occur in jobs where workers handle large quantities of cadmium dust or fume; heat cadmium-containing compounds or cadmium-coated surfaces; weld with cadmium solders or cut cadmium-containing materials such as bolts.

b. A written compliance program will be implemented when the PEL for cadmium is exceeded at a work site.
c. The following areas shall be addressed within the site compliance program and to ensure emergency plans are in place should a release of cadmium occur:
    i. Potential exposure determination including a description of each operation where cadmium is omitted, machinery use, material processed, controls in place, crew size, employee job responsibilities and maintenance practices.
    ii. Air monitoring data or developing a justification for not conducting monitoring based on previous monitoring/historical data or objective data.
    iii. Engineering controls including the specific means that will be employed to meet compliance.
    iv. A report of technology considered in meeting the PEL.
    v. A detailed schedule of implementation.
    vi. Consideration of respiratory protection.
    vii. A documented, written plan for dealing with emergency situations involving a substantial release of cadmium.
    viii. Work practice program.
    ix. Other relevant information such as protective clothing, housekeeping, hygiene areas and practices (including consideration of shower facilities), consideration of medical surveillance, training and recordkeeping.
d. The written program must be reviewed and updated annually or more often to reflect significant changes in the compliance status for Cooper Steel.
e. The program shall be provided for examination and copying upon request of affected employees, their representatives or OSHA officials.
f. Work activities that result in exposure to chromium or cadmium may include, but are not limited to, the following:
    i. Removal or encapsulation of materials containing chromium or cadmium.
    ii. New construction, alteration, repair, or renovation of structures and substrates that contain chromium or cadmium.
    iii. Torch-cutting, grinding or welding on/near chromium/cadmium containing paints.
    iv. Welding, cutting, burning, or grinding stainless steel, chromium-/cadmium-containing alloy steel, and chromium/cadmium containing alloys.

g. The permissible exposure limit (PEL) for cadmium and hexavalent chromium is five (5) micrograms calculated as an 8-hour time-weighted average over a work shift. The action level (AL) of 2.5 micrograms triggers the following requirements:
    i. Pre-job planning includes, as needed, a thorough identification of chromium or cadmium materials. Identification may include the product name, a Safety Data Sheet (SDS) with the SDS number (if available) or a sample content analysis. Sampling data includes location, sampling method, sampling dates, laboratory identification, and analytical method.
    ii. If documentation is not feasible or has been determined by the project engineer to be unavailable or unreliable, chromium or cadmium content sufficient to exceed the action level for chromium or cadmium is assumed.
    iii. Results of bulk sampling, calculations of potential chromium or cadmium exposure, and other data that demonstrate compliance with this practice (as well as the pertinent standards) are attached to the work package.
    iv. Where chromium or cadmium exposure above the action level is suspected, and in the absence of monitoring data, interim protective measures are established that are equal to or greater than the assumed exposure level.

5. Hexavalent Chromium Procedure

a. Welding, Cutting, and Grinding
   Certain welding and cutting activities have been shown to expose the welder/cutter, and potentially helpers, to hexavalent chromium above the action level when exhaust ventilation is not used. The activities have included the following:
    i. Shielded metal arc welding, Gas metal arc welding,
    ii. Flux cored arc welding, Sub arc welding,
    iii. Torch cutting through chromate-containing paints, grinding chromium-containing metals.

b. The types of metal involved have been stainless steel, chromium-containing alloy steel, and chromium-containing nonferrous alloys. Exposure has also occurred when the welding rod or wire in use contains chromium, and exhaust ventilation is not used.
   Therefore, exhaust ventilation is always prescribed as a control measure when activities with the materials mentioned above are in use unless historical personal monitoring data performed when similar materials, using similar methods, under similar environmental conditions are used shows conclusively that the welder/cutter and helper (if applicable) are not exposed above the action level without regard to respiratory protection.

c. Employees shall not be exposed in excess of the permissible exposure level.

6. **Plasma and Air Arc Cutting and Gouging**
   Plasma and air arc cutting and gouging operations have been shown to expose the worker and helpers within 10 feet of the work to levels of hexavalent chromium above the permissible exposure limit (PEL) under most circumstances and conditions.

7. **Medical Surveillance**
   Medical surveillance must be provided to employees who are exposed above the PEL for 30 days or more per year or exposed in an emergency. Medical surveillance shall be provided when an employee experiences signs or symptoms of the adverse health effects of Hexavalent Chromium (dermatitis, asthma, bronchitis, etc.). Medical evaluations will be provided at no cost to employees. Examinations will be performed by or under the supervision of a physician or other licensed health care professional.

8. **Hygiene**
   Personal hygiene is very important while working with chromium or cadmium products. To avoid accidental ingestion of chromium or cadmium, employees must wash thoroughly (regardless of other controls) prior to eating, chewing, smoking, or drinking.

9. **Practices**
   Cooper Steel Management/supervision supported by safety professional(s) and the Licensed Health Care Provider will conduct the following basic steps to control exposure to chromium or cadmium:
    a. Determine the types of projects, activities, and operations that could involve chromium or cadmium, or chromium or cadmium-containing materials. For those jobs, conduct hazard identification as part of the work design, planning, and control process.
    b. If chromium or cadmium materials are involved, ensure that project safety or a competent person conducts a hazard evaluation to determine the potential exposure and to recommend initial controls.
    c. Develop and implement a Task-Specific Safety Plan when exposure is or is likely to be above the PEL. The JSA will address the scope of work activities; provides initial exposure assessment; and prescribes exposure controls, air-monitoring requirements, work practices, personal protective equipment and additional information as required.
    d. Incorporate recommendations from project safety for chromium or cadmium hazard control measures into any JSA and work control documents.

10. **Exposure Monitoring**
    Periodic monitoring will be conducted at least every 6 months if initial monitoring shows employee exposure. Air monitoring will be performed at the beginning of

each job task. If exposure monitoring results indicate exposure is above the PEL, a written notification must be included with the corrective action being taken to reduce exposure to or below the PEL.

11. Changing and Hygiene Facilities Will Be Provided

Cooper Steel will provide change rooms for decontamination and ensure facilities prevent cross contamination. Washing facilities will be readily accessible for removing chromium from the skin. Workers must wash their hands and face or any other potentially exposed skin before eating, drinking or smoking.

12. Regulated Areas

Regulated areas will be established when exposure to an employee is or is expected to be in excess of the PEL. Regulated areas shall be marked with warning signs to alert employees and access is restricted to authorized persons only.

13. Controls

Cooper Steel is responsible for implementing effective engineering and work practice controls if the exposure level is above the permissible limit for more than 30 days per year. If such controls are not feasible, Cooper Steel shall use engineering/work controls to reduce employee exposure to the lowest levels achievable and shall supplement them with the use of respiratory protection.

14. Recordkeeping:

Cooper Steel is required to maintain and make available an accurate record of all employee exposure monitoring, medical surveillance and training records.

Respiratory Protection is Required & PPE Respirators must be used when engineering controls and work practices cannot reduce employee exposure, during work operations where engineering controls and work practices are not feasible, and emergencies.

Respirators shall be provided in accordance with 1910.134 or 1926.103 (Respiratory Protection as applicable) or Cooper Steel Respiratory Protection Program. Specific requirements contained within 1926.1127 (Cadmium) regarding respiratory protection shall also be followed including:

a. Providing employees with full face piece respirators when they experience eye irritation.
b. Providing HEPA filters for powered and non-powered air-purifying respirators.
c. Providing a powered air-purifying respirator instead of a negative-pressure respirator when an employee entitled to a respirator chooses to use this type of respirator and such a respirator will provide adequate protection to the employee.

PPE will be provided at employees at no cost. PPE must be provided when there is a hazard from skin or eye contact. Gloves, aprons, coveralls, goggles, foot covers etc. Contaminated PPE will be removed at the end of the work shift. Cooper Steel must clean, launder, repair and replace protective clothing as needed.

15. Housekeeping

Surfaces shall be maintained as free as practicable of accumulation of chromium.
All spills and releases of chromium shall be cleaned promptly.
Methods of cleaning include HEPA filtered vacuums, dry or wet sweeping, shoveling or other methods to minimize exposure.

16. Training of Employees

Cleaning equipment must be handled in a manner that minimizes the reentry of chromium into the workplace. Cooper Steel shall provide appropriate types of training for employees who are potentially exposed to chromium or cadmium prior to their initial assignment and annually thereafter.

Cooper Steel will assure employee participation and maintain a record of the training contents. This training includes:

a. Hazard communication training for potentially exposed employees.
b. Chromium hazards, control methods and medical surveillance.
c. Training specified by the applicable chromium or cadmium standard for workers exposed at the action level for any one day, or who are exposed to chromium or cadmium compounds that are skin irritants.
d. Respirator training if respirators are to be used.
e. Provide information to workers regarding task-specific chromium or cadmium hazards and control methods, the JSA, work practices, medical surveillance and other applicable information, including any changes that are made to these controls.
f. Provide training annually, as appropriate, to workers who continue to have exposure to chromium or cadmium at or above the action level on any one day.
g. All training will be recorded and include the identity of the employee trained, the signature of the person who conducted the training and the date of the training.

28 MANAGEMENT OF CHANGE

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-28
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   a. Management of Change (MOC) is designed to ensure that no unforeseen hazards are introduced and the risk of existing hazards to faculty, staff and visitors, or the environment is not unknowingly increased from the procurement of new equipment, through the renovation or construction of buildings or spaces on campus, or changes in procured hazardous materials.
   b. This program includes the review of proposed modifications to facilities or from the procurement of potentially hazardous items or equipment.

2. **Scope**
   a. The policy applies to all personnel who are involved in:
      i. The modification or renovation of physical assets such as buildings, equipment, or in the erection of new buildings.
      ii. The procurement of potentially hazardous items or equipment, not limited to new chemicals or equipment that may cause harm to people or the environment.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.

4. **Definitions**
   a. <u>Management of Change Checklist (MOC) –</u> This is part of the process for projects creating a significant change or new equipment with substantial hazard potential. It is a pre-use and pre-start up assessment conducted during the design, installation, and prior to the release of the space or equipment for use. The safety and functionality of the space or equipment itself are checked to ensure that all safeguards are in place and functioning as intended so potential hazards can be mitigated or prevented.
   b. Leadership, Operations, Maintenance shall:
      i. Request the project owner complete the Management of Change Checklist for Renovation, Building Additions, New Equipment, and Process Change projects prior to procurement and commencing work.
      ii. Partner with the safety department to complete the MOC, if needed.
      iii. Ensure all actions identified from the Management of Change Checklist for Renovation, Building Additions, New Equipment, or Process Change are completed prior to project completion.

        iv. Consult with safety if questions arise when hazards are noted with the new equipment or renovated spaces after the completion of MOC checklist.
    c. Facility Safety Department shall:
        i. Participate in or facilitate MOC checklist.
        ii. Assist departments with developing mitigation efforts when new equipment or changes are requested.
        iii. Review and maintain this program corresponding with best management practices.
        iv. Conduct training on this policy.

5. Management of Change Checklist (MOC)
    a. MOC shall be completed during the design phase.
    b. MOC shall be completed during the installation phase.
    c. MOC shall be completed in the close-out (pre-operation) phase.
    d. All deficiencies shall be addressed prior to the space being released for operations.

MANAGEMENT OF CHANGE EHS REVIEW FORM

29 POWERED INDUSTRIAL TRUCK

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSC-29
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. It is the policy of Cooper Steel Fabricators to ensure compliance with all applicable laws, regulations, standards and best management practices to provide for the safe operation and maintenance of powered industrial trucks.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel facilities and project sites where powered industrial truck/forklifts may be used.

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.
    d. Each Cooper Steel employee that is required to operate a powered industrial truck shall be responsible for its safe operation.
    e. Powered industrial truck operators are responsible for conducting a safety inspection of their truck before each daily operation.

4. **Policy**
    a. Each Cooper Steel location shall ensure that all powered industrial trucks be in good repair and visually inspected before each use/shift. All approved operators shall have received proper training, and that training shall be certified in writing.
    b. All powered industrial trucks shall be equipped with a backup alarm and or warning lights.
    c. All combustible fuel powered industrial trucks shall be equipped with a portable fire extinguisher.
    d. Training Requirements.
        i. All training will be provided by a qualified PIT trainer.
        ii. All PIT training will include :
            1. Formal classroom instruction,
            2. Practical training,
            3. Workplace specific operator evaluation.

iii. All powered industrial truck operators shall receive initial training in the following topics:
    1. Operating instructions, warnings, and precautions for the type of truck the operator will be authorized to operate.
    2. Introduction to Forklifts/Industrial Trucks
    3. Truck controls and instrumentation.
    4. Engine or motor operation.
    5. Steering and maneuvering.
    6. Visibility restrictions.
    7. Fork and attachment adaptation, operation, use and limitations.
    8. Vehicle capacity.
    9. Vehicle stability.
    10. Operator inspection and maintenance requirements.
    11. Refueling and recharging procedures.
    12. Operating limitations.
    13. Specific requirements noted in the Operators Manual.
    14. Workplace conditions, hazards, ramps and slopes.

iv. All powered industrial truck operators shall receive a training program that bases the amount and type of training required on:
    1. The operator's prior knowledge and skill.
    2. The types of powered industrial trucks the operator will operate in the workplace.
    3. The hazards present in the workplace.
    4. The operator's demonstrated ability to operate a powered industrial truck safely.

v. All powered industrial truck operators shall include in their training a review of this policy.

vi. Upon completion of training the employee will be issued a “Forklift Operator License”. The license is valid for three years from the date of training and will include the following information:
    1. Operator name.
    2. Date of training.
    3. Date of operator evaluation.
    4. Identity of person conducting training and evaluation.
    5. Classification of Powered Industrial Truck(s) Operator is qualified to operate.

vii. An evaluation of each industrial truck operator’s performance shall be conducted and documented at least every three years (or more frequently if required by local regulations).

viii. Refresher training is required if:
    1. The operator is involved in an accident or a near-miss incident.
    2. The operator has been observed operating the vehicle in an unsafe manner.
    3. The operator has been determined during an evaluation to need additional training.

4. There are changes in the workplace that could affect safe operation of the truck.
5. The operator is assigned to operate a different type of truck.

e. Specific Requirements.
   i. At the beginning of each shift operators shall complete a documented inspection including but not limited to:
      1. Brakes
      2. Steering
      3. Controls
      4. Forks
      5. Hoist
      6. warning devices
      7. lights
      8. oil leaks
   ii. Discrepancies shall be reported to the supervisor.
   iii. Do not operate a lift truck or hand truck which is unsafe to use.
   iv. Operators of Powered industrial trucks must wear seatbelt restraints if available.
   v. Capacity and operation instruction plates, tags or decals shall be maintained in legible condition.
   vi. Trucks shall not be driven up to anyone standing in front of a fixed object.
   vii. No person shall be allowed to stand or pass under the elevated portion of any truck whether loaded or empty.
   viii. Unauthorized personnel shall not be permitted to ride on powered industrial trucks. Only the operator will ride the industrial truck. This shall include the use of skids or forks as a man-lift.
   ix. It is prohibited for arms or legs to be placed between the uprights of the mast or outside the running lines of the truck.
   x. When leaving a powered industrial truck unattended (a distance greater than 25 feet (8 meters) and/or not in plain view), the load shall be fully lowered, controls shall be neutralized, power shut off, brakes set and key or connector plug removed. Wheels shall be blocked if the truck is parked on an incline.
   xi. A safe distance shall be maintained from the edge of ramps or platforms while on any elevated dock or platform.
   xii. Trailers must be docked to a tractor with the parking brake set, or trailer will be chocked and secured prior to unloading. Fixed jacks may be necessary to support a semi-trailer during loading or unloading when the trailer is not coupled to a tractor.
   xiii. There shall be sufficient headroom under overhead installations, lights, pipes, sprinkler systems, etc.
   xiv. An overhead guard shall be used as protection against falling objects. It should be noted that an overhead guard is intended to offer protection from the impact of small packages, boxed, bagged material,

etc., representative of the job application but not to withstand the impact of a falling capacity load.

xv. A load backrest extension shall be used whenever necessary to minimize the possibility of the load or part of it from falling rearward.

xvi. Only approved industrial trucks shall be used in hazardous locations.

f. Traveling Rules.

i. All traffic regulations shall be observed, including authorized facility speed limits. A safe distance shall be maintained approximately three truck lengths from the truck ahead, and the truck shall be kept under control at all times.

ii. Do not drive forklifts faster than the speed of a brisk walk in congested areas where work is being performed.

iii. The right of way shall be yielded to ambulances, fire trucks or other vehicles in emergency situations.

iv. Other trucks traveling in the same direction at intersections, blind spots, or other dangerous locations shall not be passed.

v. The driver shall be required to slow down and sound the horn at cross aisles and other locations where vision is obstructed. If the load being carried obstructs forward view, the driver shall be required to travel with the load trailing.

vi. At locations where railroad tracks must be crossed, they shall be crossed diagonally wherever possible. Parking closer than eight feet from the center of railroad tracks is prohibited.

vii. The driver shall be required to look in the direction of and keep a clear view of the path of travel.

viii. Grades shall be ascended or descended slowly.

ix. When ascending or descending grades in excess of 10%, loaded trucks shall be driven with the load upgrade.

x. Unloaded trucks should be operated on all grades with the load engaging means downward.

xi. On all grades, the load and load engaging means shall be tilted back if applicable and raised only as far as necessary to clear the road surface.

xii. Under all travel conditions, the truck shall be operated at a speed that will permit it to be brought to a stop in a safe manner.

xiii. Stunt driving and horseplay shall not be permitted.

xiv. The driver shall be required to slow down for wet and slippery floors.

xv. When crossing roadways the driver shall ensure they have 2 spotters (one on each side of the road) with stop signs. The driver shall not cross the road until the spotters are in position and signal it is safe to cross the road.

g. Loading.

i. Rigging is never allowed on or over forks. If rigging is required, connect and secure an approved hoisting device to the forks prior to hoisting.

ii. The weight of any rigging equipment must be deducted from the overall capacity of the forklift.

iii. The lifting capacity must be clearly marked on any rigging attachments.
iv. Only stable or safely arranged loads shall be handled. Caution shall be exercised when handling off-center loads which cannot be centered.
v. Only loads within the rated capacity of the truck shall be handled.
vi. Long or high (including multiple-tested) loads which may affect capacity shall be adjusted.
vii. Trucks equipped with attachments shall be operated as partially loaded trucks when not handling a load.

h. Fueling and Related Rules.
   i. Recharging and or exchange of batteries or LP gas containers shall be conducted in accordance with CST-42 (Procedure for The Safe Operation and Exchange of Batteries and LP-Gas Containers Used on Powered Industrial Trucks).
   ii. No smoking is allowed in any service area.
   iii. Fuel tanks shall not be filled while the engine is running. Spillage shall be avoided.
   iv. Spillage of oil or fuel shall be cleaned up in accordance with supervisor approved procedures, or completely evaporated and the fuel tank cap replaced before restarting the engine.
   v. No truck shall be operated with a leak in the fuel system until the leak has been corrected.
   vi. Open flames shall not be used for checking the electrolyte level in storage batteries or gasoline level in fuel tanks.

5. Reference Documents

a. CSx-42 Batteries and LP-Gas Exchange
b. OSHA requirements for powered industrial trucks (codified at 29 CFR 1910.178).
c. American National Standard for Powered Industrial Trucks, ANSI B56.1, latest edition.

6. Training

a. Facility Safety Managers and Field Safety Managers will ensure that all applicable employees are trained in the requirements of this policy. Training shall be documented, and training records shall be maintained on file at the facility.

30 HOUSEKEEPING

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-30
SUPERSEDES: VERSION: 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   The purpose of this document is to provide definitions and procedures that should be used by all facilities in defining and managing housekeeping and walking-working surfaces within Cooper Steel offices, job sites, and facilities. Where local regulations are more stringent than this requirement, those regulations supersede this requirement.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all Cooper Steel facilities, project sites, and offices.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.

4. **Requirements**
   a. The workplace must be kept in a suitable clean and tidy state.
   b. Aisle-ways must be kept free of hoses, cords, stored materials, and other trip hazards.
   c. Emergency exit routes shall remain free and clear of any materials, debris, or trash that could impede foot traffic in an emergency evacuation.
   d. Items shall not be stored near electrical panels for a minimum of 36 inches of clear space in front of the panel, 30 inches of width (or the width of the panel, whichever is greater), and a vertical clearance of at least 6.5 feet or the height of the equipment, whichever is greater.
   e. Floors must be even and free of holes or other trip hazards.
   f. Staircases must be safe. No materials may be placed on staircases.
   g. Ladders and other equipment should be secured and not left leaning.
   h. Housekeeping inspections should be conducted at each location at least monthly and documented.
   i. Training must be provided to all workers at all work sites to maintain orderliness and housekeeping.
   j. Construction debris such as dunnage and banding will be stacked neatly or disposed of properly in a timely manner.

OSHA INSPECTIONS

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSC-31
SUPERSEDES: VERSION: 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   a. The purpose of this program is to provide employees with an understanding of the framework of an OSHA inspection, what to expect, and how to comply with OSHA requirements.

2. **Scope**
   a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel facilities, project sites, and offices.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Directors of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.

4. **General**
   Under the Occupational Safety and Health Act of 1970, OSHA is authorized to conduct workplace inspections to determine that employers are complying with the standards issued by OSHA for safe and healthful workplaces.
   Inspections are usually conducted without advance notice. In fact, alerting an employer, without proper authorization to do so in advance of an OSHA inspection, can bring a fine of up to $1,000.00 and/or a 6 month jail term. This is true for federal OSHA compliance officers as well as state compliance officers.
   If an employer refuses to admit an OSHA compliance officer, or if an employer attempts to interfere with the inspection, the Act permits appropriate legal action.
   There are four priorities used in inspections:
   a. Imminent Danger - this is given top priority. An imminent danger situation is any condition that exists where there is reasonable certainty that a danger exists that can be expected to cause death or serious physical harm immediately or before the danger can be eliminated through normal enforcement procedures.
   b. Catastrophes and Fatal Accidents - second priority is given to fatalities and accidents resulting in hospitalization of employees.
   c. Employee Complaint - third priority is given to formal employee complaints of alleged violations of standards or of unsafe or unhealthful working conditions.
   d. Programmed Inspections - next in priority are the programmed inspections aimed at specific high hazard industries, occupational or health substances, on the basis of injury incidence rates, previous citation history, employee

exposure to toxic substances or random selection.

5. **Follow Up Inspections**
   A follow up inspection determines if previously cited violations have been corrected. If an employer has not abated (corrected) a violation, that employer is subject to "Failure to Abate" the violations and proposed additional daily penalties until the violation is abated.

6. **Before the Inspection Begins**
   When an OSHA compliance officer arrives, they will display official credentials and ask to see an employer representative. Employer representatives must be notified immediately and will accompany the compliance officer during the workplace inspection.
   a. The Facility Safety Director is the representative for the fabrication facility, if they are not on the premises, the Plant Manager, will be the representative and must call the EVP of Safety immediately upon being notified that an OSHA compliance officer in on site.
   b. At a jobsite, the Field Safety Director is the representative. If they are not on the premises, the Field Safety Manager, On Site Project Manager, or the Foreman will be the company's designated representative and must call the VP of Field Safety immediately upon being notified that an OSHA compliance officer is on site.
   c. In either case, the designated representative will accompany the compliance officer during the entire inspection process.

7. **Opening Conference**
   On a construction project, OSHA will usually deal directly with the general contractor. If it is determined that the inspection will be comprehensive, each trade may have a company representative present.
   During the opening conference, the compliance officer explains how the worksite was selected, purpose of the visit, the scope of the inspection, and standards which apply. The Employer Representative will attend the opening conference and accompany the compliance officer during the inspection.

8. **The Inspection**
   a. After the opening conference, the compliance officer and any accompanying representatives will walk through the workplace to inspect for safety and/or health hazards. The compliance officer will observe employees at work, consult with employees on a one-to-one basis if necessary, take photos, examine records, etc. An inspection may cover all or part of a workplace.
   b. During the inspection the compliance officer will point out any unsafe or unhealthy working conditions and discuss possible corrective action.
   c. Remember that some apparent violations can be corrected immediately. When they are corrected on the spot, the compliance officer records such corrections to help in judging the employer's good faith in compliance.

This, however, will not necessarily stop OSHA from citing a violation and assessing a penalty.

d. Keep in mind the following guidelines during an inspection process:
    i. Keep a POSITIVE safety attitude throughout the inspection process.
    ii. Show your willingness to help and correct immediately any unsafe conditions that can be taken care of while the compliance officer is still on site.
    iii. Take photos of everything the compliance officer takes photos of, if the compliance officer makes notes, write down what they write down, even if you have to ask what it was.
    iv. Answer all questions, but NEVER volunteer information.
    v. NEVER admit guilt. We need all the facts from all parties before any decision can be made.
    vi. NEVER perform demonstrations of your work for OSHA.

9. Closing Conference

a. At the end of each inspection, the compliance officer will hold a closing conference. This is an informal meeting for discussing problems and needs, allowing time for questions and answers.
b. The compliance officer will discuss all unsafe or unhealthy conditions observed and all apparent violations for which a citation and a proposed penalty may be issued. The compliance officer will inform all present of appeal rights.
c. During the closing conference the Employer Representative may produce records to show compliance efforts. This includes records of training, Tool Box Talks, daily equipment inspections., etc.
d. The Employer Representative should make a report of the inspection along with any other notes or photos and forward it immediately to the VP of Safety.

10. Violations and Penalties

OSHA violations and penalties are classified as per the following:

e. <u>Other-Than-Serious</u> - A violation that has direct relationship to job and safety and health, but probably would not cause death or serious physical harm. A penalty of up to $16,550 may be assessed.
f. <u>Serious</u> - A violation where there is substantial probability that death or serious physical harm could result. The penalty for a serious violation could be up to $16,550.
g. <u>Willful</u> - This is a violation that the employer knowingly and intentionally commits. The employer is aware that a hazardous condition exists, knows that the condition violates a standard and makes no reasonable effort to eliminate the hazard. Penalties up to $165,514 may be proposed.
    vii. An employer who is convicted in a criminal proceeding of a willful violation of a standard that has resulted in the death of an employee, may be fined up to $ 250,000 (or $ 500,000 if the employer is a corporation) or imprisoned up to 6 months, or both. A second

conviction doubles the possible term of imprisonment.

h. Repeated Violation - A violation of any standard, rule, or order where, upon re-inspection, a substantially similar violation is found. Repeated violations can bring a penalty of up to $165,514 for each such violation.
i. Failure to Abate - Failure to correct a prior violation may bring a civil penalty of up to $165,514 for each day that the violation continues beyond the prescribed abatement date.
j. OSHA also issues citations and penalties for falsifying records, reports, or applications and can, upon conviction, bring a criminal fine of $16,550 or up to 6 months in jail, or both. Violations of posting requirements bring a civil penalty of $16,550, and assaulting a compliance officer or resisting, opposing, intimidating, or interfering with a compliance officer in the performance of their duties, is a criminal offense and is subject to a fine of not more than $5,000 and imprisonment for not more than 3 years.

HAZARD COMMUNICATION PROGRAM

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSF-32
SUPERSEDES: Rev.9 VERSION: 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   Cooper Steel is required to evaluate the hazards of the products and chemicals we use, purchase or are exposed to, and to provide information about the hazardous properties to our employees by means of a hazard communication program, labels, Safety Data Sheets (SDS), and other forms of warnings.

   Safety Data Sheets are used to determine whether supplied chemicals are hazardous. Chemicals which present health hazards or physical hazards will be designated as such by information provided in the appropriate section of the SDS.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Field Employees and project sites.

3. **Responsibilities**
   Listed below are the persons responsible for managing the ongoing activities undertaken in order to comply with the hazard communication standard:
   a. Executive Vice President, Safety
      i. Responsible for preparation of the program
      ii. Reviewing the effectiveness of the Hazard Communication Program and ensuring that the program satisfies the requirements of all applicable federal, state, or local hazard communication requirements.
   b. Vice President of Field Safety
      i. Responsible for distribution of the program
      ii. Hazardous chemical evaluation
      iii. Monitoring the air concentrations of hazardous chemicals in the work environment.
   c. Field Safety Director
      i. Ensure this policy is available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
      ii. Maintain chemical inventory list
      iii. Obtaining and maintaining SDS
      iv. Identifying hazardous chemicals used in non-routine tasks and assessing their risks.
   d. Field Safety Manager / General Foreman
      i. Reviewing the potential hazards and safe use of chemicals.
      ii. Proper labeling of received containers
      iii. Proper labeling of containers on site
      iv. Directing the cleanup and disposal operations in the case of a spill or release.
   e. Safety Training Administrator / Field Safety Director
      i. Providing new hire and annual training for employees, including where

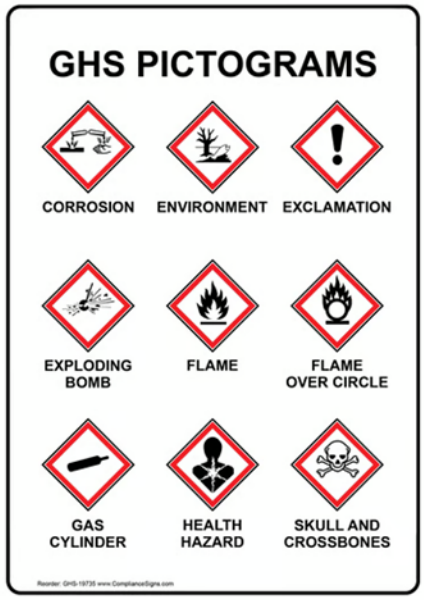
to find SDS's.
    ii. Maintaining training records

4. **Definitions**
A hazardous chemical is any chemical which presents a health or physical hazard. Listed below is an explanation of the differences between the two:
    a. Health Hazard - a chemical for which there is statistically significant evidence, based on at least one study, conducted in accordance with established scientific principles, that acute or chronic health effects may occur in exposed employees. (Acute effects usually occur rapidly as a result of short-term exposures, and are of short duration, Chronic effects generally occur as a result of long-term exposure and are of long duration.)
    b. Physical Hazard - a chemical for which there is scientifically valid evidence that it is a combustible liquid, a compressed gas, explosive, flammable, an organic peroxide, an oxidizer, pyrophoric (will ignite spontaneously at a temperature of 130 degrees or below), unstable, or water-reactive.

5. **Chemical Inventory List**
The Chemical Inventory List will contain the product identifier that is referenced on the appropriate SDS, the location or work area where the chemical is used, and the personal protective equipment and precautions for each chemical product. This list will be updated annually and whenever a new chemical is introduced into the workplace.

6. **Labels and Other Forms of Warning**
    a. All chemicals received will have the proper labels and SDS with them or these chemicals will not be accepted by receiving. These labels should have an identity of the chemical and any appropriate hazard warnings. These labels must be legible and prominently displayed. Cooper Steel uses the GHS and NFPA (National Fire Protection Association) labeling system in English, along with the related SDS. Each container of hazardous chemicals received from the chemical manufacturer, importer or distributor must be labeled with the following information:
        i. Product identifier
        ii. Signal word
        iii. Hazard statement(s)
        iv. Pictograms
        v. Precautionary statement(s)
        vi. Name, address and telephone number of the chemical manufacturer, importer or other responsible party
    b. If, for some reason, the labels have either fallen off the containers, have been damaged, or the chemical was transferred from one container to another, the labels shall be replaced immediately with the chemical name matching the name on the related SDS. Containers must always be labeled. The label must contain the following information:
        i. Product identifier

    ii. Signal word
    iii. Hazard statement(s)
    iv. Pictograms
    v. Precautionary statement(s)
c. Pictograms shall comply with GHS standards:



d. Food and beverage containers will never be used for chemical storage. In addition, used chemicals or other raw material containers may never be used for food or beverage service.

7. **Safety Data Sheets (SDS)**
    a. Chemical manufacturers and importers are required to obtain or develop a SDS for each hazardous chemical they produce or import. Distributors are responsible for ensuring their customers are provided a copy of these SDS's. Cooper Steel keeps on file a copy of SDS's for all the chemicals we import.
    b. SDS provides detailed information on each hazardous material, including its potential hazardous effects, its physical and chemical characteristics, and recommendations for appropriate protective measures.
    c. When a new product or chemical is ordered, a notice requesting the related SDS is stated on the purchase order. If a SDS is not received with the first shipment of a chemical, receiving will notify purchasing immediately, giving them the manufacturer's name and address from the label. Purchasing will then write a letter to the supplier requesting the SDS be sent to their attention. If, after a reasonable amount of time (one week from date of request), a SDS has not been received, purchasing will follow up with a second request letter. If no SDS has been received after 10 days, a complaint will be filed with the appropriate OSHA office, along with copies of the two request letters. A copy of the complaint filed by Cooper Steel will then be sent to the supplier.
    d. SDS's will be accessible to employees through Cooper Steel Vector SDS on

any computer, smart phone, or tablet. An SDS book will also be kept in a designated location for access in the event online access is unavailable.

e. A chemical inventory list is to be maintained by the Safety Director and the Purchasing Manager, cross matched with SDS, and updated periodically.

8. **Employee Information and Training**

    a. Each employee who may be exposed to hazardous chemicals when working must be provided information and trained prior to initial assignment to work with a hazardous chemical and whenever the hazard changes. Employees will be informed of the hazards involved, given personal protective equipment as required, and trained in the specific tasks and hazards.
    b. Hazard Communication training will take place for new hires during the orientation for new employees, whenever a new chemical is introduced, and as re-training as required by OSHA revisions, or to verify the employee's understanding of the Hazard Communication Standard.
    c. Foremen and Field Safety Directors will ensure that all applicable employees are trained in the requirements of this policy. Training shall be documented, and training records shall be maintained on file through the Learning Management System (LMS).
    d. Hazardous Communication training will emphasize the following items:
        i. Summary of the standard and Cooper Steel's written program
        ii. Chemical and physical properties of hazardous materials, such as flash points, and methods that can be used to detect the presence or release of materials.
        iii. Physical hazards of chemicals such as the potential for fire or explosion
        iv. Health Hazards, including signs and symptoms of exposure to chemicals and any medical conditions known to be aggravated by exposure to the chemical.
        v. Procedures to protect against hazards, such as personal protective equipment required, proper use and maintenance.
        vi. Work procedures to follow to assure protection when cleaning hazardous chemical spill and leaks.
        vii. How to read and interpret the information on labels and SDS's, and how employees may obtain additional hazard information.
    e. All employees, or their designated representatives, can obtain further information on this written program, the Hazard Communication Standard, or applicable SDS and chemical information lists by contacting the Safety Department.

EMERGENCY ACTION PLAN - FIELD

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSF-33
SUPERSEDES: Rev.9 **VERSION:** 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   The purpose of this program is to provide education, training, and procedures for preparing and responding to emergencies. This program is intended to heighten emergency response awareness at Cooper Steel job sites. It is the responsibility of Cooper Steel to use this program in combination with federal, state, and local regulations as a facility-specific Emergency Action and Response Program.

2. **Scope**
   The following shall serve as guidance to Cooper Steel on the topic of Emergency Action, Response and Planning. Emergencies can be identified as Medical, Fire, Severe Weather, Extended Power Loss, etc. If an emergency develops, STAY CALM.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, and Field Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary health and safety information.

4. **Job Site Alerts**
   a. General evacuation and weather warning alerts will be designated in the site specific safety plan and may vary from job to job depending on specific job site procedures. A system must be in place to alert employees.

5. **Fire Fighting**
   a. Only fires in the beginning stages shall be attempted to be put out.
   b. Fire extinguishers shall be manned only by designated employees who are trained in the use of fire extinguishers.

6. **Fire Response Plan – Field**
   a. When a fire or explosion occurs on any part of the job site, personnel in that area are to immediately evacuate and notify their supervisor
   b. The General Foreman or above will make the repeated announcement sounding the air horn while surveying the area to “Evacuate Now” and will

call emergency services (911) or will request someone else to place the call.

c. Employees should calmly and quickly (walk do not run) evacuate the area by means of the nearest available route or emergency exit and proceed to the assembly area. Employees are to wait in assembly area until given all clear to return by their Supervisor.
d. Supervisors will assume stations outside of the building pad or at emergency exits to assist in an orderly evacuation. Supervisors will also perform a personnel count.
e. Any employee not accounted for will be located by personnel designated by the supervisor. At no time shall an employee re-enter the building pad if immediate danger exists

7. Fire Assembly Locations

a. Fire assembly locations will be established by the project management/safety team and briefed to all personnel on site project specific orientation.

8. Tornado Response

a. When there is a chance severe weather is approaching the General Foreman or above will keep a close eye on the weather.
b. All personnel will be notified by radio to take shelter.

9. Tornado Assembly Locations

a. Tornado assembly locations will be established by the project management/safety team and briefed to all personnel on site project specific orientation.

10. Lightning Response

a. When there is a chance severe weather is approaching the General Foreman or above will keep a close eye on the weather.
b. When lightning strikes within 10 miles no aerial work is to be performed.
c. When Lightning strikes within 6 miles no outside work is to be performed and yard crew is to come inside.
d. Outside work can resume 30 minutes after last lightning strike.

11. Rescue and Medical Emergency Response

a. In the event of a medical emergency follow the below:
    i. Notify your supervisor if it is a major medical emergency (heart attack, stroke, amputation, etc.).
    ii. First responders must evaluate the scene for possible danger and ensure the scene is secure prior to entering.

iii. Designated and trained employees are to provide initial First Aid/CPR/AED to injured worker until medical help arrives at the site.
iv. Designated employees will be trained in the American Heart Association First Aid/CPR/AED certification program. In each crew, ten percent of employees or more will be certified.
v. The supervisor will make the call to 911 if needed and provide the appropriate information to emergency personnel.
vi. The General Foreman will designate someone to assume a station at the job site entrance to direct emergency vehicles to the site. They are also responsible for keeping the area clear.
vii. If you are contacted by the media, make no statements, and refer their representative to the Cooper Steel Legal Department in the Shelbyville office.
viii. Under no circumstances is any employee to release information to the media.

12. First Aid Kits & AED

a. First aid kits will be readily available on all crew trucks and jobsite trailers.
   i. All first aid kits will be supplied for injuries that may be encountered in their area.
b. Automatic External Defibrillators (AED) will be supplied with each crew truck.
   i. Batteries will be replaced according to the manufacturer's guidelines or when a low battery warning is given, whichever occurs first.

13. Emergency Eyewash Stations

a. Emergency eye wash supplies are available in the supplied first aid kits.

14. Drills

Cooper Steel will conduct periodic Emergency Evacuation Drills to evaluate our readiness to respond to an emergency. These drills are for your safety and the safety of your fellow workers. Your feedback after any evacuation drill should be given to your supervisor or a safety representative.

15. Training

General Foremen or above will ensure that all applicable employees are trained in the requirements of this policy. Training shall be documented, and training records shall be maintained on file by Cooper Steel.

IN AN EMERGENCY

1. CALL 911 IF LIFE THREATENING
(Heart Attack, Stroke, Major Medical)

2. Send an employee to each entrance to direct emergency personnel.

FIRST AID

Non-Emergency Injuries
First Aid/CPR

In the event of an injury (no matter how minor) follow the steps below:

Immediately notify your supervisor, someone in Safety of the incident with details. If no one in Safety can be reached contact someone in Human Resources.

1. Manage the incident with First Aid if possible
2. Do not send anyone for off site medical care. This will be determined by someone in Safety.
   a. The only exception to sending someone to off site care is if it is life threatening (see above) or no one in Safety or Human Resources can be reached.
3. If you are injured at work, do not go to your personal doctor or walk in clinic without permission from Human Resources.
4. If it is determined by Safety, Human Resources and the injured Employee that off site care is required an employee will be presented with a panel of medical facilities to choose from.

Safety Contacts:

Heath McElroy – (865)338-2327

Jason Farris – (931)703-1149

Human Resources Contacts:

Shelby Taylor – (931)224-8815

Ashley Rowland – (931)703-7079

Blair Mann – (931)993-0580

EMERGENCY RESPONSE

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSF-34
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   This Cooper Steel policy outlines accident and workplace related illness reporting requirements. The policy is designed to ensure compliance with all applicable laws, regulations, standards, and best management practices.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Field Employees and project sites.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Safety will ensure the Director of Field Safety, Foremen, and Field Safety Managers make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Management and supervision will ensure each new employee participates in this program and review all necessary site and project specific health and safety information.

4. **Investigation and Reporting Requirements**
   In the Event of an Incident:
   a. The Supervisor must IMMEDIATELY notify the V.P. of Safety, Safety Director or Director of Human Resources. If the individuals above cannot be reached, one of the following may be contacted:

Shelbyville Office	**(931) 684-7962**
Heath McElroy	**(865) 338-2327**
Cory Cooper	**(931) 205-2679**

   b. The Supervisor will complete an Incident Investigation Report and submit it to the Safety Department as soon as possible. Witnesses are required to complete a Witness Statement, documenting in their own word what they actually observed. Witness Statements must be signed by the witness.
   c. The original copy of this witness statement must be sent to the V.P. of Safety in the Shelbyville office.
   d. The Supervisor may be responsible for obtaining follow up information.
   e. If the incident attracts media attention, all questions must be deferred to Gary Cooper. Employees are not permitted to release information to the media without the consent of Executive Management.

5. **Additional Reporting Requirements**
   a. OSHA Reporting Requirements

i. Within 8 Hours
    1. All work-related fatalities.
ii. Within 24 Hours
    1. Inpatient hospitalizations as a formal admission to the in-patient service of a hospital or clinic for care or treatment. It does not include hospitalizations for diagnostic tests or observation.
    2. Amputations - An amputation is defined as the traumatic loss of a limb or other external body part. This includes:
        a. A part, such as a limb or appendage, that has been severed, cut off, amputated (either completely or partially)
        b. Fingertip amputations with or without bone loss
        c. Medical amputations resulting from irreparable damage.
        d. Amputations of body parts that have since been reattached.
    3. Loss of an Eye

b. If the incident is NOT immediately reportable but results in the death of an employee within 30 days of the incident, the employer must report the incident to OSHA.
c. The report must contain all the following information:
    i. Establishment Name
    ii. Location of the work-related incident
    iii. Time of the work-related incident
    iv. Type of reportable event (fatality, inpatient hospitalization, amputation, loss of an eye)
    v. Number of employees who suffered the event
    vi. Name(s) of employees who suffered the event
    vii. Contact person and his or her phone number
    viii. Brief description of the work-related incident
d. The V.P. of Safety is responsible for contacting OSHA officials.
    i. In Tennessee, during working hours call (800) 249-8510 to make a report.
    ii. To contact federal OSHA, please call (800) 321-OSHA (6742)

6. Motor Vehicle Accidents

Only pre-qualified and authorized drivers may operate Cooper Steel vehicles. In the event of a collision:

a. Stop immediately and take all necessary precautions to prevent further accidents at the scene.
b. Do not leave the accident scene.
c. Contact police and wait for them to arrive at the scene, complete any investigation and gather information necessary to prepare their accident report.
d. Do not admit liability. Do not make a statement of any kind to anyone other than Cooper Steel personnel, Cooper Steel's claims administrator, your personal insurance claims administrator, or the police.

e. Get the names and contact information for all witnesses.
f. Exchange information with involved parties to include name, address, phone number, vehicle license number and year and make of vehicles.
g. Report the accident immediately to your supervisor.
h. Obtain a copy of the police report and send to your supervisor.

7. **Training**
   The Field Safety Director shall ensure that all employees will be trained in this policy and requirements.

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSF-36
SUPERSEDES: VERSION: 1.0

1. **Purpose**
    a. It is the policy of Cooper Steel to ensure compliance with all applicable laws, regulations, standards and best management practices with regards to the establishment of a Personal Protective Program.

2. **Scope**
    a. This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Field Employees and project sites.

3. **Responsibilities**
    a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
    b. The Vice President of Field Safety and Directors of Field Safety shall be responsible for the distribution of this policy.
    c. Foremen and Field Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
    d. The Field Safety Director will ensure that the appropriate PPE hazard assessments are conducted and certified.
    e. The Field Safety Director will ensure that appropriate PPE is selected and assigned.
    f. Employees shall conform to the requirements of this policy.
    g. Department managers should advise the responsible person of changes in the requirements for PPE (for example, new procedures, processes requiring PPE, omission of a job or task). Additionally, managers should consult with the responsible person before purchasing any new PPE.
    h. All Cooper Steel employees will obey the personal protective equipment policy. Any deviation from this policy to allow for job site visitor tours must be approved by the Field Safety Director.

4. **Policy / Procedures**

    a. When engineering and administrative controls cannot mitigate a hazard, personal protective equipment (PPE), shall be provided, used, and maintained in a sanitary and reliable condition wherever it is necessary by reason of hazards, of process or environment, chemical hazards, radiological hazards, or mechanical irritants encountered in a manner capable of causing injury or impairment in the function of any part of the body through absorption, inhalation, or physical contact. PPE includes personal protective equipment for eyes, face, head, and extremities, protective clothing, respiratory devices, and protective shields and barriers.

b. Cooper Steel will provide all required PPE with the exception of prescription safety glasses, and footwear. Where employees provide their own personal protective equipment, the employer shall be responsible for assuring its adequacy, including proper maintenance and sanitation of such equipment. Therefore, any personal equipment brought on site to be used for Cooper Steel work is subject to Cooper Steel inspection and may be replaced if necessary. Some PPE, which cannot be repaired (such as a safety harness) may be destroyed to prevent further use. If this is the case, new equipment will be issued to the worker, but it is not a replacement of your personal equipment.

c. All personal protective equipment shall be of safe design and construction for the work to be performed. PPE is to be inspected daily and before each use. Any PPE that is no longer suitable for use must be exchanged for a new serviceable unit.

d. Hazard Assessments
    i. Each task and/or job will be assessed to determine foot, head, eye, face, and hand hazards present and the proper PPE that should be worn. A Job Hazard Analysis will be completed for each job and/or task and will serve as certification that a hazard assessment has been performed.
    ii. The person conducting the hazard assessment will also survey jobs that are non-routine or periodic. In some cases these assessments may not be completed until the jobs are scheduled.
    iii. The Job Hazard Analysis will be update/evaluated whenever conditions or procedures change.
    iv. The assessments will include observation of the following sources of hazards:
        1. Impact: Flying chips, objects, dirt, particles, collision, motion hazards.
        2. Penetration: Falling/dropping objects, sharp objects that cut or pierce.
        3. Compression: Rollover or pinching.
        4. Chemical: Splashing, burns, fumes.
        5. Temperature Extremes: Sparks, splashes from molten materials, burns from high/low temperatures
        6. Harmful Dust: Dirt, particles, asbestos, lead
        7. Light Radiation: Welding, cutting, brazing, lasers, furnaces, lights
    v. Selection of PPE
        1. The Safety Director will make certain that the personal protective equipment in use is appropriate for the identified tasks, provides a level of protection that meets or exceeds the minimum required to protect employees from the

hazards, and meets all ANSI requirements as specified in OSHA's PPE standard.

vi. Training and Fit Testing
   1. The Safety Director will make certain that all affected employees receive training on:
      a. What PPE is necessary and why
      b. How to wear PPE properly
      c. PPE limitations and capabilities, and
      d. PPE care and maintenance.
   2. Each employee will demonstrate that he or she understands the training.
   3. Training will be repeated under the following conditions:
      a. Changes in the workplace that make previous training obsolete
      b. New assignment for employee or change in job assignment/equipment.
      c. Incorrect use of/or failure to use equipment
      d. Introduction of new PPE

e. PPE Inspection, Cleaning and Maintenance
   i. Employees will conduct inspections, cleaning, and maintenance of PPE at intervals according to the manufacturer's instructions. They will not use damaged or defective equipment.

   ii. Individuals with questions about the PPE Program and Policy should address them to the Facility Safety Manager.

f. Eye and Face Protection
   i. Corrective lenses/industrial eye protection/safety glasses (ANSI Z87.1-2020) (Z87 should be stamped on the frames) or equivalent with side shields are required at all times in the fabrication facility, and at the job site. As in all cases with personal protective equipment, damaged or defective equipment shall not be used.
      1. Googles or over the glass safety glasses may be worn over spectacles without disturbing the adjustment of the spectacles.
   ii. The equipment should provide adequate protection against the particular hazards for which they are designed.
   iii. The equipment should fit snugly and not unduly interfere with the movements of the wearer.
   iv. The equipment should be kept clean, disinfected, and in good repair.
   v. Dark shaded safety glasses are prohibited indoors and in low light areas. Safety glasses suitable for indoor and low light use must be worn in these areas.

vi. When working with or around equipment that may produce flying sparks or debris a face shield is required in addition to safety glasses. The face shield must meet ANSI Z87.1-2020 standards.
vii. Eye and Face protection is required when welding and cutting. Welding lenses must meet ANSI Z87.1-2020 standards. Safety glasses are required to be worn in addition to the welding hood.

g. Foot Protection
    i. When there is danger of foot injuries due to falling and rolling objects, or objects piercing the sole, uneven/rugged terrain, and where employee's feet are exposed to electrical hazards, each employee shall wear safety toed protective footwear. The footwear must cover and provide adequate support to the ankle. The footwear must provide adequate protection for the tasks performed. Foot protection must be kept in good condition.
    ii. Safety toed shoes or boots are required at all times.

h. Head Protection
    i. Helmets for head protection shall be worn by workers when there is a hazard from impact and penetration from falling and flying objects and limited shock and burns. These helmets shall meet the specifications established in ANSI Safety Requirements for Industrial Head Protection, Z89.1-2014 and the European standards for side impact EN12492.
    ii. Helmets are required by all employees in the following areas or when performing the following activities:
        1. Within 10' of receiving and loading areas
        2. While performing tasks at heights at or above 4'
        3. At all times while operating or aboard a Mobile Elevated Work Platform (aerial lift)
        4. As determined by area supervisor

    iii. Chin straps must be fastened during any elevated work.
    iv. Helmets must not display profanity, lude, or vulgar images or phrases.
    v. Helmets must meet contract requirements.

i. Hand Protection
    i. Per OSHA, employers shall select and require employees to use appropriate hand protection at all times in operational areas on the jobsite.
    ii. Appropriate gloves for the task are required to be worn by all employees when outside of jobsite trailers on any Cooper Steel projects. This mandatory glove wearing policy applies equally to Cooper Steel, visitors, trade Partners, and any others associated with the jobsite. Keep in mind, gloves should protect employees

against the risk of injury. Consider cut, puncture, abrasion and tear as part of the assessment and selection of “appropriate” glove.

iii. Cooper Steel employees and Subcontractor employees are required to wear gloves rated ANSI cut level 4 at a minimum, but other levels can be dictated by the task and its degree of risk.

iv. Gloves with Impact protection are required for steel work and other activities where hands are at risk of being “struck by” or caught between”

v. The only exceptions will be:
   1. Specialty gloves used for certain applications and exposures such as protection against chemicals
   2. If an employee needs to temporarily remove his/her glove(s) in the work area and this does not present any type of risk or exposure. i.e., work on iPad or phone. After completion of task, gloves must be put back on to ensure compliance.
   3. When operating equipment such as cranes, telehandlers or other similar equipment where exposure to abrasions or cuts/lacerations are low. However, prior to exiting the seat, appropriate gloves will be expected to be worn.
   4. Gloves should be inspected before each use to ensure they are not torn, punctured or made ineffective in any way.
   5. Subcontractors will be expected to supply their employees and any sub-tiered subcontractor with appropriate gloves

j. Hearing Protection

i. When it is not feasible to reduce noise levels or duration of exposure under “permissible noise exposures” hearing protection devices shall be used. Plain cotton and ear buds are not an acceptable protective device. The protective device used should be suited to the levels of noise that are being generated in the workplace. Hearing protection devices inserted in the ear shall be fitted or determined individually by competent persons.

k. Hi-Visibility Outerwear

i. Anytime employees are in close proximity to moving equipment (directing trucks, cranes, forklifts, etc.), public roadways, and low light areas, an ANSI Class 2 reflective vest (or equivalent) must be worn. When hi-visibility clothing is required, it will be worn as the outermost layer of clothing at all times.
   1. ANSI Class 2 vests will remain zipped at all times.
   2. If the vest is non-FR rated, it must be removed prior to performing hot work (FR rated vest must have legible tags present showing its FR rating).

5. Respiratory Protection

a. Definitions
    i. **CONTAMINANT** - Any material that by reason of its action upon, within, or to a person is likely to cause physical harm.
    ii. **HEPA** - High-efficiency particulate absolute filter (cartridge) used for a specific hazardous material.
    iii. **TWA** - Time-weighted average, a measurement of a certain exposure over an eight-hour work shift.
    iv. **QUALITATIVE FIT-TEST** - A pass/fail test that relies on the subject’s sensory response to detect the challenge agents, including isoamyl, irritant smoke, and bitrex. The test also includes the positive and negative pressure fit test.
    v. **QUANTITATIVE FIT-TEST** - A fit test that uses an instrument to measure the challenge agent inside and outside of the respirator.
    vi. **NEGATIVE PRESSURE AIR-PURIFYING RESPIRATOR** - A non-air supplied respirator that purifies the breathing atmosphere as it passes through the air-purifying elements.
    vii. **DUST** - created when solid material breaks down and gives off fine particles that float on the air before settling due to gravity. Dusts are produced by operations such as grinding, crushing, drilling, blasting, sanding, and milling.
    viii. **MISTS** - Particles formed from liquid materials through atomization and condensation processes. For example, mists can be created by spraying operations, plating operations, and mixing and cleaning operations.
    ix. **FUMES** - Created when solid materials vaporize under high heat. The metal vapor cools and condenses into an extremely small particle, with a particle size generally less than one micrometer in diameter. Fumes can come from operations such as welding, smelting, and pouring of molten metal.
    x. **GASES** - Substances that are similar to air in their ability to diffuse or spread freely throughout a container or area. Examples include oxygen, carbon monoxide, carbon dioxide, nitrogen, and helium.
    xi. **VAPORS** - Gaseous state of substances that are either liquids or solids at room temperature, formed when solids or liquids evaporate. Gasoline is an example of a liquid that evaporates easily, producing gasoline vapors. Other examples include paint thinners and degreaser solvents.

b. Introduction
    The construction industry subjects its employees to many different hazardous environments (atmosphere). Some of these are dust, smoke, fog, mist, fumes, gases, vapors, and sprays. When exposed to these hazards, a respirator is one of the most important types of protection needed. The respirator will stop hazardous substances from entering the human respiratory system by filtering the contaminated air.

c. Purpose

This respiratory protection program was developed by Cooper Steel to prevent exposure, educate its employees, and provide a safe and healthy work environment. The program was established and implemented by Cooper Steel to assure safe working procedures and compliance with the 1910.134 standards for general industry.

d. Responsibility:
   It is Cooper Steels responsibility to establish and implement an effective respiratory protection program. Through training, this program will stress the following issues: proper usage, storage, maintenance, fit testing, inspections, types of cartridges, exposure, and respirators. Cooper Steel will also be responsible for issuing the correct respirator and cartridge for each specific type of exposure.
   All employees will be responsible for wearing the proper respirator and cartridge issued to them. After the respirator is issued and training is completed, all employees will be responsible for the proper maintenance and reporting of any damage found. The respirator issued to an employee is for that employee's use only. **USE ONLY THE RESPIRATOR ISSUED TO YOU.**
e. Exposure
   There are three primary types of hazardous materials that Cooper Steels employees may be potentially exposed to: silica dust (coring and cutting), hexavalent chromium and cadmium (welding). Any hazardous exposure will be addressed in the site-specific plan for the project.
f. Ventilation
   On occasion, Cooper Steel will work in a facility not owned by Cooper Steel and may be exposed to different types of hazardous materials that its employees are not normally exposed to. When the situation arises, the first step in protection is air monitoring and ventilation. Cooper Steel will use fans and air vacuums to reduce the amount of exposure. In addition, Cooper Steel will provide the proper respirator needed for the project. The different procedures for each job will be explained in Cooper Steel Site-Specific Safety Plan.
g. Air-Purifying Respirator
   Air-purifying respirators (A.P.R.) are used when the atmosphere has enough oxygen present (19.5%-21%). If the air is contaminated with a hazardous gas, vapor, dust, etc., the respirator will screen out dangerous material or divert air through a chemical filter that removes the offending hazardous materials.
   The A.P.R. has a replaceable screw on/off filter cartridge. The average time period of protection for cartridges is about eight hours. However, that time period may not be correct if there is a large degree of exposure, which will clog the filter much faster. If at any time the employee smells or tastes the hazardous material, or if breathing becomes difficult due to clogging, the filter cartridge must be changed.
   WARNING: NO ONE CARTRIDGE WILL FILTER ALL HAZARDOUS MATERIALS. EACH HAZARDOUS MATERIAL REQUIRES ITS OWN

SPECIFIC FILTER CARTRIDGE. SERIOUS ILLNESS OR EVEN DEATH COULD RESULT FROM USING AN IMPROPER RESPIRATOR OR CARTRIDGE.

h. How To Use a Respirator

The most important aspect in the use of a respirator is the fit on the worker's face. Even a slight gap between the respirator and the user's skin could allow the contaminated air to leak in. The result of this could cause serious illness or even death. The respirator must fit securely, but not too tight. The user's nose should never be pinched, nor should the respirator slip around on his/her face. The user should be able to move around and talk without losing a secure fit. The user must be clean-shaven, or a proper fit will not be possible.

i. Steps For Proper Fit (Half-Mask)

  i. Hold respirator in the palm of your hand, exterior touching hand. The straps should be untwisted and hanging down below the palm of your hand.
  ii. Raise the respirator to your face, place bottom under your chin and nose section over your nose.
  iii. Pull head strap over top/back section of head.
  iv. Wrap neck straps around the back of your neck and fasten strap hook.
  v. Tighten or loosen straps if necessary.
  vi. Conduct positive and negative pressure test to assure correct seal/fit (Explained In "Fit Testing").

j. Steps For Proper Fit (Full-Face)

  i. Fully loosen all six head straps, then place the harness at the back of your head and pull the respirator down over your face.
  ii. Position mouth/nose piece comfortably on face.
  iii. Pull the ends of the straps to adjust the tightness, starting with the neck straps, followed by the temple straps, and finally the forehead straps. Do not tighten the head straps too tight, as this may deform the nose cup and narrow the inhalation air passage.
  iv. Conduct positive and negative pressure test to assure correct seal and fit (explained in fit testing)

k. Fit-Testing

Cooper Steel has chosen a qualitative fit test for all employees who are issued a respirator. The procedure for the fit test is as follows:

  i. After the respirator is fitted correctly on the trainee, a harmless Bittrex mist is sprayed into the fit test hood which is placed over the head of the trainee. If a taste or smell of the mist is detected at any time throughout the test, the fit is improper. In most cases the user can test the fit by using a positive negative pressure test.

l. Positive Pressure Test

Close the respirators exhalation valve and gently breathe out into the face piece. This should cause the face piece to bulge out slightly. If no air leaks out the user has proper fit.

m. Negative Pressure Test
   Close the respirators inhalation valve and breathe in gently. The face piece should collapse slightly against your face. Hold your breath for ten seconds. If the face piece stays collapsed and no air leaks in the user has a proper fit.
   Remember, a respirator will not do its job unless a proper fit is made. Some people's faces do not fit well into a respirator. In general, people who fall into the following categories either cannot were a respirator or need modifications to wear one successfully.
    i. People who wear contact lenses
    ii. People who wear glasses with temple pieces
    iii. People who have facial hair that interferes with seal
    iv. People with breathing problems
    v. People with heart conditions
    vi. People who are claustrophobic
    vii. People who are heat sensitive
    viii. People who wear a beard and refuse to be clean-shaven
n. Maintenance
   Respirators must be cleaned properly after each use. Users will be supplied with sterilizing cleaning wipes which can be used for quick cleaning. The most efficient way to clean a respirator is to soak it in warm water with a gentle soap. Wipe it clean and allow it to air dry. Always inspect your respirator during cleaning.
o. Inspection
   Before using a respirator always check for damage. Look for holes tears cracks or other signs that it could let contaminated air in. Make sure all connections are fastened properly. Check the face piece seal, the head band, valves, fittings, and filter cartridge. Report any damage found to your supervisor immediately.
p. Training
   Each employee issued a respirator will receive training and a qualitative fit test. The trainer (certified in fit testing) will cover all aspects of this program in full detail. Employees will also be trained to recognize certain hazards relating to respirator use. They will also complete a questionnaire and receive a follow-up physical at a designated clinic.
q. Respirator Usage Checklist
    i. Wear only the respirator that was issued to you.
    ii. Inspect your respirator before and after every use.
    iii. Conduct a positive and negative pressure fit-test before every use.
    iv. Follow cooper steel company procedures for proper fitting, de-contamination, cartridge use, and storage.
    v. Only use a respirator after training and qualitative fittest.
r. Identification Of Respirator Cartridges
   Protection Against:
    i. Organic Vapors:
        1. Gasoline

        2. Paint Thinner
    ii. Acid Gases:
        1. Chlorine
        2. Hydrogen Chloride
        3. Sulfur Dioxide
    iii. Hepa
        1. Dust, fumes, or mist with a TWA (Time Weighted Average) of less than 0.05 MG^3; Asbestos containing dust and mist; and radionuclides.
    iv. Ammonia Gas
        1. Ammonia
        2. Methylamine
    v. Organic Vapor / Hepa
        1. Combination
    vi. Acid Gases / Organic Vapors
        1. Combination

s. Always read the information for and use the correct cartridge for each specific contaminant! Any problems or questions, please contact your safety representative.

6. Training

a. The VP of Safety and the Field Safety Director will ensure that all applicable employees are trained in the requirements of this policy. Training shall be documented, and training records shall be maintained on file at the main office.

37 FALL PROTECTION

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSF-37
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 **VERSION:** 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   The purpose of this Fall Protection Program is to establish and maintain a safe working environment by preventing fall-related injuries. This program will outline procedures for identifying and controlling fall hazards, ensuring compliance with OSHA and Cooper Steel rules and regulations, and providing training on fall protection equipment and procedures for all affected employees.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all Cooper Steel field construction activities involving exposure to heights greater than or equal to six (6) feet and/or where falling objects exist.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety is responsible for the development and distribution of this policy.
   b. The VP of Field Safety, Field Safety Directors, and Field Safety Managers are responsible for implementing and enforcing this policy.
   c. Foremen are responsible for ensuring employees under their supervision are using proper fall protection and adhering to company policy.
   d. Employees are responsible to know and follow this policy.

4. **Policy**
   a. This policy covers minimum performance standards applicable to all Cooper Steel workers and locations. Local practices requiring more detailed or stringent rules, or local, state or other federal requirements regarding this subject can and should be added as an addendum to this procedure as applicable.
   b. Fall protection equipment and personal fall arrest systems will be issued by Cooper Steel. The use of personally owned fall protection equipment must be inspected and approved by the safety director.

5. **General Rules For Fall Protection**
   The following guidelines are to serve as the basic Comprehensive Fall Protection Program and are to be followed on ALL projects. Cooper Steel requires 100% FALL PROTECTION AT ALL TIMES.
   a. Workers shall not ride on steel being hoisted, slide down columns or ladders, or ride on the cranes' headache ball.
   b. Anchorage points used for fall arrest shall be capable of supporting 5000 pounds per person attached.
   c. Fall protection must be secured in a way that a worker's free fall is no greater than four feet.
   d. Lifelines must be installed per an engineered system and secured to an anchorage or structural member capable of supporting a minimum dead

weight of 5000 pounds per person attached.

e. Self-Retracting Lifelines (SRL's) are designed to be used by one person at a time (unless otherwise directed). SRL must be connected to an anchorage point at one end, and your harness D ring at the other. An 18" extension strap is allowed for confirmation of connection to SRL.
f. D Ring extension strap is only to be used with a structure mounted retractable. Personal SRL's and Lanyards may only be connected from the d-ring of the harness to the anchor point. The extension strap may not be used to extend a personal SRL.
g. Any other rigging equipment used for fall protection must only be used for fall protection, and never have been used for rigging material.
h. Fall protection equipment, when not in use, must be stored in a clean dry place to be protected from environmental damage.
i. 6' Lanyards are prohibited.
j. Never sit or lean on a skylight, it may not be capable of supporting additional weight.
k. All fall protection equipment shall meet the latest ANSI & OSHA ratings for the work being performed.

6. Rescue

a. In the event of a fall the employee must be rescued promptly.
b. Any task that requires the employee to use a personal fall arrest system shall have a documented rescue plan in place prior to commencement of work.
c. Task Specific Fall Protection Plans (developed by the Field Safety Director) will contain rescue procedures for a particular project.
d. All falls will be thoroughly investigated by the Safety Department and a Root Cause Analysis (RCA) will be performed by a committee appointed by the Safety Director.

7. Inspection

All fall protection equipment must be inspected prior to each use by the user in accordance with the specific manufacturer's recommendations. Cooper Steel employees are to be trained during orientation, and/or when new equipment is issued on manufacturers' inspection criteria and inspection frequency.

8. Training

a. All Cooper Steel employees that are likely to be exposed to fall hazards are to be trained:
    i. During new hire orientation
    ii. Annually
    iii. Whenever company policy changes.
    iv. Whenever new fall protection equipment is introduced.
    v. Anytime the employee violates this policy.

b. Employee training will consist of:
    i. How to recognize potential fall hazards.

ii. Cooper Steel policy on floor and roof openings and edges.
iii. Procedures for eliminating and minimizing fall hazards.
iv. The correct fit, Inspection, maintenance and use of personal fall arrest system components, as determined by the manufacturer(s)
v. Correct procedure for erecting, maintaining, disassembling, and inspecting fall protection systems to be used.
vi. Use and operation of guardrail systems, personal fall arrest systems, warning line systems, controlled access zones.
vii. Limitations of fall protection equipment
viii. Correct procedure for care, and storage of fall protection equipment.
ix. Rescue procedures in the event an individual falls

c. Training will be documented and maintained by the Safety Training Administrator.

38 MATERIAL HANDLING AND STORAGE

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSF-38
SUPERSEDES: **VERSION:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   The purpose of this Written Material Handling and Storage Safety Program is to establish a comprehensive framework for safe material handling practices, encompassing both manual and mechanical methods, to minimize the risk of workplace injuries and promote a safe and healthy environment for all employees engaged in handling, storing, and moving materials at all Cooper Steel project sites.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all employees who handle materials using mechanical equipment, including but not limited to forklifts, pallet jacks, cranes, and hoists.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The VP of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety shall be responsible for the distribution of this policy.
   c. Foremen, and Field Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   d. Employees shall follow all safety procedures and guidelines outlined in this policy and report any unsafe conditions or equipment malfunctions to their supervisor immediately.

4. **Planning**
   a. Personnel involved in moving, handling, and transporting materials shall assess the load's weight, size, and shape, and determine what equipment is needed.
   b. Ensure the equipment selected has the capacity to lift and move the materials.
   c. Ensure clear and safe pathways/roadways for transporting materials.

5. **Storage**
   a. Material that has the potential to tip over will be placed on its longest side to prevent a tipping/crushing hazard.
      i. Exception: Material being staged for erection may be placed vertically to facilitate rigging if the following conditions are met:
         1. Material shall be placed on solid level ground.
         2. Material shall be placed on adequate dunnage to promote stability.

3. Personnel shall not be permitted between materials that are placed vertically unless there is a space 1 ½ times the height of material between members.
4. The weight of stored materials on floors within buildings and structures shall not exceed maximum safe load limits.

ii. Maximum safe load limits of floors within buildings and structures shall be conspicuously posted, in pounds per square foot, in all storage areas, except when the storage area is on a floor or slab on grade.
iii. Noncompatible materials shall be segregated in storage.
iv. Housekeeping. Storage areas shall be kept free from accumulation of materials that constitute hazards from tripping, fire, explosion, or pest harborage. Vegetation control will be exercised when necessary.

b. Material Dunnage
   i. Dunnage material must be capable of supporting all loads to be applied.
   ii. Stored material must remain a minimum of 3” from the edge of its supporting dunnage, or the dunnage must have a vertical containment tab installed.
   iii. Dunnage shall remain clear of designated walk paths.

c. Free and Clear Access
   i. Aisles and passageways shall be kept clear to provide for the free and safe movement of material handling equipment or employees. Such areas shall be kept in good repair.
   ii. Material shall not be stored in designated walk paths.
   iii. Emergency Exits shall not be blocked a minimum of 36” wide with clear access to established walk paths.
   iv. Emergency access routes around the exterior of buildings shall not be blocked.

6. Stacking

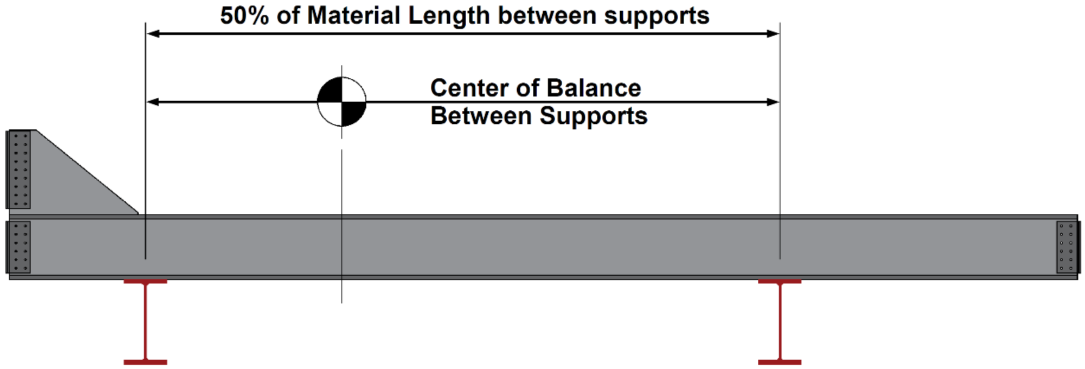
a. General Material Stacking
   i. All materials stored in tiers shall be stacked, racked, blocked, interlocked, or otherwise secured to prevent sliding, falling or collapse.
   ii. Structural steel, pipe, bar stock, and cylindrical materials, unless racked, shall be stacked and blocked so as to prevent spreading or tilting.
   iii. Materials will be stacked with like materials to promote proper nesting and prevent tilting/collapse hazards.

b. Height Limitations
   i. Material to be accessed by workers shall not be stacked more than 6’ high.
   ii. Material stacked more than 6’ high shall only be handled with a powered industrial truck.

iii. Material stacked near permanent or temporary building bracing will remain 1 ½ times the height of the stack away from nearest brace. (ex. A 6' high stack will remain 9' away from nearest brace)

7. **Transporting Materials**
    a. Materials transported by crane or powered industrial truck shall follow established policies and procedures including the following:
        i. All rigging must meet ASTM B.30 standards and Cooper Steel rigging policy.
        ii. Lower the load to the lowest position when traveling.
        iii. Never move material over personnel.

8. **Staging Material**
    a. When landing material you must ensure the following:
        i. The supports are capable of supporting the weight of the material.
        ii. The supports will hold the material level.
        iii. 50% of the material length is between the supports
        iv. The center of balance is placed between the supports



    b. When rotating material the following conditions must be met.
        i. Material rotated manually must not create an exertion of force of more than 75 pounds on the employee's body.
        ii. Material shall only be rotated with tools approved by Cooper Steel.
        iii. When material is rotated by the crane the load must remain in a controlled state throughout rotation and shall not cause shock loading to the crane.

9. **Loading**
    a. Loose structural shapes such as angles, channels, flat bars, beams, pipes, plates, tubes, etc. gathered into bundles in lengths greater than 5'-0" shall be banded with steel banding in a manner to prevent separation and or slipping.
    b. All materials must be loaded in a manner to promote stability during transport.

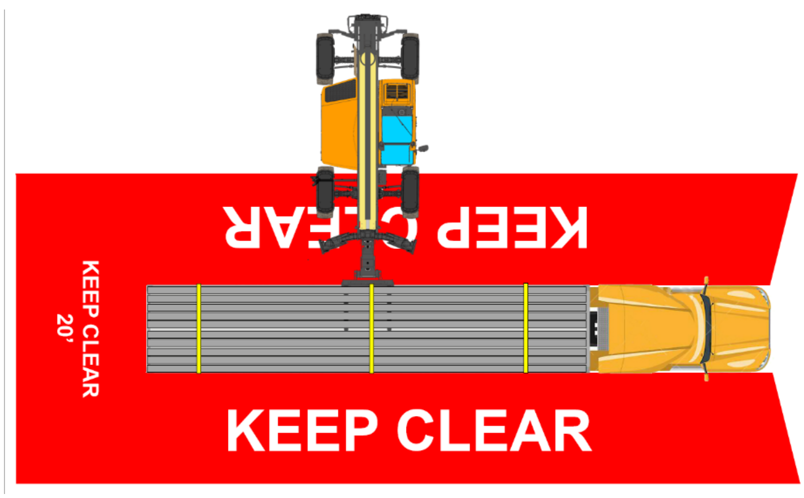
c. Loads shall be built in a manner that establishes a low center of gravity. Meaning heavier materials shall be placed near the bottom of the load.
d. All load securement devices must be in a serviceable condition. Non serviceable devices shall be removed from the tractor/trailer and discarded.
e. Loads must be secured adequately to the vehicle by devices that are capable of meeting the performance requirements and the working load limit requirements.
f. Additional tiedowns may be necessary for irregular loads.

10. Transporting to the Project Site

a. Drivers shall comply with all DOT/FMCSA regulations at all times when transporting loads to the project site.
b. Drivers shall frequently check load securement to ensure that binding devices have not become slacked.
c. When arriving on site materials shall remain fully secured to the trailer until arriving at the final unloading location.

11. Unloading

a. The load shall be inspected by a competent person to ensure stability prior to removing load securement (straps, chains, etc.).
b. Handle only stable and safely arranged loads.
c. The area around the bed/trailer and tractor being unloaded shall remain clear of non-essential personnel at all times for a distance of 20’ from the load in all directions and 20’ from the path of travel.



d. Drivers shall remain in their cabs or outside the clearance zone, in the required PPE for the location, during the unloading process.

12. **Training**
    Cooper Steel shall ensure that employees involved in the handling, storage, staging, and transport of materials are trained in this policy.

13. **References**
    a. OSHA 2236 Materials Handling and Storage
    b. CSC-29 Powered Industrial Truck
    c. CSF-40 Cranes and Hoisting Equipment

STEEL ERECTION

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSF-39
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 VERSION: 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   This program is intended to provide Cooper Steel when performing steel erection with guidelines for the safe procedures that maintain structural stability throughout the erection process.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Field Employees and project sites.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The VP of Field Safety shall develop a site specific safety and erection plan for each project in accordance with this policy, AISC 207-16, and OSHA Subpart R App A.
   c. Field Safety Directors shall ensure Field Management and Field Safety Managers implement this policy at each project.

4. **Pre Steel Erection Requirements**
   Prior to beginning steel erection the Job Hazard Analysis, Site Specific Erection Plan, and Site Specific Safety Plan will be reviewed and understood by all workers involved on the project. The following must also be received and/or performed:
   a. Before authorizing the commencement of steel erection, the controlling contractor shall ensure that Cooper Steel is provided with the following:
      i. Written notification that the concrete in the footings, piers and walls and the mortar in the masonry piers and walls has attained, on the basis of an appropriate ASTM standard test method of field-cured samples, either 75 percent of the intended minimum compressive design strength or sufficient strength to support the loads imposed during steel erection.
         1. Sufficient strength will be determined by the project engineer of record.
      ii. Written approval from the engineer of record of any repairs, replacements, or modifications to the anchor rods.
      iii. Adequate access roads into and through the site for the safe delivery and movement of cranes, trucks, other necessary equipment, and the material to be erected and means and methods for pedestrian and vehicular control.
      iv. A firm, properly graded, drained area, readily accessible to the work with adequate space for the safe storage of materials and the safe operation of the erector's equipment.
   b. Active Steel Erection areas shall be barricaded to prevent unauthorized persons from entering the area. Barricades will be made of high strength red danger tape or equivalent and “Controlled Access” signs will be posted to warn

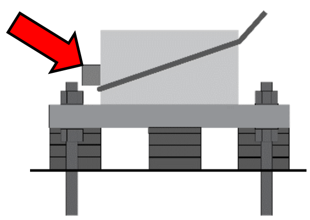
unauthorized personnel to stay clear of the area. Warning lines (when feasible) will be maintained a minimum of 25’ and maximum of 75’ from the active erection area.

c. Routes for suspended loads shall be pre-planned to ensure that no employee is required to work directly below a suspended load except for:
    i. Employees engaged in the initial connection of the steel
    ii. Employees necessary for the hooking or unhooking of the load.

d. When working under suspended loads, the following criteria shall be met:
    i. Materials being hoisted shall be rigged to prevent unintentional displacement.
    ii. Hooks with self-closing safety latches or their equivalent shall be used to prevent components from slipping out of the hook.
    iii. All loads shall be rigged by a qualified rigger.

5. Structural Stability

a. Structural stability shall be maintained at all times during the erection process.
    i. Temporary bracing plans will be developed that show the path of erection. Any deviation from the erection path will require a review of the bracing plan, making any adjustments necessary to maintain structural stability throughout the erection process.
    ii. Temporary Brace cables must not be looped underneath the column base plate.
        1. A steel stop must be provided to prevent the brace cable from slipping up the column.



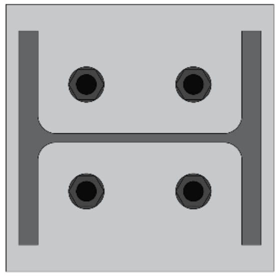
    iii. When the structural frame is “boxed in” on four sides the temporary brace cables will be installed as soon as possible, no later than the end of the day.
    iv. Permanent bracing will be installed during the initial erection process and will be noted on the temporary bracing plan.
    v. Temporary brace cables will be flagged (red) at 6’ intervals along the length of the cable.
    vi. Columns will be supported in two directions within a reasonable time, and will not be left free standing during breaks, overnight, or in inclement weather.

b. The following additional requirements shall apply for multi-story structures:
    i. The permanent floors shall be installed as the erection of structural steel progresses.

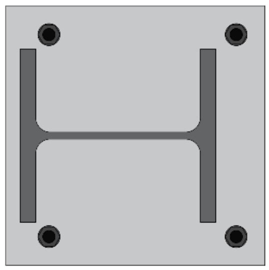
ii. There shall be not more than eight stories between the erection floor and the upper-most permanent floor, except where the structural integrity is maintained as a result of the design.
iii. At no time shall there be more than four floors or 48 feet (14.6 m), whichever is less, of unfinished bolting or welding above the foundation or uppermost permanently secured floor, except where the structural integrity is maintained as a result of the design.
    1. If steel erection procedures deviate from Subpart R regulations an engineered structural stability plan will be developed prior to commencement of steel erection to maintain structural integrity throughout the erection process.
iv. A fully planked or decked floor or nets shall be maintained within two stories or 30 feet (9.1 m), whichever is less, directly under any erection work being performed unless the following conditions are met:
    1. Complete fall protection system is in use that prohibits impact with lower levels.
    2. Workers will be trained in the use of fall protection equipment.
    3. Rescue procedures will be noted in the Site Specific Safety Plan.
    4. Employees will be trained on the rescue procedures.
    5. Area below steel erection activities will be established as a Controlled Access Zone by use of barricades and controlled access signage.
        a. Access will be restricted to workers essential the steel erection process.
        b. If unauthorized personnel enter the active erection area all steel erection activities are to be safely halted until the area is made safe.

6. Column Shims

a. If the anchor rods support the weight of the column and the column meets the criteria in this policy, they must be shimmed.
b. Business Unit Team to review need for shim packs in the Pre-Detailing Meeting.
c. Project Manager to confirm in the Quick Base Task List
d. To be determined in pre-construction phase:
    i. When columns are over 45’ in height.
    ii. When columns support multiple levels.
    iii. When “½ nut” leveling nuts must be used (eliminate in detailing if possible).
    iv. When anchor rod layout falls inside of the flange of the column (eliminate in detailing if possible).

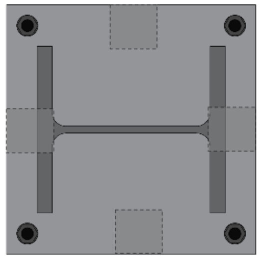


e. When setting on anchor rods that are not set in place (ie. epoxy anchors, grouted in, wedge style anchors, welded on threaded studs, etc.).
f. When the column is set off center of the anchor rod layout.



g. To be determined by Field Management:
   i. When pre-construction criteria was not followed.
   ii. When there is excessive grout space (any space greater than design requirement).
   iii. When setting on repaired, altered, or relocated anchor rods.
   iv. When temporary bracing is attached to the column.

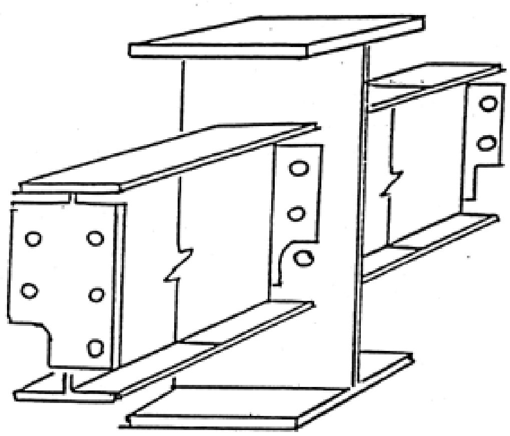
h. Typical Requirements
   i. Only steel shims will be used.
   ii. Shim packs must have firm contact with the footing and base plate.
   iii. Shim packs must be in place before additional members are connected to the column.
   iv. Typical Shim layout (unless noted otherwise) will be 4 shim packs as shown below:



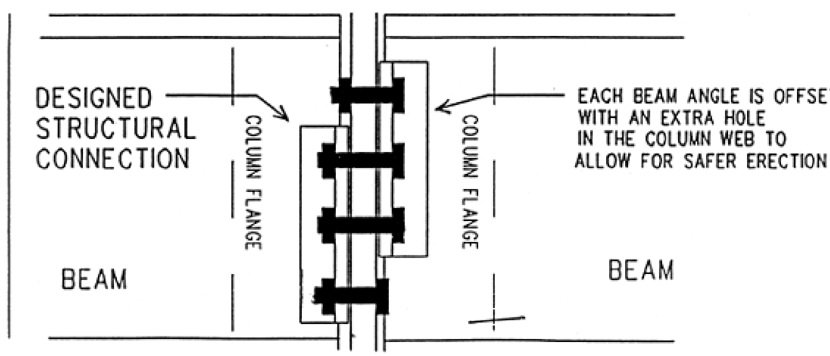
i. **Variations that may be considered in lieu of shim packs are:**
    i. Footing designs that contact the foundation and provide equal support to the column.
    ii. Grouted leveling plates installed and cured prior to column erection.
        1. A letter confirming that the grout has reached 75% of the intended minimum compressive design strength or sufficient strength to support the loads imposed during steel erection will be required.
            a. Sufficient strength will be determined by the Engineer of Record.

7. Steel Erection

a. Shear connectors (such as headed steel studs, steel bars or steel lugs), reinforcing bars, deformed anchors or threaded studs shall not be attached to the top flanges of beams, joists or beam attachments so that they project vertically from or horizontally across the top flange of the member until after the metal decking, or other walking/working surface, has been installed.
b. All columns will be anchored by a minimum of four anchor nuts prior to releasing hoisting lines. By design a minimum of four anchor rods are required per column.
c. Columns erected in sleeve footings will be welded a minimum of 1” on each side of the column prior to releasing the hoisting lines.
d. Stacked column splices shall be evaluated to determine if an engineered erection plan will be required.
e. During the erection of solid web structural members, the load shall not be released from the hoisting line until the members are secured with at least two or 25% of the connection bolts (whichever is greater), of the same size and strength as shown in the erection drawings, drawn up wrench-tight or the equivalent as specified by the project structural engineer of record.
    i. Initial erection bolts should be located near the top and bottom of the connection
f. Bolting will be 100% complete prior to installation of metal decking, planking.
g. Diagonal bracing shall be secured by at least one bolt per connection drawn up wrench-tight or the equivalent as specified by the project structural engineer of record.
h. When two structural members on opposite sides of a column web, or a beam web over a column, are connected sharing common connection holes, at least one bolt with its wrench-tight nut shall remain connected to the first member unless a shop-attached or field-attached seat or equivalent connection device is supplied with the member to secure the first member and prevent the column from being displaced. (See examples below)

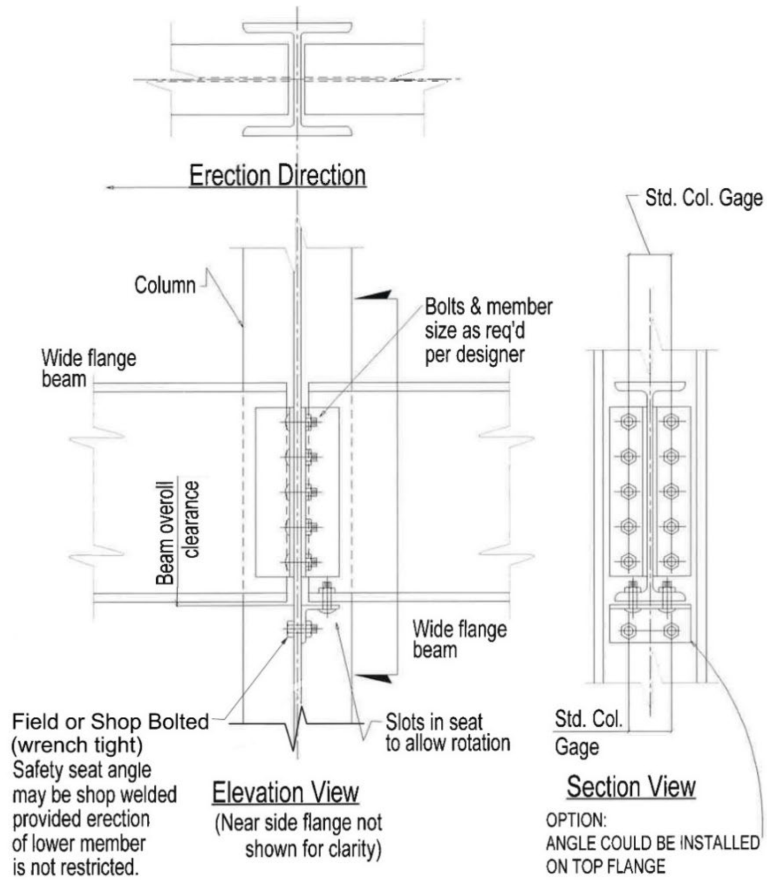


i. Clipped end connections are connection material on the end of a structural member which has a notch at the bottom and/or top to allow the bolt(s) of the first member placed on the opposite side of the central member to remain in place. The notch(es) fits around the nut or bolt head of the opposing member to allow the second member to be bolted up without removing the bolt(s) holding the first member. (above)



j. Staggered connections are connection material on a structural member in which all of the bolt holes in the common member web are not shared by the two incoming members in the final connection. The extra hole in the column web allows the erector to maintain at least a one bolt connection at all times while making the double connection. (above)

k. If a seat or equivalent device is used, the seat (or device) shall be designed to support the load during the double connection process. It shall be adequately bolted or welded to both a supporting member and the first member before the nuts on the shared bolts are removed to make the double connection (below).



8. **Joists and Joist Girders**
   a. Except where constructability does not allow, where steel joists are used and columns are not framed in at least two directions with solid web structural steel members, a steel joist shall be field-bolted at the column to provide lateral stability to the column during erection. For the installation of this joist:
      i. A vertical stabilizer plate shall be provided on each column for steel joists. The plate shall be a minimum of 6 inch by 6 inch (152 mm by 152 mm) and shall extend at least 3 inches (76 mm) below the bottom chord of the joist with a 13/16 inch (21 mm) hole to provide an attachment point for guying or plumbing cables.
      ii. The bottom chords of steel joists at columns shall be stabilized to prevent rotation during erection.
      iii. Hoisting cables shall not be released until the seat at each end of the steel joist is field-bolted, and each end of the bottom chord is restrained by the column stabilizer plate.
      iv. If diagonal "X" bridging is required it must be installed before the hoisting lines are released.
   b. Where constructability does not allow a steel joist to be installed at the column:

        i. an alternate means of stabilizing joists shall be installed on both sides near the column and hoisting cables shall not be released until the seat at each end of the steel joist is field-bolted and the joist is stabilized.

c. Where steel joists at or near columns span 60 feet (18.3 m) or less, the joist shall be designed with sufficient strength to allow one employee to release the hoisting cable without the need for erection bridging.
d. Where steel joists at or near columns span more than 60 feet (18.3 m), the joists shall be set in tandem with all bridging installed unless an alternative method of erection, which provides equivalent stability to the steel joist, is designed by a qualified person and is included in the Site Specific Erection Plan.
e. A steel joist or steel joist girder shall not be placed on any support structure unless such structure is stabilized.
f. When steel joist(s) are landed on a structure, they shall be secured to prevent unintentional displacement prior to installation. This applies to joists not located at the columns.
g. No modification that affects the strength of a steel joist or steel joist girder shall be made without the approval of the project structural engineer of record.
h. These connections shall be field-bolted unless constructability does not allow.
i. Steel joists and steel joist girders shall not be used as anchorage points for a fall arrest system unless written approval to do so is obtained from a qualified person.
j. Each end of "K" series steel joists shall be attached to the support structure with a minimum of two 1/8-inch (3 mm) fillet welds 1 inch (25 mm) long or with two 1/2-inch (13 mm) bolts, or the equivalent.
k. Each end of "LH" and "DLH" series steel joists and steel joist girders shall be attached to the support structure with a minimum of two 1/4-inch (6 mm) fillet welds 2 inches (51 mm) long, or with two 3/4-inch (19 mm) bolts, or the equivalent.
l. No bundle of decking may be placed on steel joists until all bridging has been installed and anchored and all joist bearing ends attached, unless all of the following conditions are met:
    i. It is first determined from a qualified person and documented in the site-specific erection plan that the structure or portion of the structure is capable of supporting the load
    ii. The bundle of decking is placed on a minimum of three steel joists
    iii. The joists supporting the bundle of decking are attached at both ends
    iv. At least one row of bridging is installed and anchored
    v. The total weight of the bundle of decking does not exceed 4,000 pounds
    vi. The edge of the construction load shall be placed within 1 foot (.30 m) of the bearing surface of the joist end.
m. If deck bundles cannot be placed in accordance with 1926.757(e)(5) a Deck Bundle Placement Plan will be required.

n. No workers will be allowed to work on top of joists until all structural bridging is installed and anchored.

9. Metal Decking

a. Bundle packaging and strapping shall not be used for hoisting unless specifically designed for that purpose.
b. At the end of the shift or when environmental or jobsite conditions require, metal decking shall be secured against displacement.
c. During initial placement, metal decking panels shall be placed to ensure full support by structural members.
d. No holes will be cut in roof or floor deck by Cooper Steel employees or subcontractors.

10. Metal Deck Installation

a. No holes will be cut in roof or floor deck by Cooper Steel employees or subcontractors.
b. Cooper Steels policy for “tacking” deck is to secure each sheet at six (6) locations per deck sheet (2 at each end, and 2 in the center).
c. The area below decking operations must be barricaded and “overhead work” warning signs must be present.
d. When fall protection anchor points will be attached to decking, the sheet(s) will be connected 100% per the Engineer of Records design.
e. When winds exceed 20 mph, all decking operations will stop. The crew will wait until winds subside before resuming active deck operations. Any deck that has been laid will at a minimum be wind tacked in 6 locations per deck sheet or fully connected. Any broken bundles will be secured with ratchet straps attached to the steel structure at each end. Decking being laid out should not exceed the following guidelines without being wind tacked.
    i. B, F and N Roof Deck (20 ga or lighter)
        6. Winds calm to 10 mph: no more than 3-4 bays
        7. Winds 10 to 14 mph: no more than 1-2 bays
        8. Winds 14 to 20 mph: no more than 1 bay
    ii. B, F and N Roof Deck (18 ga or heavier)
        9. Winds calm to 14 mph: no more than 3-4 bays
        10. Winds 14 to 20 mph: no more than 1-2 bays
    iii. Form Deck (24, 26 and 28 ga)
        11. Winds calm to 8 mph: no more than 1-2 bays
        12. Winds 8 to 16 mph: no more than 1 bay
    iv. Composite Deck (all gages)
        13. Winds calm to 14 mph: no more than 1-2 bays
        14. Winds 14 to 20 mph: no more than 1 bay

11. Signal Person

a. Signal Persons must be trained in accordance with OSHA 1926.1428, and understand the relevant requirements of OSHA 1926.1492 – 1926.1422. Qualified signal persons are required in the following situations:
   i. When the load must be lifted over personnel
   ii. When the lift and path of travel of the load is not in full sight of the crane operator.
   iii. When required by site specific safety concerns.

b. Signals to operators must be by hand, voice, radio, or audible, and will be determined in the field before lifting operations begin.

40 CRANES AND HOISTING EQUIPMENT

DATE REVIEWED: 3/4/2025 DOCUMENT #: CSF-40
SUPERSEDES: Rev. 9 VERSION: 2.0

1. **Purpose**
   The purpose of this Written Cranes and Hoisting Equipment Safety Program is to establish and maintain a safe working environment for all personnel involved in the operation, maintenance, and work around cranes, hoists, and associated rigging equipment. This program is designed to prevent accidents, injuries, and property damage by defining safe work practices, inspection procedures, and training requirements, while ensuring compliance with applicable regulatory standards, including those set by OSHA. Ultimately, this program aims to foster a culture of safety, promoting efficient operations and the well-being of our workforce.

2. **Scope**
   This policy applies to all Cooper Steel Field Employees and project sites where daily tasks include the use of cranes and hoisting equipment.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation and distribution of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety and Directors of Field Safety shall be responsible for the distribution of this policy.
   c. Foremen and Field Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.

4. **Mobile Crane Inspections**
   a. Daily (Each Shift): Mobile cranes in use shall be visually inspected and documented prior to each shift by a competent person; the inspection shall include observation for deficiencies during operation. At a minimum this inspection shall include the following:
      i. Control mechanisms for maladjustments interfering with proper operation.
      ii. Control and drive mechanisms for apparent excessive wear of components and contamination by lubricants, water, or other foreign matter.
      iii. Air, hydraulic, and other pressurized lines for deterioration or leakage, particularly those which flex in normal operation.
      iv. Hydraulic system for proper fluid level.
      v. Hooks and latches for deformation, cracks, excessive wear, or damage such as from chemicals or heat.
      vi. Wire rope reeving for compliance with the manufacturer's specifications.
      vii. Wire rope, in accordance with § 1926.1413(a).

viii. Electrical apparatus for malfunctioning, signs of apparent excessive deterioration, dirt, or moisture accumulation.
ix. Tires (when in use) for proper inflation and condition.
x. Ground conditions around the equipment for proper support, including ground settling under and around outriggers/stabilizers and supporting foundations, ground water accumulation, or similar conditions. This paragraph does not apply to the inspection of ground conditions for railroad tracks and their underlying support when the railroad tracks are part of the general railroad system of transportation that is regulated pursuant to the Federal Railroad Administration under 49 CFR part 213.
xi. The equipment for level position within the tolerances specified by the equipment manufacturer's recommendations, both before each shift and after each move and setup.
xii. Operator cab windows for significant cracks, breaks, or other deficiencies that would hamper the operator's view.
xiii. Rails, rail stops, rail clamps and supporting surfaces when the equipment has rail traveling. This paragraph does not apply to the inspection of rails, rail stops, rail clamps and supporting surfaces when the railroad tracks are part of the general railroad system of transportation that is regulated pursuant to the Federal Railroad Administration under 49 CFR part 213.
xiv. Safety devices and operational aids for proper operation.

b. **Monthly:** Each month the equipment is in service it must be inspected in accordance with the Daily (Each Shift) criteria of this section and Manufacturer’s recommendations by a qualified person. Equipment must not be used until there are no corrective actions required under this section. Monthly Inspections will be documented and maintained for a minimum of three months by Cooper Steel.
c. **Annual/Comprehensive:** At least every 12 months the equipment must be inspected by a qualified person in accordance with this section and the manufacturer’s recommendations. Disassembly is required, as necessary, to complete the inspection. This inspection must include functional testing to determine that the equipment as configured in the inspection is functioning properly. If any deficiency is identified, an immediate determination must be made by the qualified person as to whether the deficiency constitutes a safety hazard. If the qualified person determines that a deficiency is a safety hazard, the equipment must be taken out of service until it has been corrected. **The equipment must be inspected for all the following:**
    i. Equipment structure (including the boom and, if equipped, the jib):
    ii. Structural members: Deformed, cracked, or significantly corroded.
    iii. Bolts, rivets, and other fasteners: loose, failed or significantly corroded.
    iv. Welds for cracks.

v. Sheaves and drums for cracks or significant wear.
vi. Parts such as pins, bearings, shafts, gears, rollers and locking devices for distortion, cracks, or significant wear.
vii. Brake and clutch system parts, linings, pawls, and ratchets for excessive wear.
viii. Safety devices and operational aids for proper operation (including significant inaccuracies).
ix. Gasoline, diesel, electric, or other power plants for safety-related problems (such as leaking exhaust and emergency shut-down feature) and conditions, and proper operation.
x. Chains and chain drive sprockets for excessive wear of sprockets and excessive chain stretch.
xi. Travel steering, brakes, and locking devices, for proper operation.
xii. Tires for damage or excessive wear.
xiii. Hydraulic, pneumatic, and other pressurized hoses, fittings, and tubing, as follows:
    1. Flexible hose or its junction with the fittings for indications of leaks.
    2. Threaded or clamped joints for leaks.
    3. Outer covering of the hose for blistering, abnormal deformation, or other signs of failure/impending failure.
    4. Outer surface of a hose, rigid tube, or fitting for indications of excessive abrasion or scrubbing.
xiv. Hydraulic and pneumatic pumps and motors, as follows:
    1. Performance indicators: unusual noises or vibration, low operating speed, excessive heating of the fluid, low pressure.
    2. Loose bolts or fasteners.
    3. Shaft seals and joints between pump sections for leaks.
xv. Hydraulic and pneumatic valves, as follows:
    1. Spools: Sticking, improper return to neutral, and leaks.
    2. Leaks.
    3. Valve housing cracks.
    4. Relief valves: Failure to reach correct pressure (if there is a manufacturer procedure for checking pressure, it must be followed).
xvi. Hydraulic and pneumatic cylinders, as follows:
    1. Drifting caused by fluid leaking across the piston.
    2. Rod seals and welded joints for leaks.
    3. Cylinder rods for scores, nicks, or dents.
    4. Case (barrel) for significant dents.
    5. Rod eyes and connecting joints: Loose or deformed.
    6. Outrigger or stabilizer pads/floats for excessive wear or cracks.
    7. Slider pads for excessive wear or cracks.

xvii. Electrical components and wiring for cracked or split insulation and loose or corroded terminations.
xviii. Warning labels and decals originally supplied with the equipment by the manufacturer or otherwise required under this standard: Missing or unreadable.
xix. Originally equipped operator seat (or equivalent).
xx. Originally equipped steps, ladders, handrails, guards
xxi. Steps, ladders, handrails, guards in unusable/unsafe condition.

5. **Mobile Crane Operations**

Operations must not begin unless all of the safety devices are in proper working order. If a device stops working properly during operations, the operator must safely stop operations. If any of the devices are not in proper working order, the equipment must be taken out of service and operations must not resume until the device is again working properly. Alternative measures are not permitted to be used.

a. The Crane Operator will obey a STOP signal from anyone immediately.
b. Cranes will be operated strictly in accordance with the manufacturer’s instructions and procedures.
c. The crane operator’s manual must be readily available at all times and stored in the operators cab when not in use.
d. If any other deficiency is identified, an immediate determination shall be made by the competent person as to whether the deficiency constitutes a hazard.
e. If the deficiency is determined to constitute a hazard, the hoisting equipment shall be removed from service until the deficiency has been corrected.
f. All windows in cabs should be clear of any obstruction or distortion that interferes with the safe operation of the machine.
g. The operator shall be responsible for those operations under the operator's direct control. Whenever there is any doubt as to safety, the operator shall have the authority to stop and refuse to handle loads until safety has been assured.
h. No part of the crane, load or associated equipment will be operated, moved or lifted within 20 feet of power lines. Work requiring equipment to be closer than 20’ will be reviewed by the Safety Director and a plan developed in accordance with OSHA regulations before commencement.
i. The headache ball, hook or load shall not be used to transport personnel.
j. Safety latches on hooks shall not be deactivated or made inoperable except:
    i. When a qualified rigger has determined that the hoisting and placing of purlins and single joists can be performed more safely by doing so, and the procedure is documented in the Site Specific Safety Plan.
k. The operator must not leave the controls while the load is suspended, except where all of the following are met:
    i. The operator remains adjacent to the equipment and is not engaged in any other duties.

ii. The load is to be held suspended for a period of time exceeding normal lifting operations.
iii. The competent person determines that it is safe to do so and implements measures necessary to restrain the boom hoist and telescoping, load, swing, and outrigger or stabilizer functions.
iv. Barricades or caution lines, and notices, are erected to prevent all employees from entering the fall zone. No employees are permitted in the fall zone.
v. These provisions do not apply to working gear (such as slings, spreader bars, ladders, and welding machines) where the weight of the working gear is negligible relative to the lifting capacity of the equipment as positioned, and the working gear is suspended over an area other than an entrance or exit.

l. The Operator is responsible to erect and maintain control lines, warning lines, railings or similar barriers to mark the boundaries of the swing radius hazard areas
m. Crane Operators will be certified by the National Commission for the Certification of Crane Operators (NCCCO) or equivalent. Prior to certification Crane Operators in Training will operate by the following guidelines at the fabrication facility, or in the field:
n. Trainers for new crane operators will be:
    i. employed by Cooper Steel
    ii. must be certified or have passed the written portion of the certification test
    iii. must be in direct line of sight and continuously monitor trainee
    iv. must have no other tasks that interfere with continuous monitoring or communication
o. Crane Operator trainees shall not operate in the following conditions:
    i. within 20’ of power lines
    ii. hoisting personnel
    iii. participate in multiple-crane lifts
    iv. over a shaft, cofferdam, or in a tank farm
    v. multiple-lift rigging, unless the supervisor determines it is within the trainees skill level
p. No modifications will be made that could impact safe operation of the crane without written permission from the manufacturer.
q. Employees assigned to work on or near the equipment must be trained in how to recognize struck-by and pinch/crush hazard areas posed by the rotating superstructure.

6. Critical Lifts

This section includes guidelines and requirements applicable to critical lifts and describes the planning and documentation required to perform a critical lift.

a. **Critical Lift Criteria -** Lifts meeting the following criteria will be considered a “Critical Lift”:
    i. Lift that exceeds 75% of the rated capacity of the crane.
    ii. Two or more cranes used for a single lift. Complete CLP for each crane. (De-rate each crane to 75% rated capacity).
    iii. Two or more cranes in proximity where the booms or loads could make contact.
    iv. The operator is unable to see the load at all times during the lift.
    v. Over operating facilities where personnel may be endangered.
    vi. Lifting personnel in cages/man baskets attached to equipment not designed for the explicit purpose of lifting people.
    vii. Travelling with load.
    viii. Within 20 feet of power lines.
    ix. Material requiring special handling (e.g. dangerous goods, size/shape, requires nonstandard rigging, or is of high monetary value).
    x. Lifts to and from water.

b. **Critical Lift Procedure** - When critical lifts are required, the following procedure will be followed:
    i. Critical lift plan will be completed by the “lift supervisor” that will be involved with the lift using the latest revision of the “Cooper Steel Critical Lift Plan”.
    ii. Critical lift plan will be submitted to the Safety Director a minimum of 24 hours prior to commencement for approval.
    iii. All items being lifted must be noted on the Critical Lift Plan for confirmation of weight and size.

c. **Pre-Lift Meeting** - Once approved and prior to the lift, the plan will be reviewed by all involved including, but not limited to:
        1. Foreman (lift supervisor)
        2. Crane Operator
        3. Rigger(s)
        4. Connector(s)
    ii. Any revisions to the critical lift plan shall be reviewed and approved through the original procedure.

7. **Crane Assembly and Disassembly**
    a. All the below shall be met when assembling or disassembling any crane
        i. All manufacturers’ specifications/instructions are to be followed during assembly/disassembly.

ii. The Assembly/Disassembly (A/D) Director must be certified in Cooper Steel's A/D Director Training Course.
iii. Before commencing assembly/disassembly operations, the A/D director must ensure that the crew members understand all of the following:
    1. Their tasks.
    2. The hazards associated with their tasks.
    3. The hazardous positions/locations that they need to avoid.
iv. Upon completion of assembly, the equipment must be inspected to ensure compliance with post-assembly inspection requirements.
v. When rigging is used for assembly/disassembly, the employer must ensure that:
    1. The rigging work is done by a qualified rigger.
    2. Synthetic slings are protected from: Abrasive, sharp or acute edges, and configurations that could cause a reduction of the slings rated capacity, such as distortion or localized compression.
    3. When synthetic slings are used, the synthetic sling manufacturer's instructions, limitations, specifications and recommendations must be followed.
vi. None of the pins in the pendants are to be removed (partly or completely) when the pendants are in tension.
vii. None of the pins (top or bottom) on boom sections located between the pendant attachment points and the crane/derrick body are to be removed (partly or completely) when the pendants are in tension.
viii. None of the pins (top or bottom) on boom sections located between the uppermost boom section and the crane/derrick body are to be removed (partly or completely) when the boom is being supported by the uppermost boom section resting on the ground (or other support).
ix. None of the top pins on boom sections located on the cantilevered portion of the boom being removed (the portion being removed ahead of the pendant attachment points) are to be removed (partly or completely) until the cantilevered section to be removed is fully supported.

8. Signal Person

a. Signal Persons must be trained in accordance with OSHA 1926.1428, and understand the relevant requirements of OSHA 1926.1492 – 1926.1422. Qualified signal persons are required in the following situations:
    i. When the load must be lifted over personnel
    ii. When the lift and path of travel of the load is not in full sight of the crane operator.
    iii. When required by site specific safety concerns.

b. Signals to operators must be by hand, voice, radio, or audible, and will be determined in the field before lifting operations begin.

9. **Other Hoisting Equipment**
   Any other hoisting equipment must first be reviewed by the General Field Superintendent, and the Field Safety Director for approval before use.

43 SCAFFOLD SAFETY

DATE REVIEWED: 12 Mar 2025 **DOCUMENT #:** CSF-43
SUPERSEDES #: **VERSION #:** 1.0

1. **Purpose**
   It is Cooper Steel's purpose to further ensure a safe workplace based on the following written procedures for scaffold work. These procedures should be reviewed and updated as needed to comply with new safety regulations, best industry practices, and business demands.

2. **Scope**
   This general scaffold plan applies to:
   a. All Cooper Steel employees who perform work while on a scaffold.
   b. All Cooper Steel employees who are involved in erecting, disassembling, moving, operating, repairing, maintaining, or inspecting scaffolds.

3. **Responsibilities**
   a. The Executive VP, Safety shall be responsible for the preparation of this policy and shall authorize any revisions to this policy.
   b. The Vice President of Field Safety, Director of Field Safety, Director of Facilities Safety, Plant Managers, and Facility Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.
   c. Field Management and Field Safety Managers shall make this policy available to all employees and are responsible for overall compliance with this policy.

4. **General Rules**
   a. Scaffolds will only be erected by a competent person in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions and/or an engineered plan.
   b. Scaffolds shall be erected on a base that will support all the loads that will be applied including materials and equipment.
   c. Only use access ladders built into the scaffold structure for access. Do not climb the frame of the scaffold.
   d. Clean ice, snow, oil, and grease off planks. Platform decks should be slip-resistant and should not accumulate water.
   e. Do not use scaffold planks as a base to stack materials, or as ramps or temporary roadways.
   f. Do not over-reach from the scaffold.
   g. On rolling scaffolds:
      i. Ensure that each wheel or castor is equipped with brakes to prevent rolling and swiveling.
      ii. Lock the caster brakes before climbing onto scaffold.

iii. Secure or remove all material, equipment, and personnel from platform before moving it.
iv. Push towards the base when moving.
v. Never move a scaffold with personnel aboard.
vi. Do not try to move a rolling scaffold without enough help. Watch out for slopes, holes, debris, and overhead obstructions.

5. Fall Protection Plan

Fall protection planning is critical to the safety and well-being of our workers. The Company's fall protection plan follows certain requirements that are different depending on the type of scaffold being used. Fall protection will be utilized by any worker on a scaffold more than 10 feet above a lower level by means of handrails and/or personal fall protection systems.

6. Using Scaffolds

Scaffolds and scaffold components shall be inspected for visible defects by a competent person before each work shift, and after any occurrence which could affect a scaffold's structural integrity.

However, in addition to that, all users of scaffolds in this company will know and understand the following safety rules:

a. Scaffolds and scaffold components will never be loaded more than their maximum intended loads or rated capacities.
b. Debris must not be allowed to accumulate on platforms.
c. Any part of a scaffold damaged or weakened shall be immediately tagged out, repaired, or replaced, braced to meet those provisions, or removed from service until repaired.
d. Scaffolds shall not be moved horizontally while workers are on them, unless they have been designed by a registered professional engineer specifically for such movement or, for mobile scaffolds.
e. Scaffolds shall not be erected, used, dismantled, altered, or moved such that they or any conductive material handled on them might come into contact with exposed and/or energized power lines.
f. Scaffolds shall be erected, moved, dismantled, or altered only under the supervision and direction of a competent person qualified in scaffold erection, moving, dismantling or alteration. Such activities shall be performed only by experienced and trained workers selected for such work by the competent person.
g. Workers shall be prohibited from working on scaffolds covered with snow, ice, or other slippery material except as necessary for removal of such materials.
h. Where swinging loads are being hoisted onto or near scaffolds such that the loads might contact the scaffold, tag lines or equivalent measures to control the loads shall be used.

i. Work on or from scaffolds is prohibited during storms or high winds.
j. Debris shall not be allowed to accumulate on platforms.
k. Makeshift devices, such as but not limited to boxes and barrels, shall not be used on top of scaffold platforms to increase the working level height of workers.
l. Ladders shall not be used on scaffolds to increase the working level height of workers.
m. Platforms shall not deflect more than 1/60 of the span when loaded.
n. To reduce the possibility of welding current arcing when performing welding from scaffolds, the following precautions shall be taken, as applicable:
    i. A grounding conductor shall be connected from the scaffold to the structure. The size of this conductor shall be at least the size of the welding process work lead, and this conductor shall not be in series with the welding process or the work piece
    ii. If the scaffold grounding lead is disconnected at any time, the welding machine shall be shut off
    iii. An active welding rod or uninsulated welding lead shall not be allowed to contact the scaffold.

7. **Prohibited Practices**

The following practices will never be tolerated:

a. Scaffold components manufactured by different manufacturers will never be intermixed unless the components fit together without force and the scaffold's structural integrity is maintained.
b. Unstable objects will never be used to support scaffolds or platform units. Footings must be level, sound, rigid, and capable of supporting the loaded scaffold without settling or displacement.
c. Cross braces will never be used as a means of access.

8. **Duties of Competent and Qualified Persons**

Only qualified and competent personnel are allowed to modify scaffolding systems. Modifications made by non-qualified personnel may create more hazards and are prohibited. If modifications are attempted by non-qualified personnel, they will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

9. **Tagging**

Tags must be placed at each point of entry to the scaffold. This includes access points from ground level and any access points from the structure with which the scaffold is being used.

Doing so ensures that workers are aware of the status and condition of the scaffold, regardless of where they access it. Whatever their color, tags must include:

a. The duty rating of the scaffold
b. The date on which the scaffold was last inspected

c. The name of the competent worker who inspected the scaffold
d. Any precautions to be taken while working on the scaffold, and
e. The expiration date of the tag

Scaffolds must be inspected prior to initial use and after any occurrence which could affect the scaffolds structural integrity.

The tags let workers know that a particular scaffold is safe for use, that a potential or unusual hazard is present, or the scaffold is unsafe for use.

Color of Inspection Tag	Wording to Appear on Tag
Green	"Safe for Use" or similar wording
Yellow	"Caution: Potential or Unusual Hazard" or similar wording
Red	"Unsafe for Use" or similar wording

10. Training

Recognizing the need for training for workers who:

a. perform work while on scaffolds
b. are involved in erecting, disassembling, moving, operating, repairing, maintaining, or inspecting scaffolds
c. have lost the requisite proficiency, training is one of the highest priorities of this program

11. Employees Who Use Scaffolds

Cooper Steel employees who perform work on scaffolds will be trained by a qualified person to recognize the hazards associated with the type of scaffold being used and to understand the procedures to control or minimize those hazards. All Cooper Steel employees will comply with scaffold tags. The training will include the following areas as applicable:

a. The nature of and the correct procedures for dealing with electrical hazards.
b. The nature of and the correct procedures for erecting, maintaining, and disassembling the fall protection and falling object protection systems used.
c. The proper use of the scaffold, and the proper handling of materials on the scaffold.
d. The maximum intended load and the load-carrying capacities of the scaffolds used.
e. Tagging of scaffolds.
f. Any other pertinent requirements of the local standards and regulations.

12. Employees Who Erect, Disassemble, Move, Operate, Repair, Maintain, or Inspect Scaffolds

Cooper Steel employees who erect, disassemble, move, operate, repair, maintain, or inspect scaffolds will be trained by our competent person to recognize the hazards associated with the work being done. The training will include the following:

a. The nature of scaffold hazards.
b. The correct procedures for erecting, disassembling, moving, operating, repairing, inspecting, and maintaining the type of scaffold in question.
c. The design criteria, maximum intended load-carrying capacity, and intended use of the scaffold.
d. Tagging of scaffolds.
e. Any other pertinent requirements of this subpart.